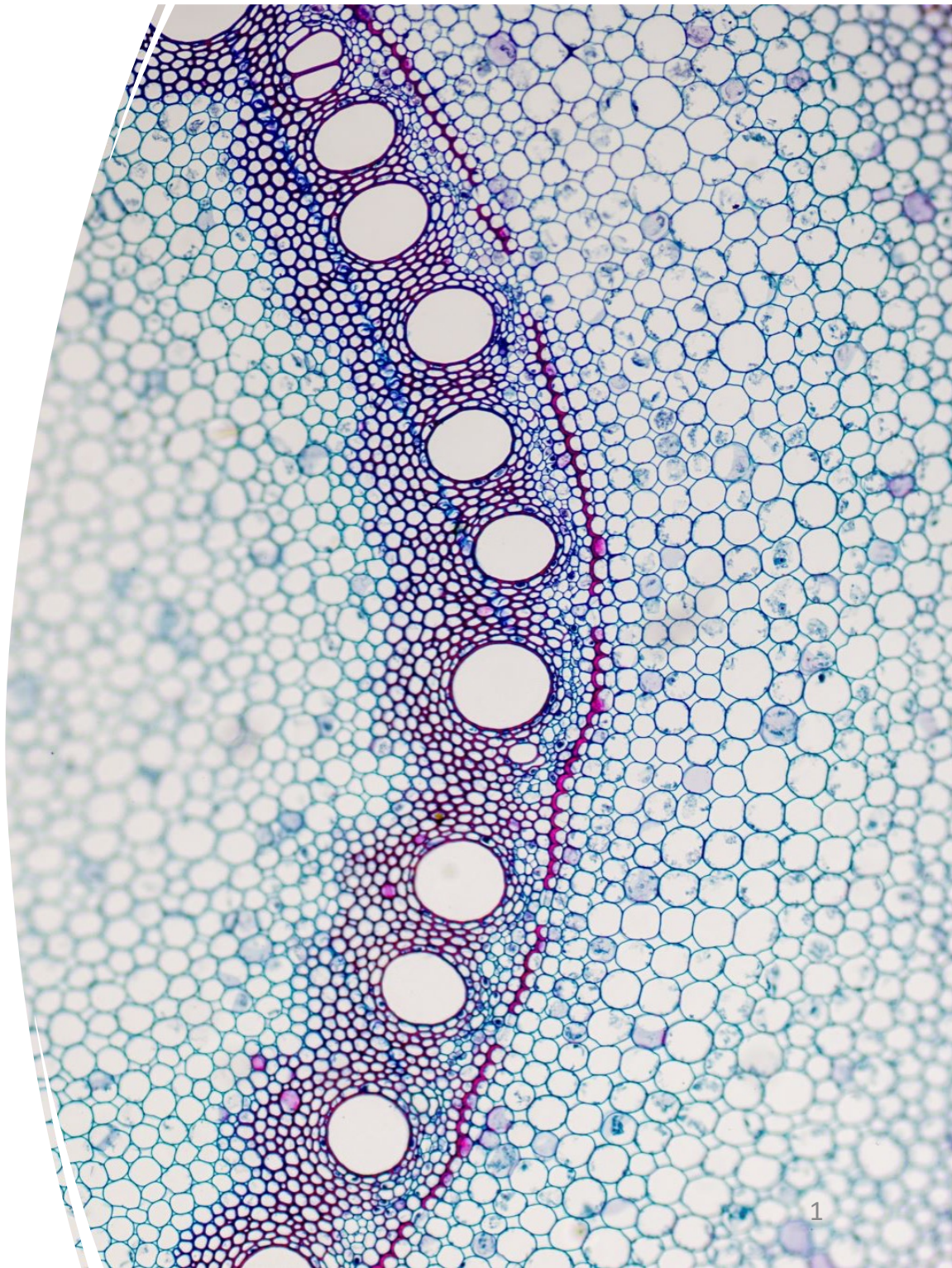
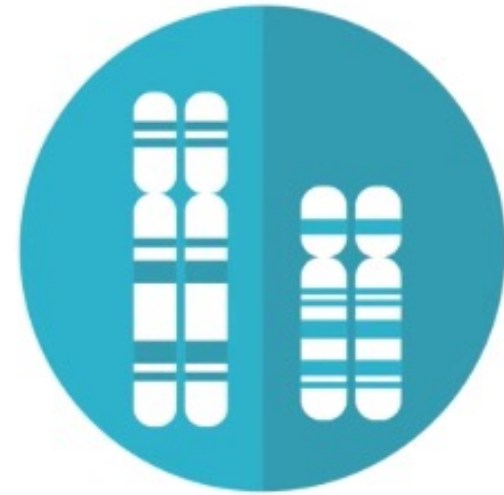


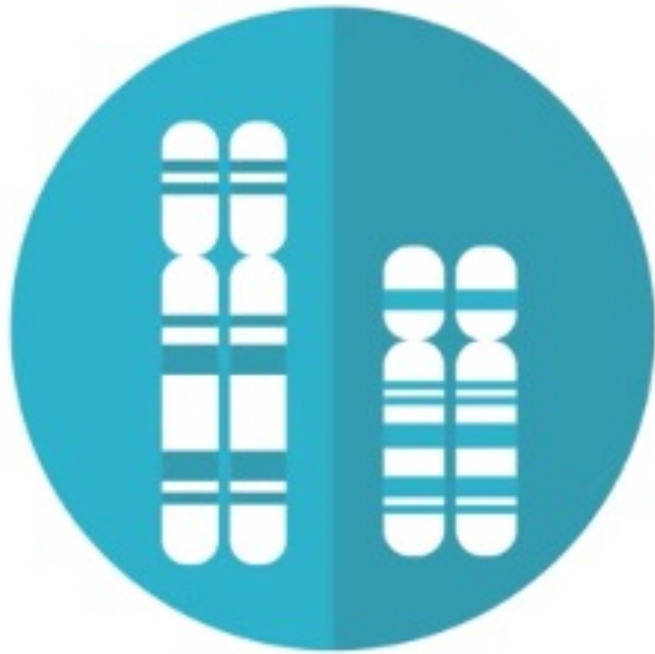
Transcriptome

Chapter18



in biology we
study **living**
organisms



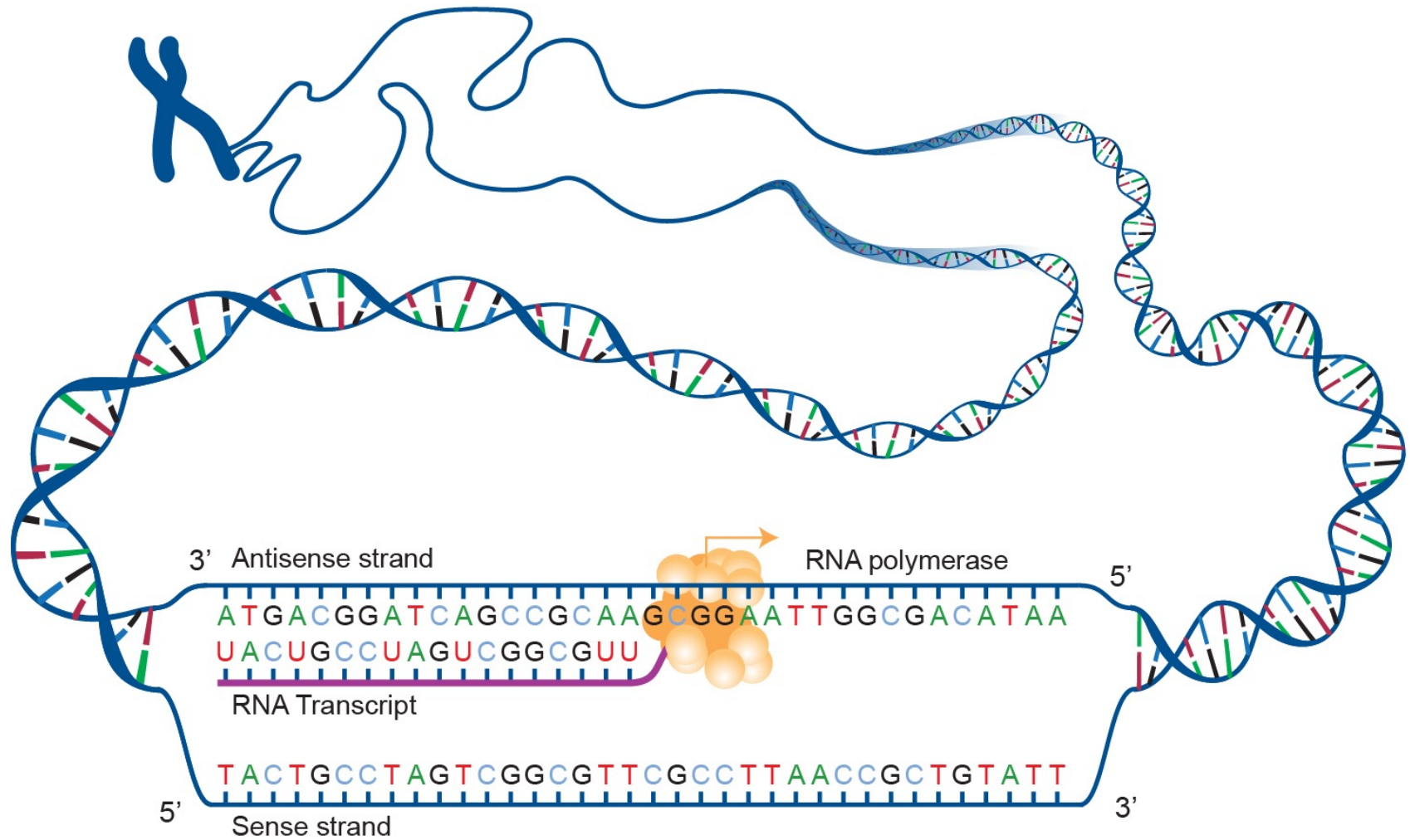


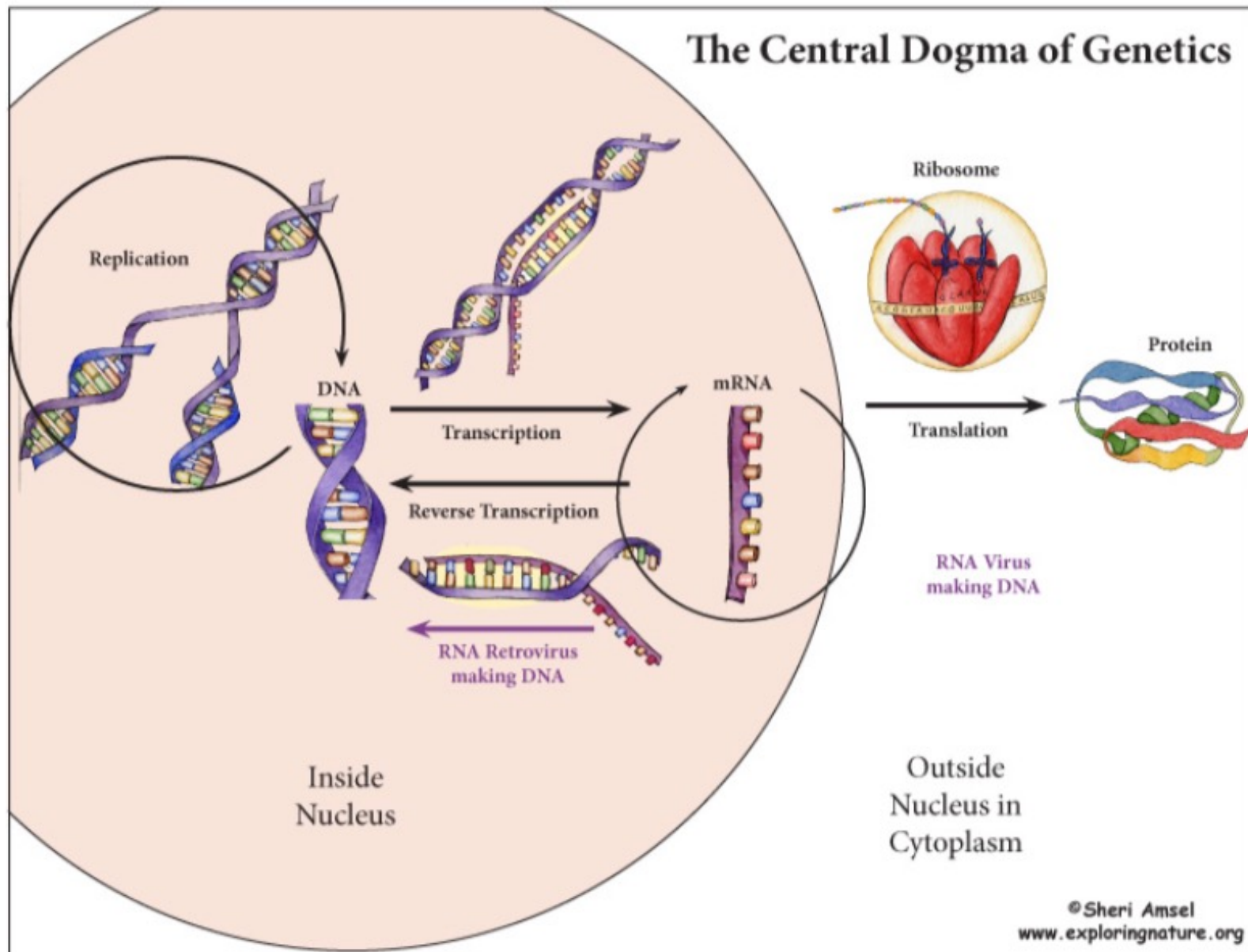
What **genes
are present?**



**What is happening
in a particular cell?**

**How does a cell type
perform gene expression?**



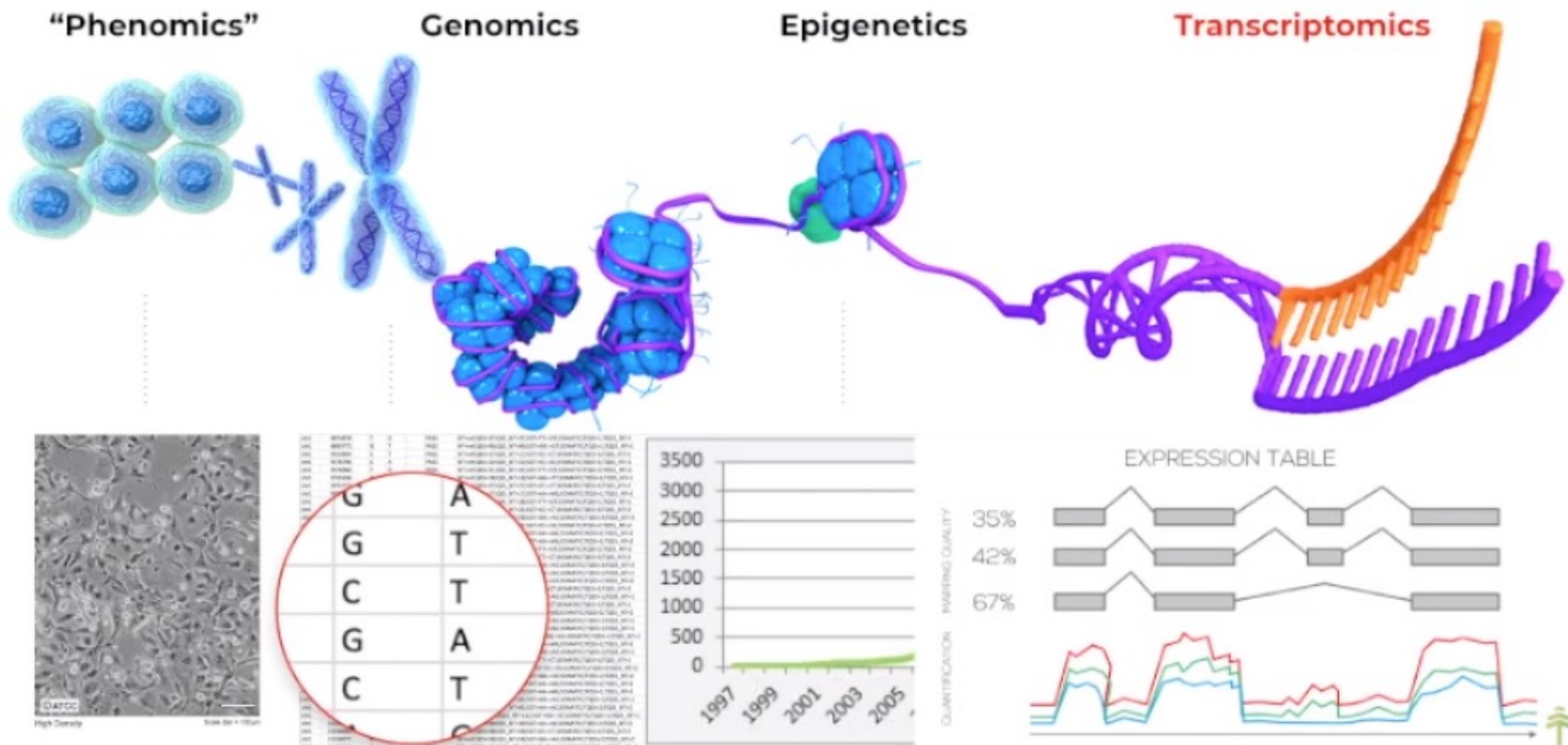


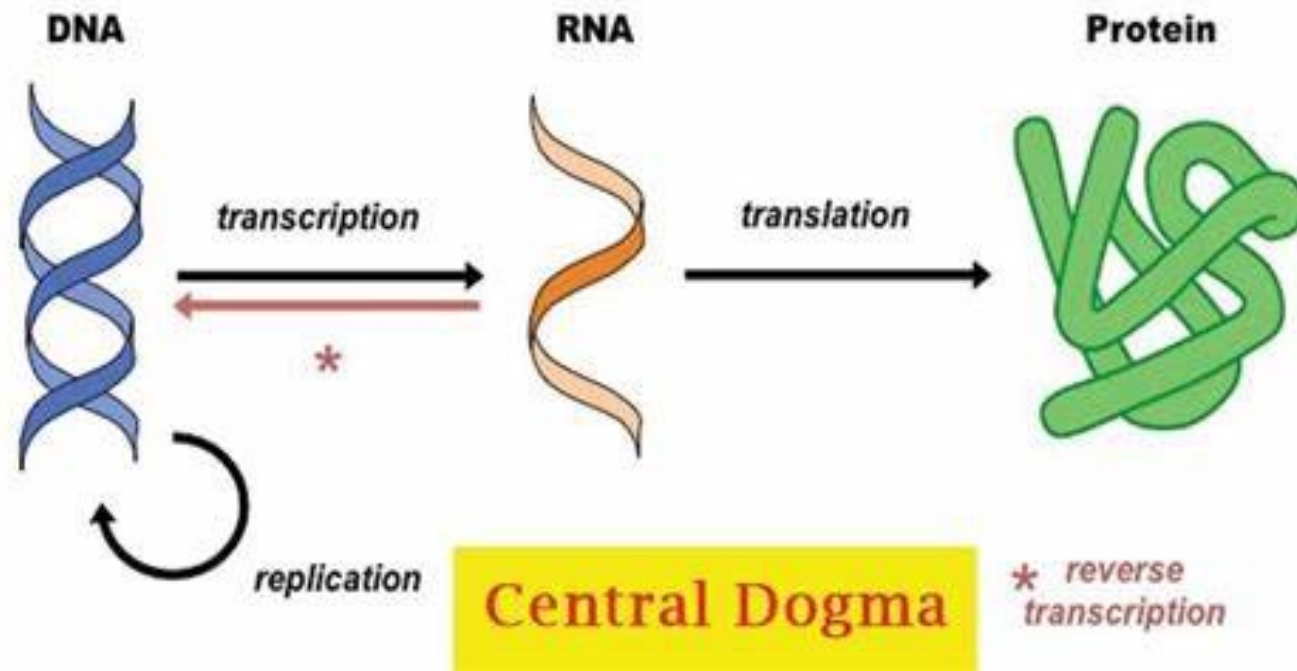
Concept

- **Transcriptome** is now widely understood to mean the complete set of all the ribonucleic acid (RNA) molecules expressed in some given entity, such as a cell, tissue, or organism.
- **Transcriptomics** encompasses everything relating to RNAs, including their transcription and expression levels, functions, locations, trafficking, and degradation. It also includes the structures of transcripts and their parent genes with regard to start sites, 5' and 3' end sequences, splicing patterns, and posttranscriptional modifications.
- **Transcriptomics** covers all types of transcripts, including messenger RNAs (mRNAs), microRNAs (miRNAs), and different types of long noncoding RNAs (lncRNAs).

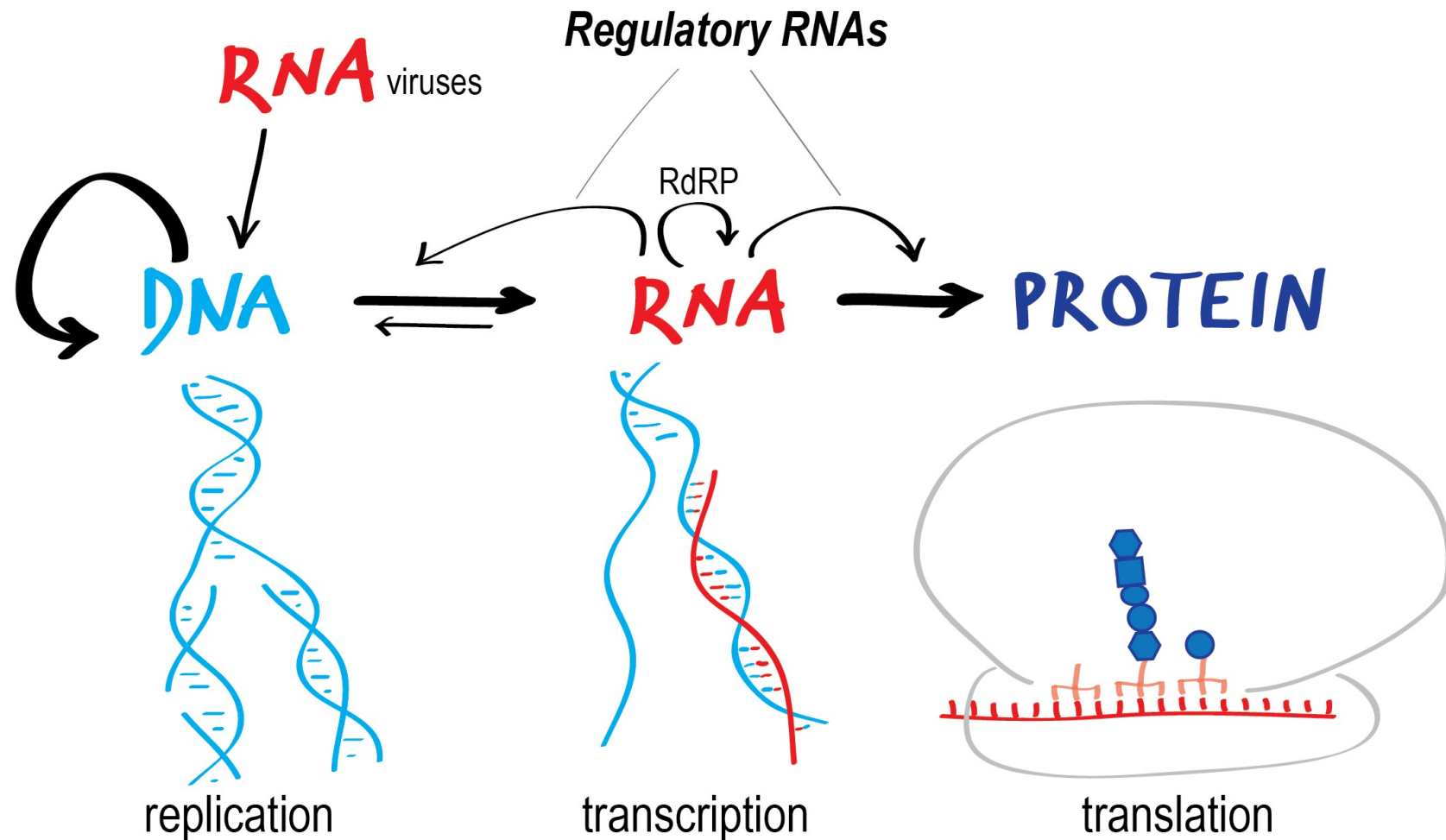
Concept

- **Modern transcriptomics** uses high-throughput methods to analyze the expression of multiple transcripts in different physiological or pathological conditions and this is rapidly expanding our understanding of the relationships between the transcriptome and the phenotype across a wide range of living entities.
- **Transcriptomic data** based on deep RNA-Seq approach can provide valuable information on differential gene and transcript expression patterns in specific cell types.

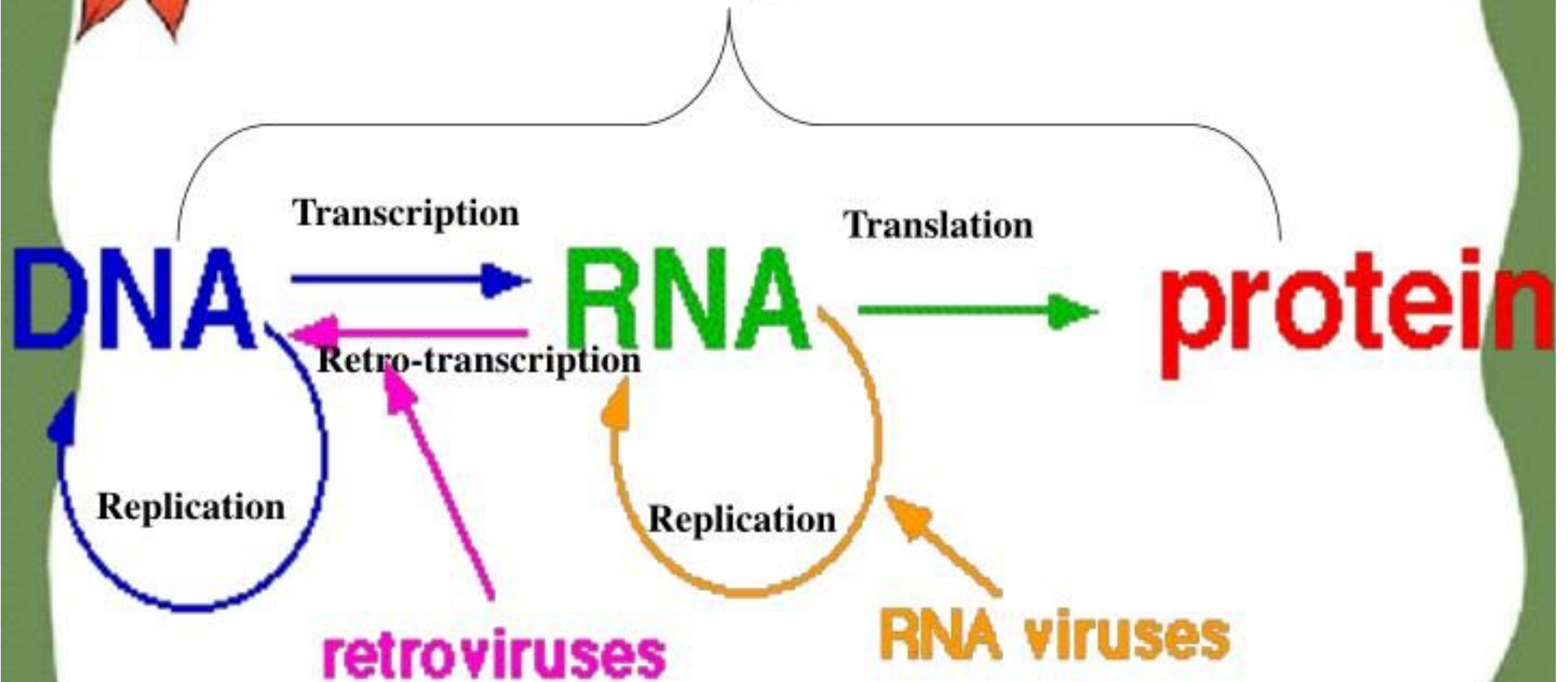




The expanded Central Dogma of Molecular Biology



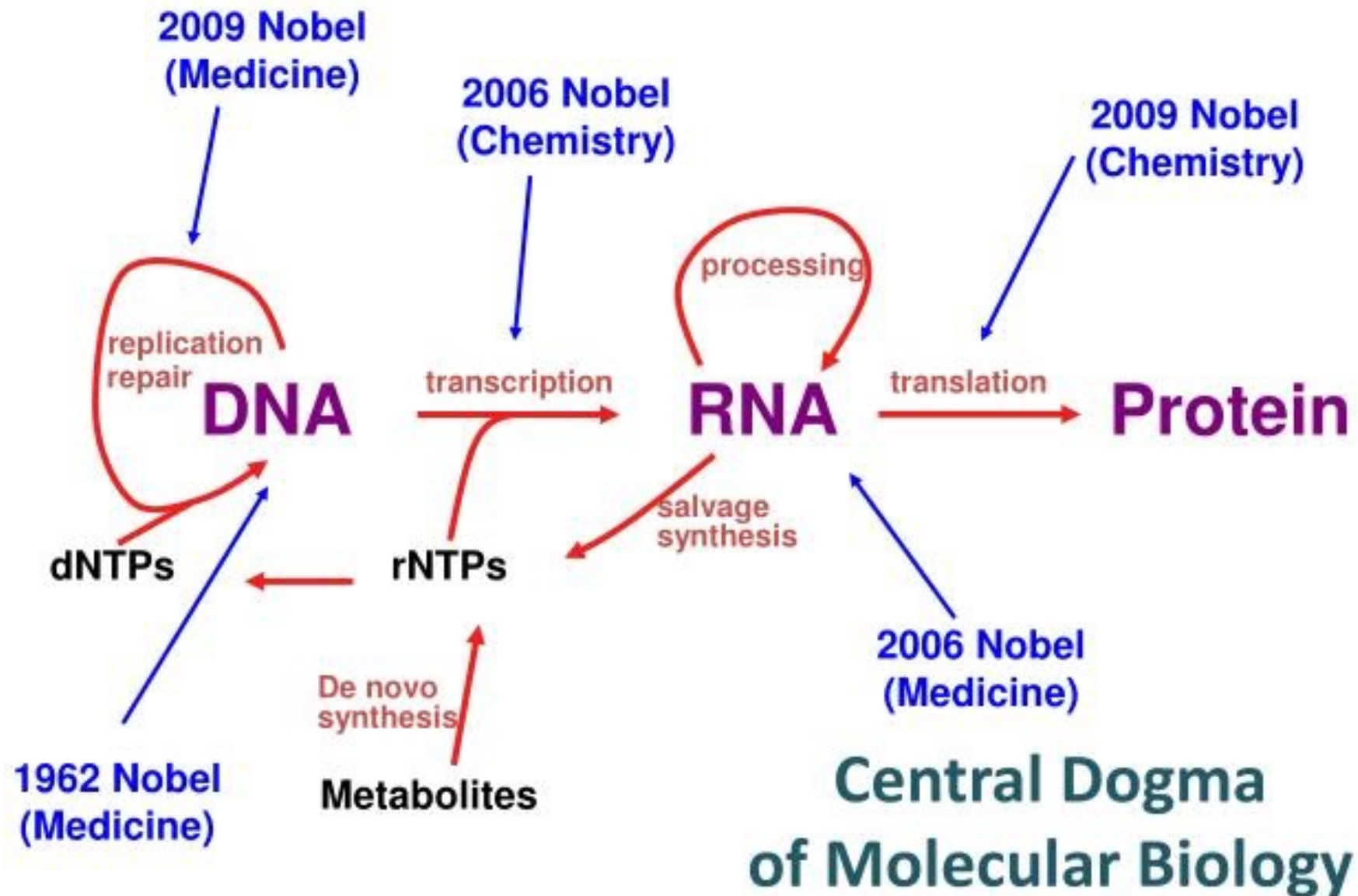
Gene expression



Central Dogma

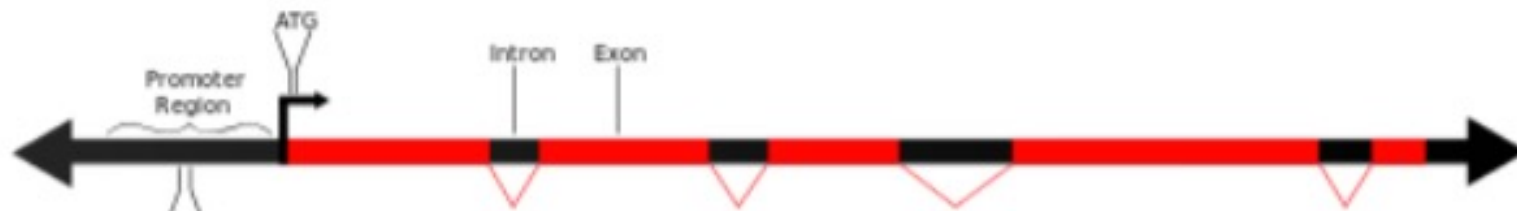


153B = the hottest science in town !



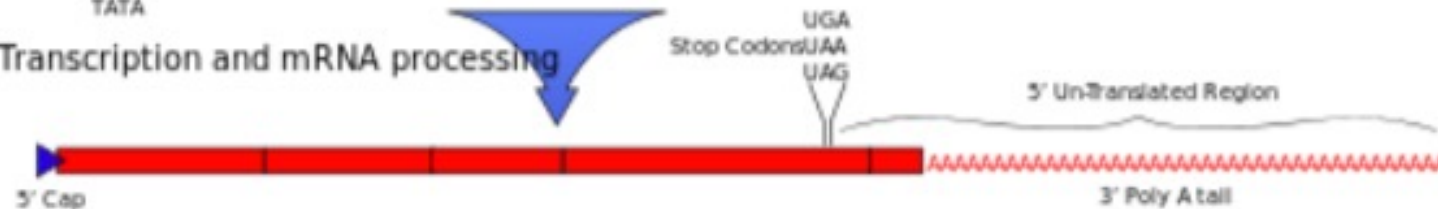
Central Dogma of Molecular Biology : Eukaryotic Mode

DNA



Transcription and mRNA processing

mRNA

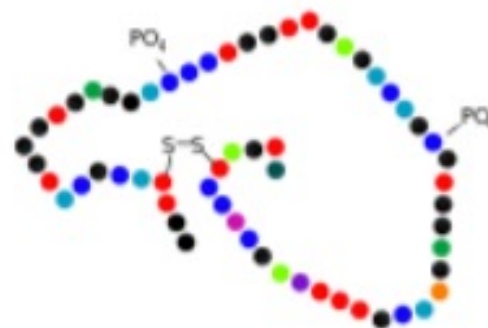


Translation

Protein

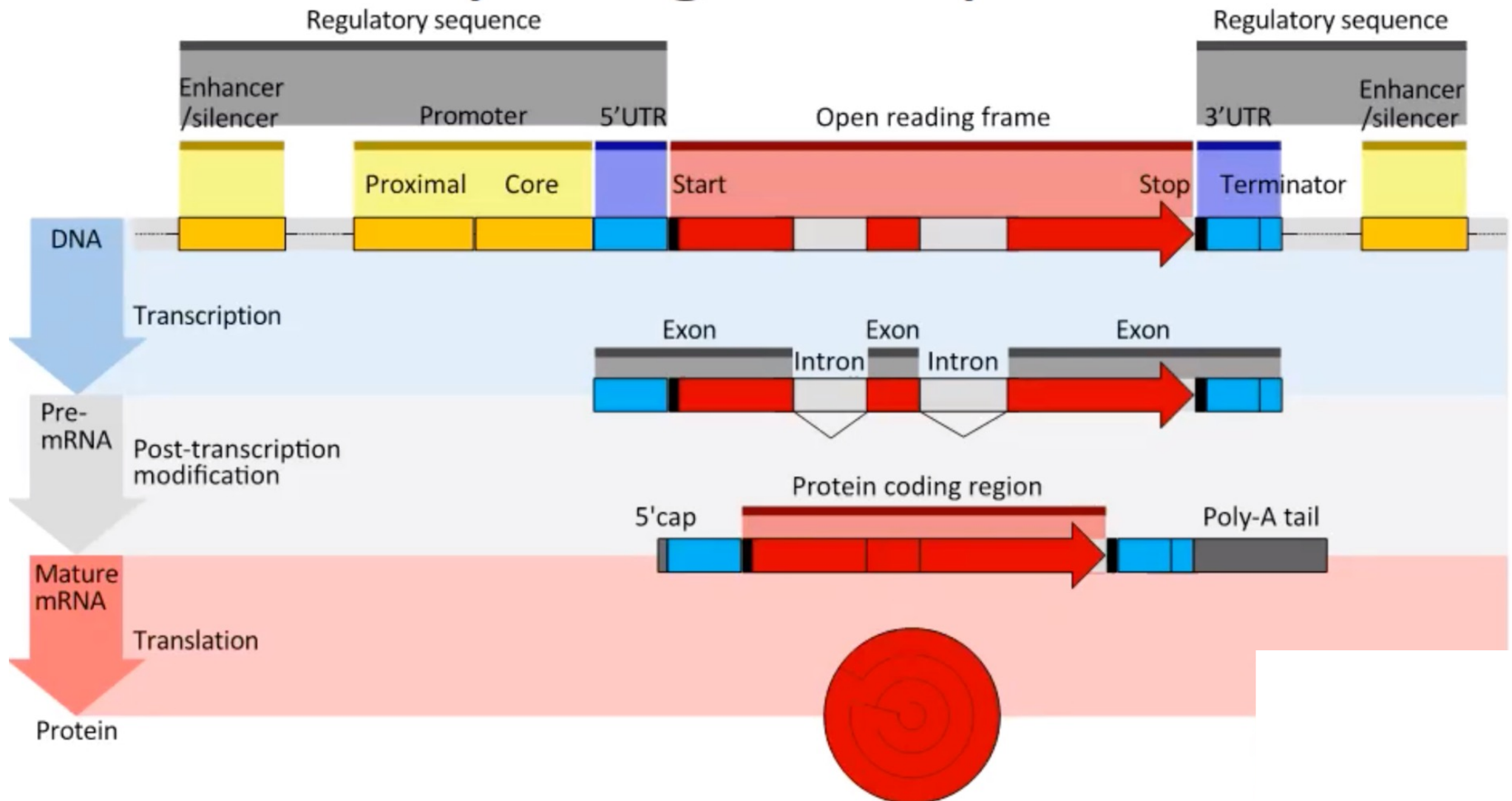


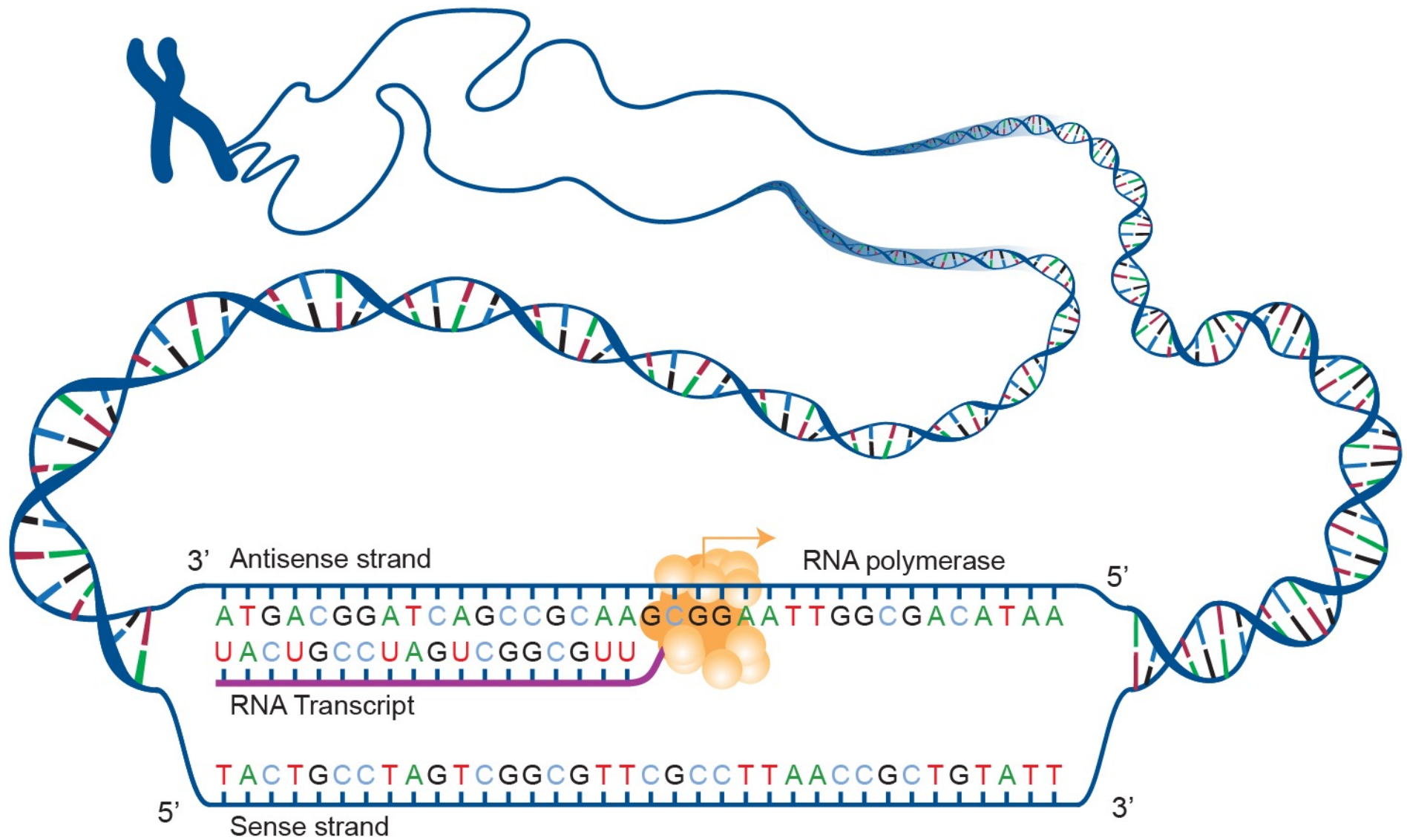
Post-Translational Modification

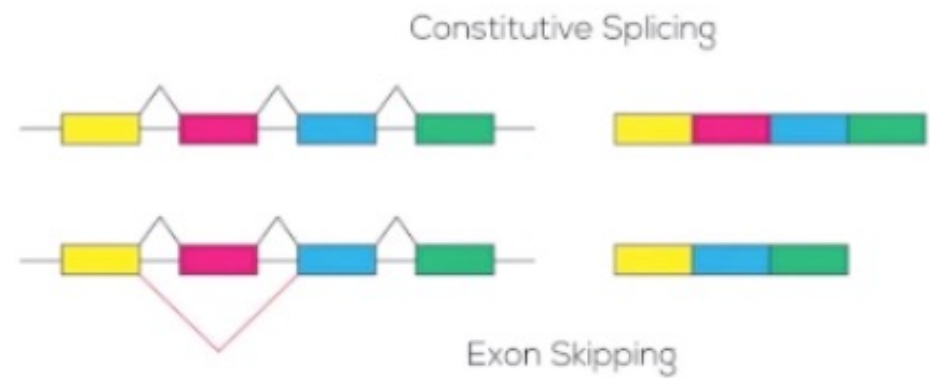
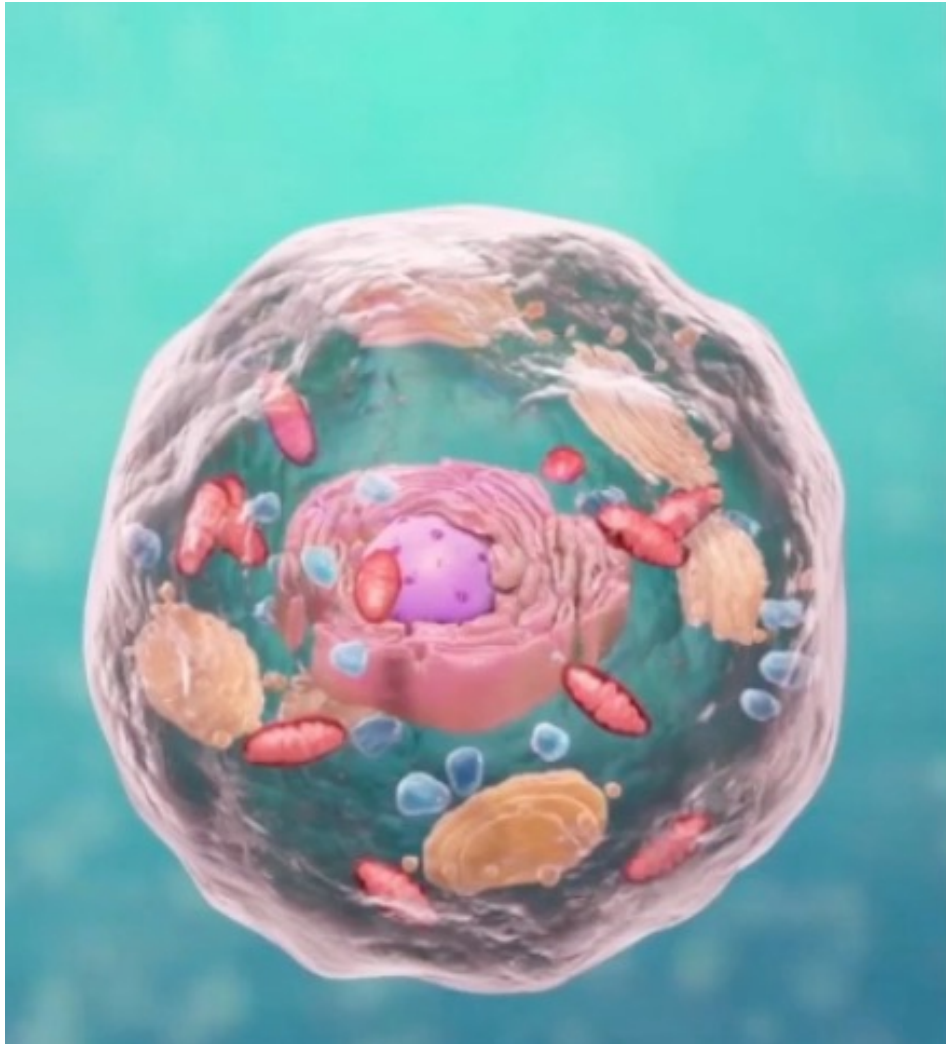


Active Protein

Eukaryotic gene expression







RESEARCH

Open Access



Rad51C-ATXN7 fusion gene expression in colorectal tumors

Arjun Kalvala¹, Li Gao¹, Brittany Aguila¹, Kathleen Dotts¹, Mohammad Rahman¹, Serge P. Nana-Sinkam^{1,3}, Xiaoping Zhou⁴, Qi-En Wang⁵, Joseph Amann^{1,2}, Gregory A. Otterson^{1,2}, Miguel A. Villalona-Calero^{1,2,6*} and Wenrui Duan^{1,2*}

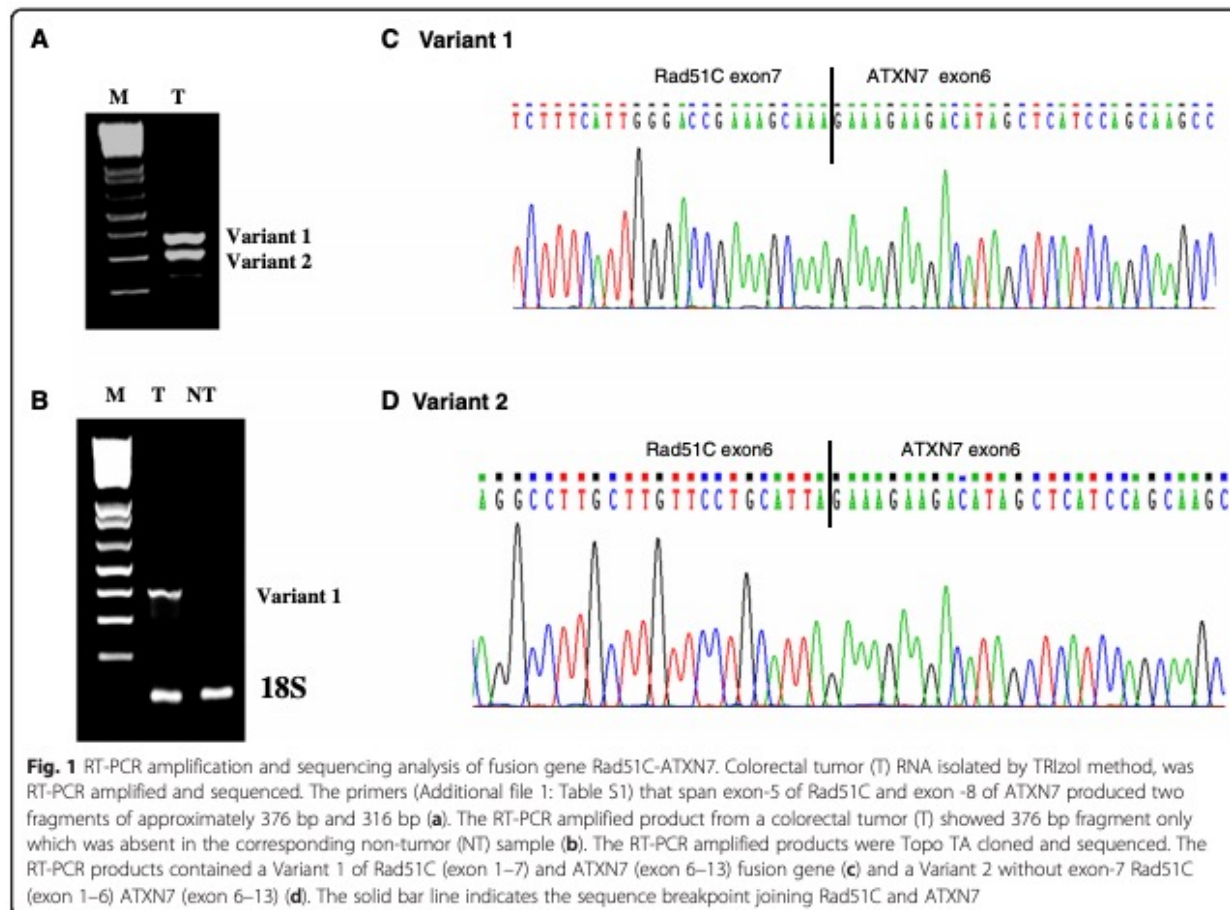
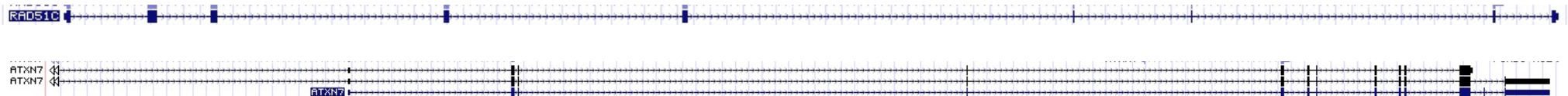


Fig. 1 RT-PCR amplification and sequencing analysis of fusion gene Rad51C-ATXN7. Colorectal tumor (T) RNA isolated by TRIzol method, was RT-PCR amplified and sequenced. The primers (Additional file 1: Table S1) that span exon-5 of Rad51C and exon -8 of ATXN7 produced two fragments of approximately 376 bp and 316 bp (a). The RT-PCR amplified product from a colorectal tumor (T) showed 376 bp fragment only which was absent in the corresponding non-tumor (NT) sample (b). The RT-PCR amplified products were Topo TA cloned and sequenced. The RT-PCR products contained a Variant 1 of Rad51C (exon 1–7) and ATXN7 (exon 6–13) fusion gene (c) and a Variant 2 without exon-7 Rad51C (exon 1–6) ATXN7 (exon 6–13) (d). The solid bar line indicates the sequence breakpoint joining Rad51C and ATXN7

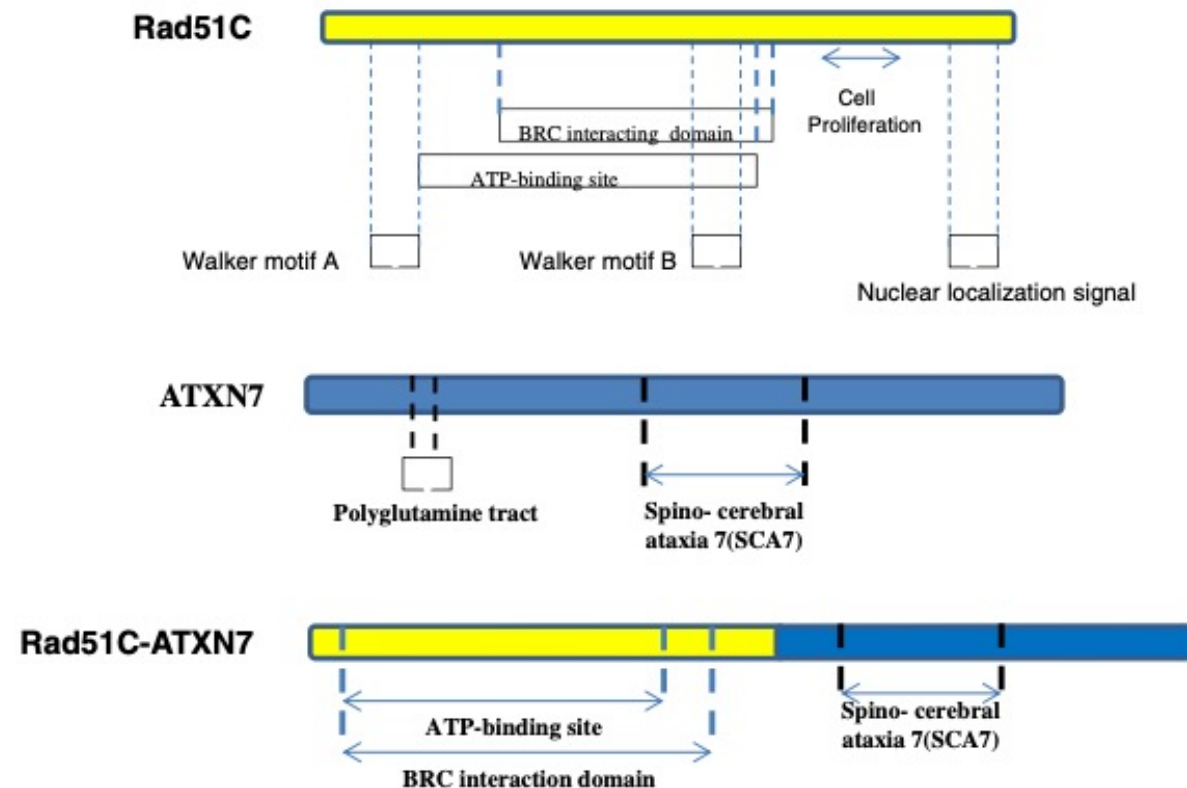


Fig. 2 Schematic representation of portion of the fusion Variant 2 of Rad51C-ATXN7. The fusion transcript and their breakpoints are indicated with exons of Rad51C and ATXN7. The Variant 2 of the fusion gene transcript is joined at 3'-end of exon-6 of Rad51C with 5'-end of the exon-6 of ATXN7. The Fusion protein has lost its nuclear localization signal located at the C-terminus end of Rad51C and CAG (Poly glutamine tract) repeat sequence of ATXN7. The ATP binding site and BRC (BRCA1) interacting domains of Rad51C are conserved at N-terminus of the fusion protein and SCA7 (Spino- cerebral ataxia 7) domain of ATXN7 conserved at middle terminus of the fusion protein

Case Report

Molecular Characterization of a Novel Splicing Mutation underlying Mucopolysaccharidosis (MPS) type VI—Indirect Proof of Principle on Its Pathogenicity

Maria Francisca Coutinho ^{1,2,†}, Marisa Encarnação ^{1,2,3,†}, Liliana Matos ^{1,2}, Lisbeth Silva ^{1,3}, Diogo Ribeiro ^{1,2}, Juliana Inês Santos ^{1,4}, Maria João Prata ^{4,5}, Laura Vilarinho ^{1,2,3} and Sandra Alves ^{1,2,*}

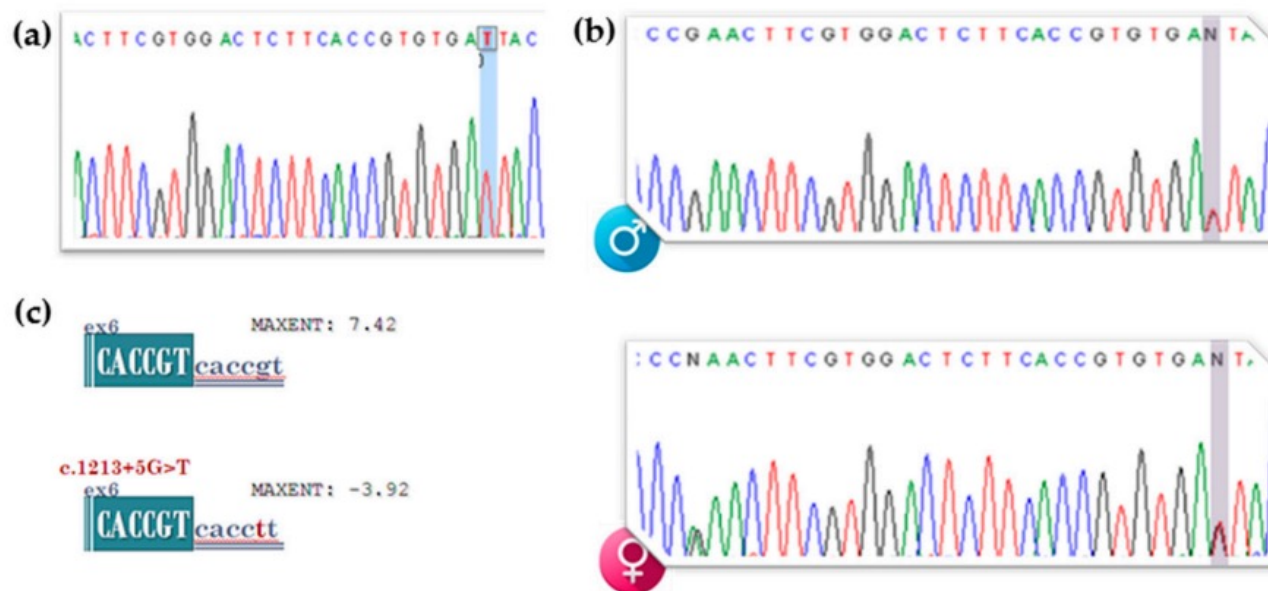


Figure 1. Molecular diagnosis of the patient by classical gDNA screening of the *ARSB* gene: detection of the novel c.1213+5G>T (IVS6+5G>T) mutation. Electropherogram highlighting the affected residue (a) in the patient and (b) parents. (c) *In silico* predictions on the effect of the novel mutation over the splice-site junctions. Score predictions by the MaxEntScan bioinformatic tool.

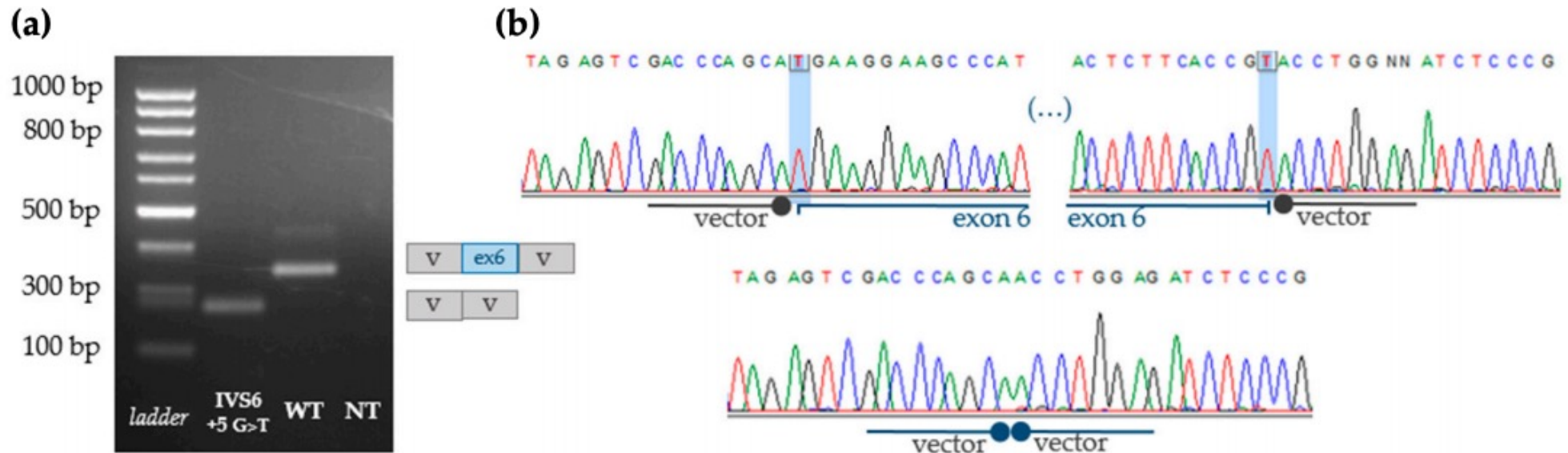
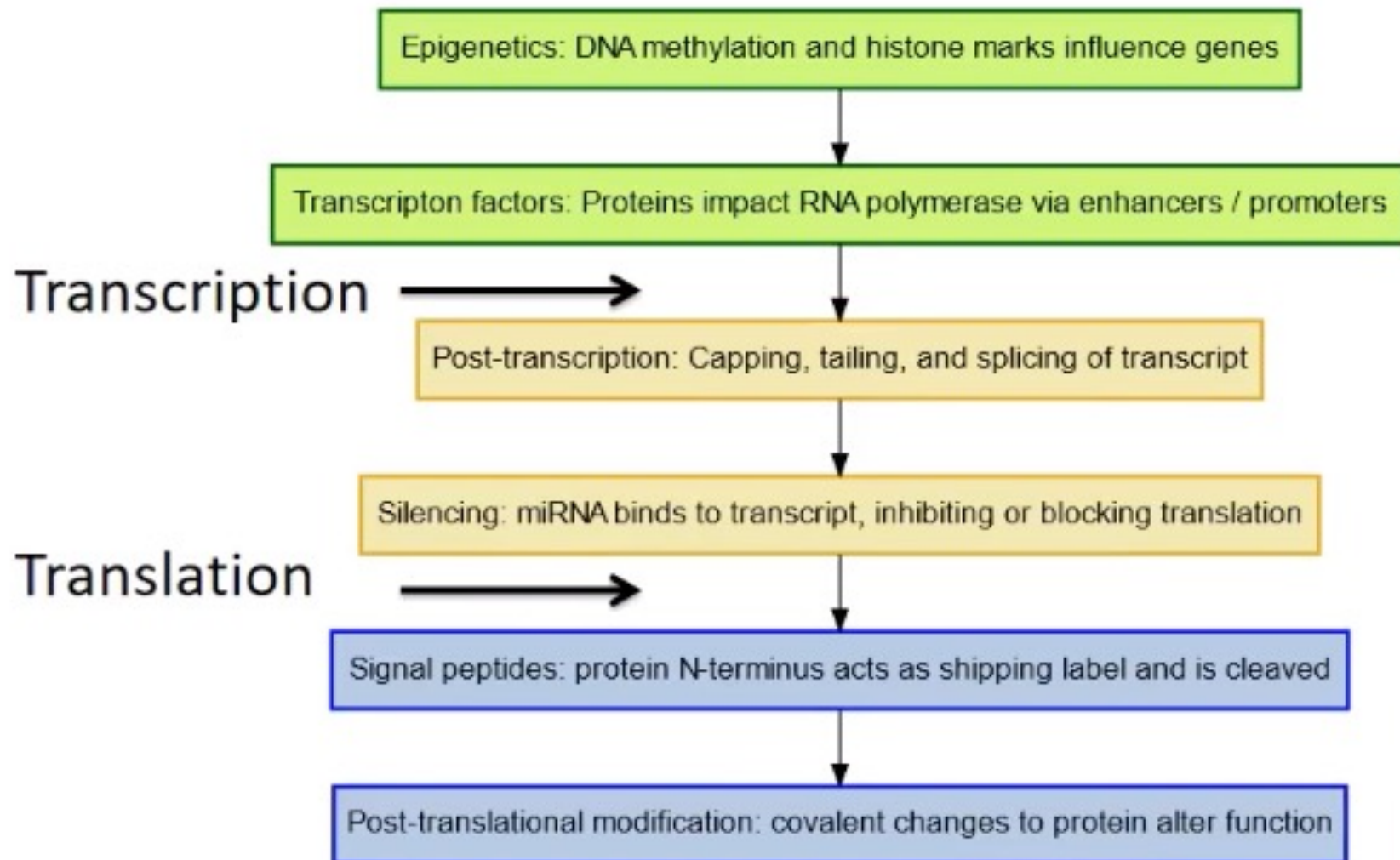
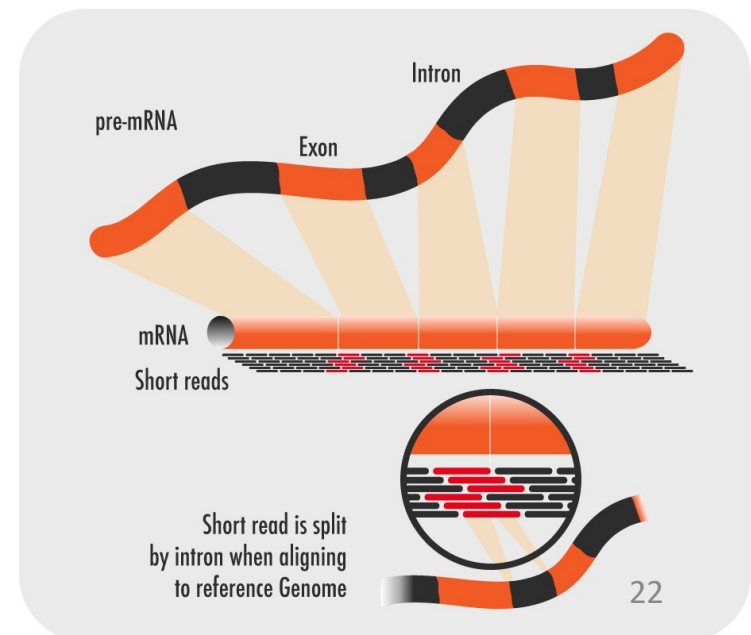
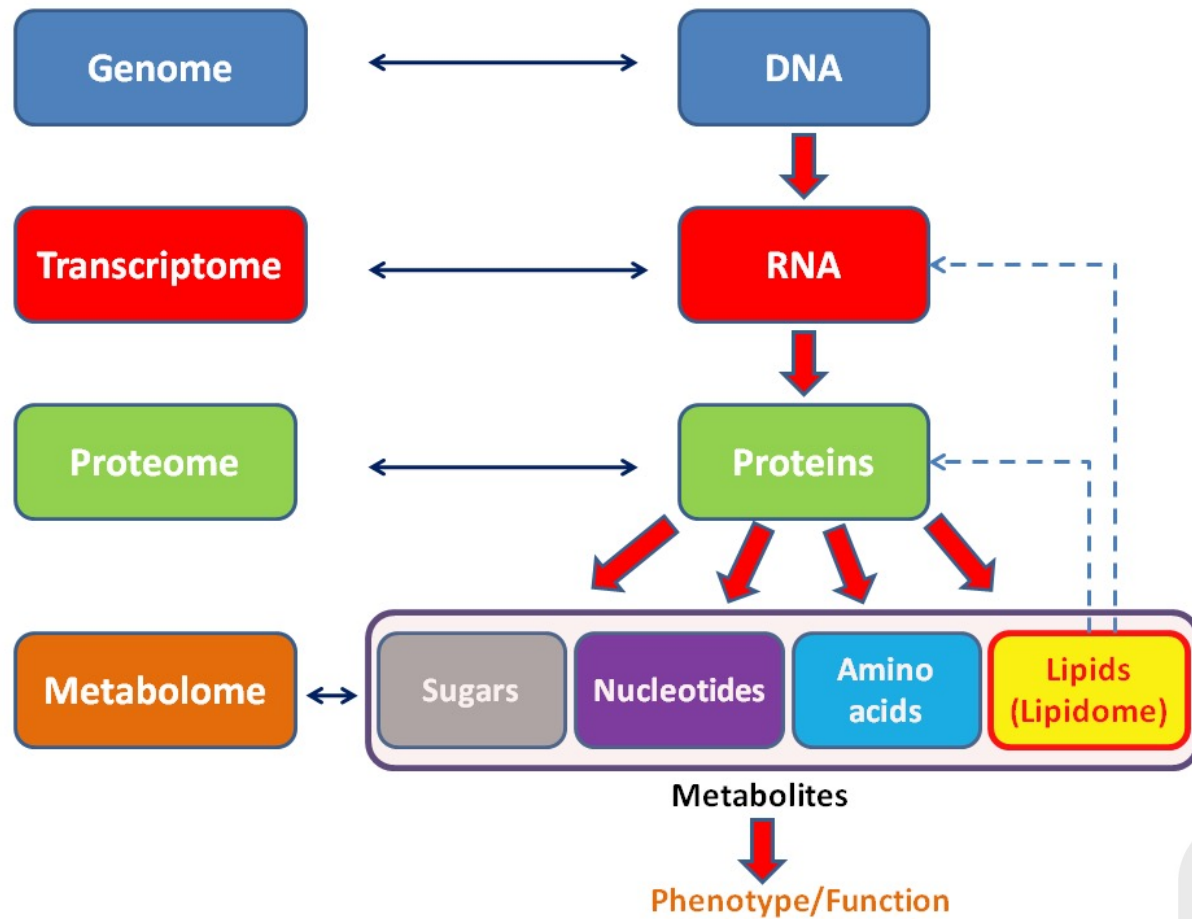
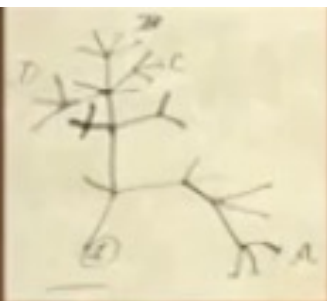


Figure 4. RT-PCR amplification and Sanger sequencing of WT and mutant splicing reporter minigenes using vector-specific primers. The results of RT-PCR analysis using vector specific primers are shown along with a diagram of the transcripts obtained in Hep3B cells after 24 h of incubation **(a)** and their sequencing results depicted in electropherograms **(b)**. c.1213+5G>T [IVS6+5G>T]: mutant minigene; WT: wild-type; NT: non-transfected.

Complex control of gene expression







Transcriptomes

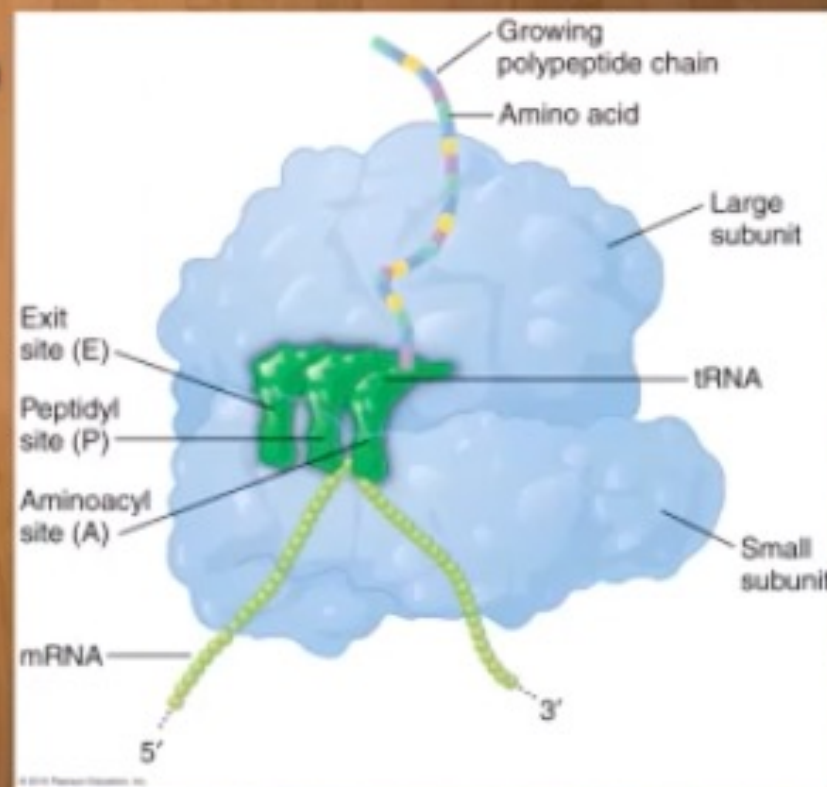
Transcriptome Sequencing

Starting material?

rRNA

tRNA

mRNA



Reverse Transcriptase

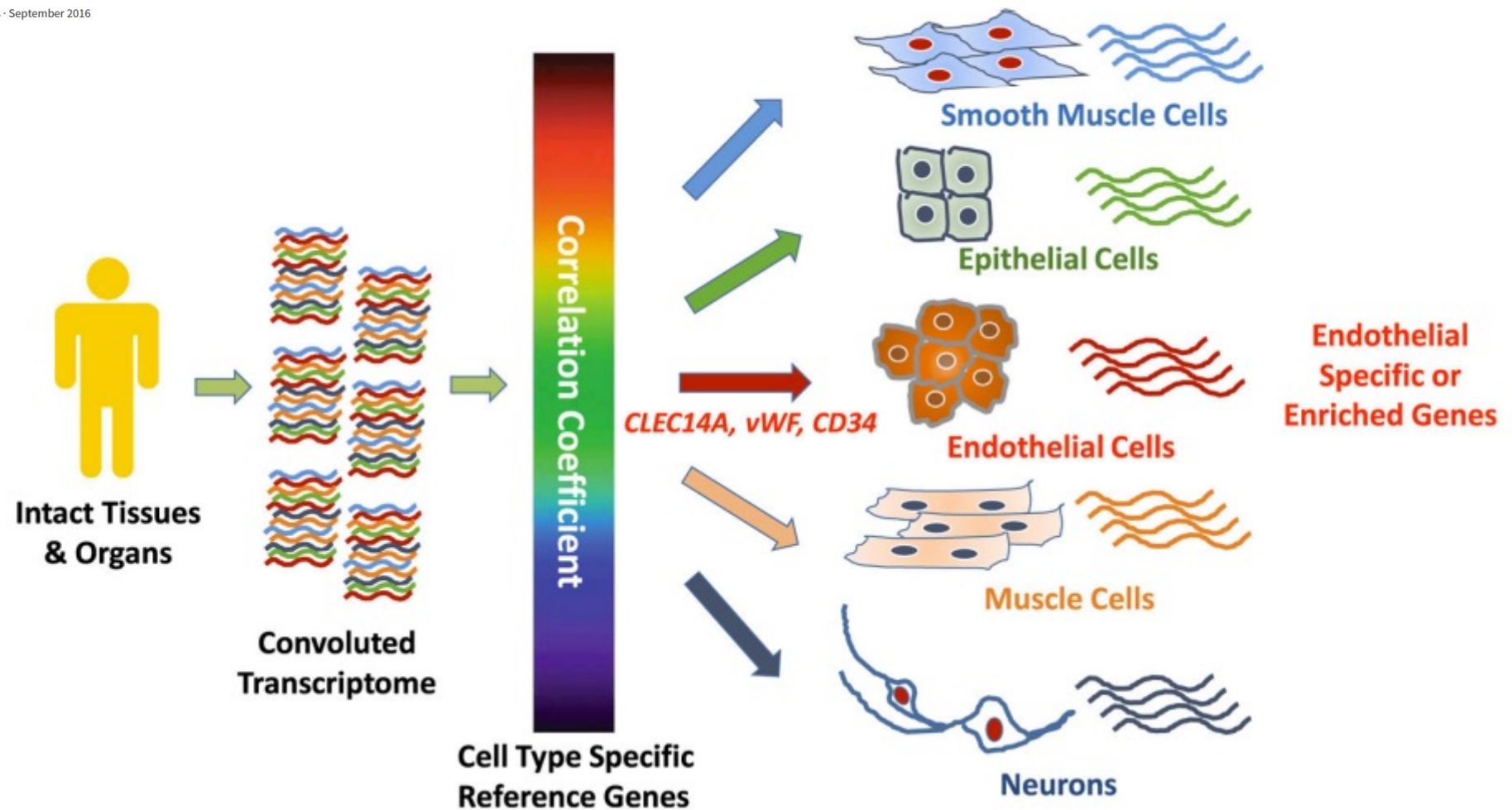


Figure 1. Reference-Gene-Based Human Transcriptome Deconvolution

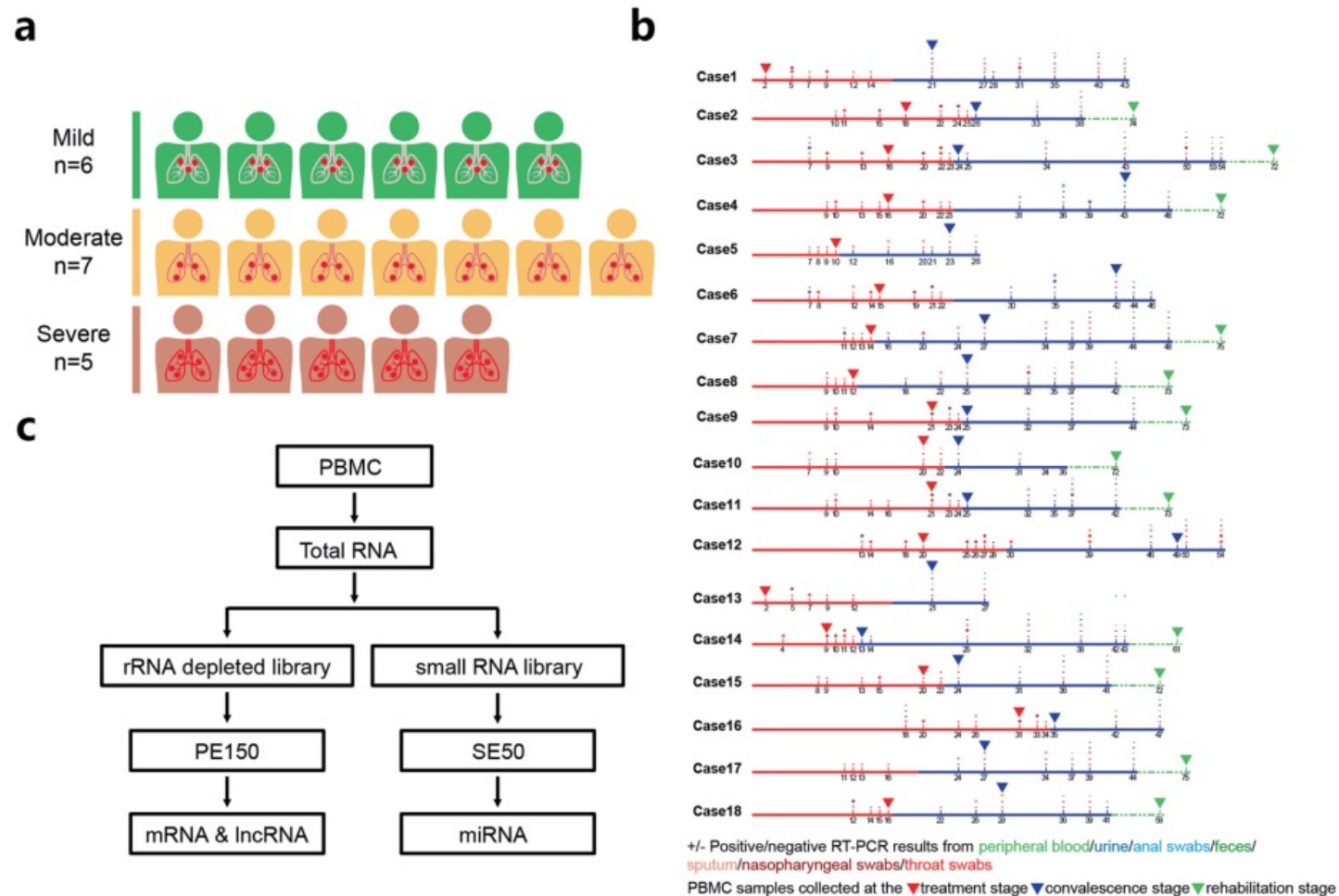
Illustration of the approach employed by Butler et al. (2016) to identify endothelial-specific or -enriched genes from unfractionated human tissues using combined correlation coefficient analysis with three endothelial-cell-specific reference genes. Other cell types are included to indicate potential applications to deconvolute the human transcriptome for other cell-type-specific genes.

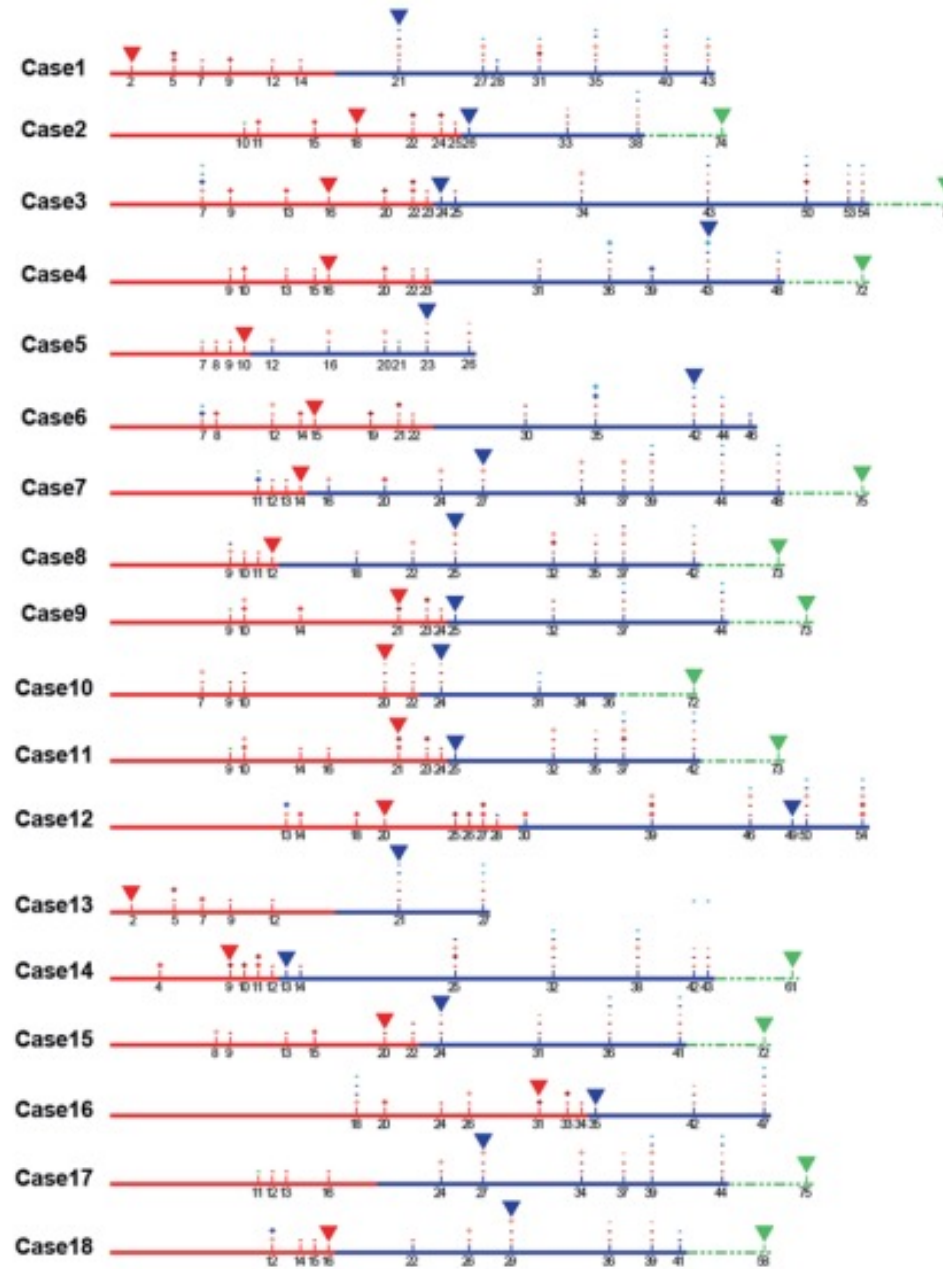
ARTICLE OPEN

Longitudinal transcriptome analyses show robust T cell immunity during recovery from COVID-19

Hong-Yi Zheng¹, Min Xu¹, Cui-Xian Yang², Ren-Rong Tian¹, Mi Zhang², Jian-Jian Li², Xi-Cheng Wang², Zhao-Li Ding³, Gui-Mei Li³, Xiao-Lu Li³, Yu-Qi He³, Xing-Qi Dong², Yong-Gang Yao^{1,4,5} and Yong-Tang Zheng^{1,4}

Fig. 1 Study design of whole transcriptome sequencing for PBMCs from patients with COVID-19 during recovery. **a** Patients are divided into mild, moderate and severe groups according to clinical symptoms of each one. **b** Timeline of the disease course of 18 patients infected with SARS-CoV-2. RT-PCR indicates the PCR test of SARS-CoV-2 nucleic acid. A positive RT-PCR (marked by "+") indicates that the SARS-CoV-2 nucleic acid was found in the throat swab, nasopharyngeal swab, sputum or other samples, which were distinguished by using different colors. "–", negative RT-PCR. The solid red lines stand for treatment stage, solid blue lines for convalescence stage and dotted green lines for rehabilitation stage. The sampling days were marked below this line. The inverted triangle symbol is used to mark the time point for collecting PBMC samples at each stage. **c** A flowchart showing the process of library construction and RNA sequencing of PBMC samples from patients with COVID-19





+/- Positive/negative RT-PCR results from peripheral blood/urine/anal swabs/feces/
sputum/nasopharyngeal swabs/throat swabs

PBMC samples collected at the ▼ treatment stage ▼ convalescence stage ▼ rehabilitation stage

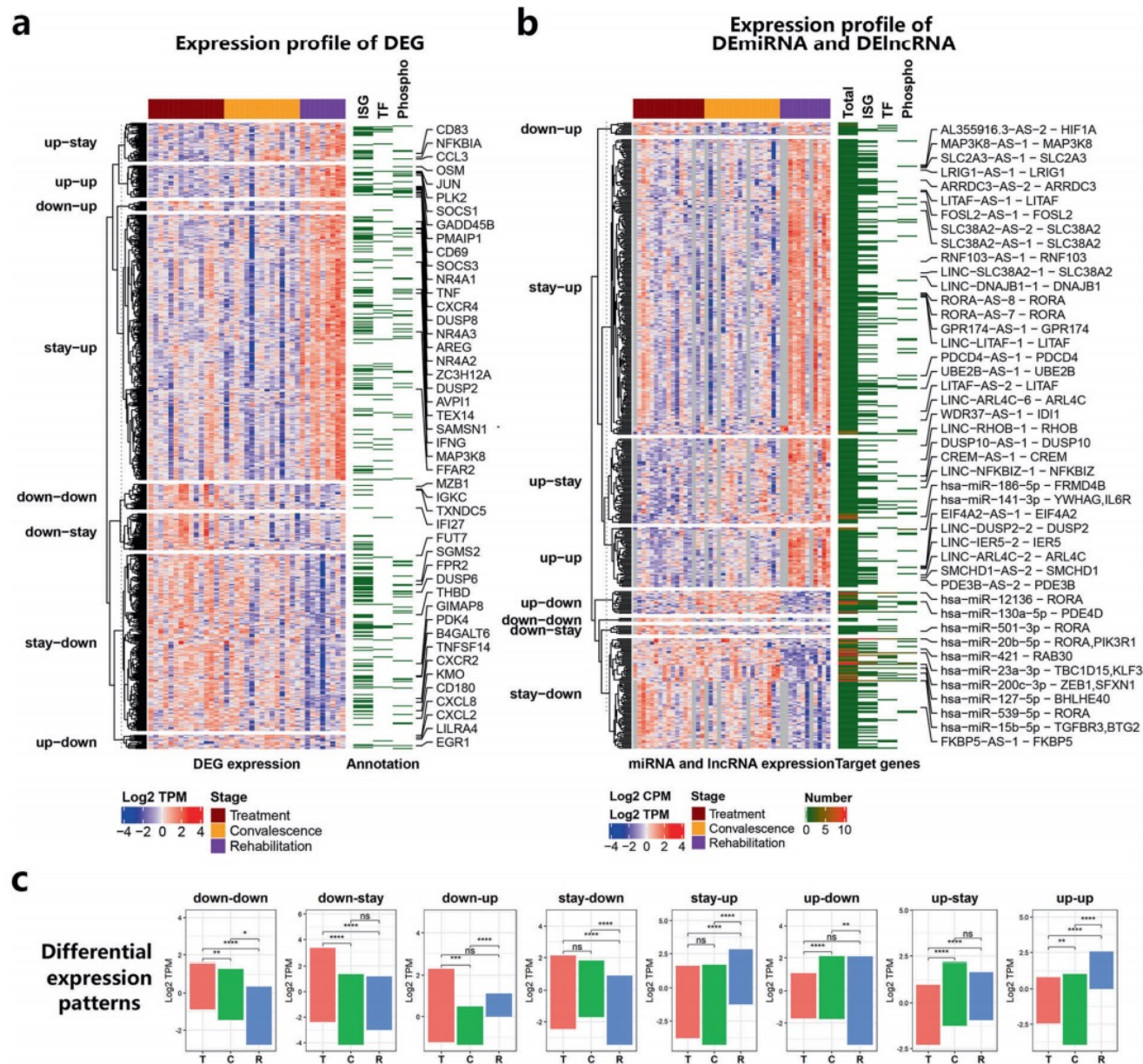
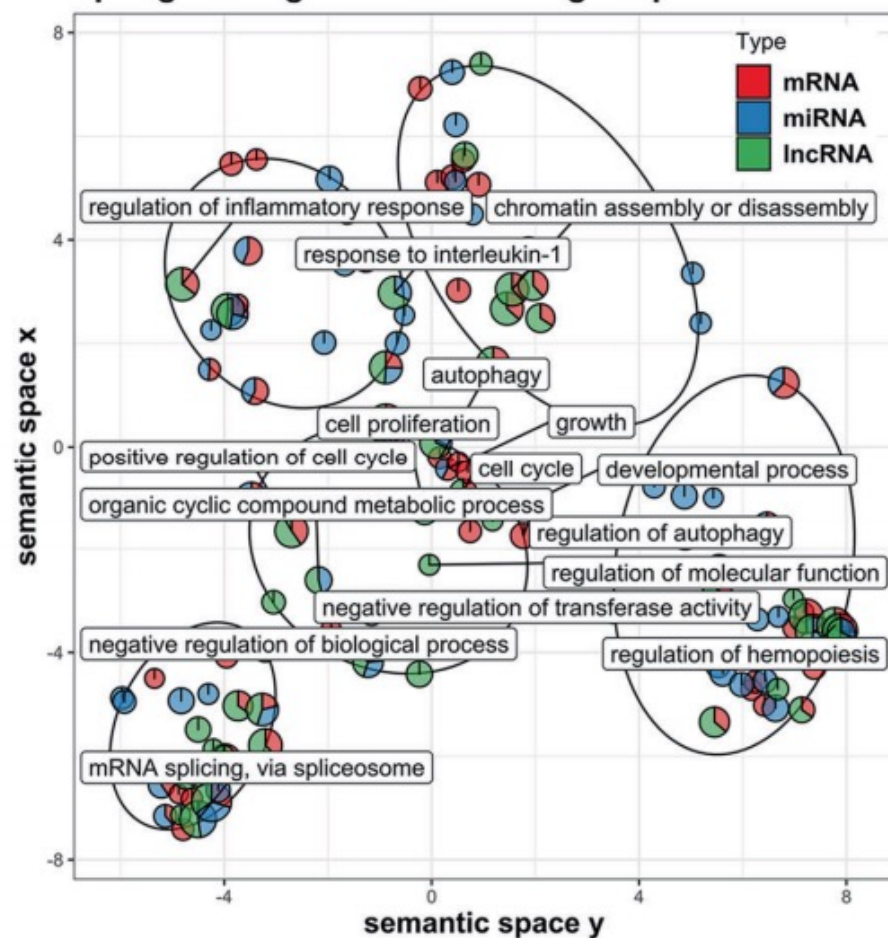


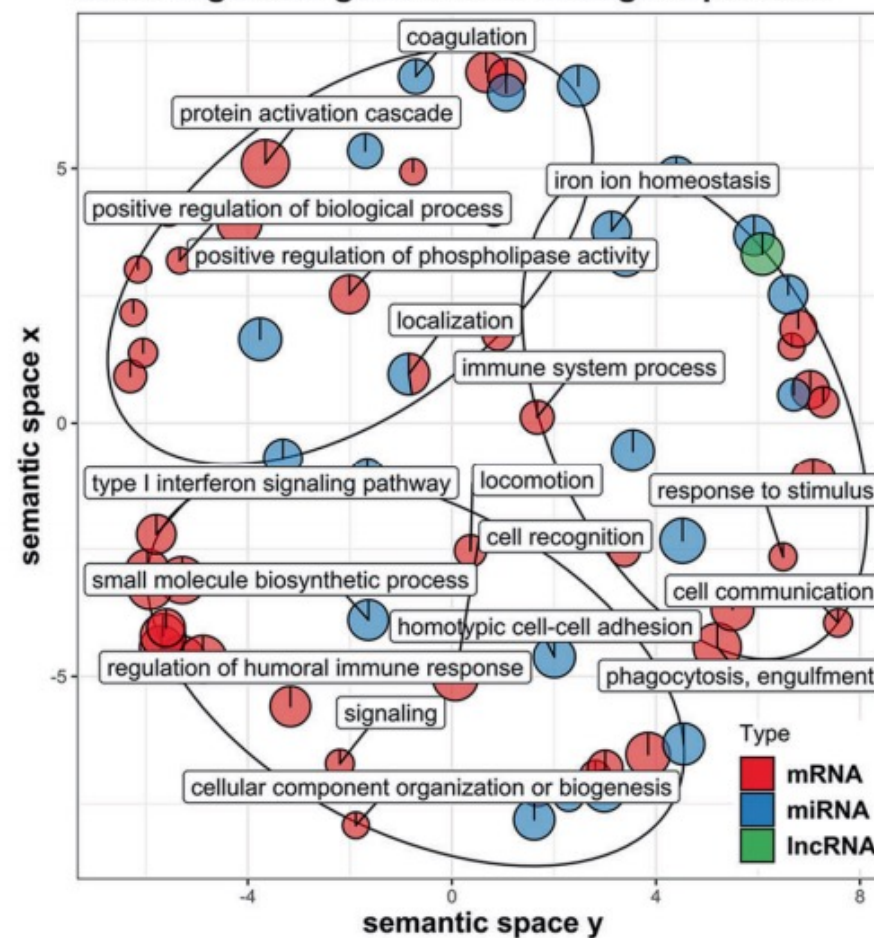
Fig. 2 Differentially expressed genes (DEG), miRNAs (DE miRNA), and lncRNAs (DE lncRNA) in PBMC samples from patients with COVID-19 during the recovery. **a** A heatmap showing the expression profiles of 643 DEGs. The blue-red gradient square maps the scaled $\log_2$ value of transcripts per kilobase million ($\log_2$ TPM) for each DEG in a sample. The grouping information on the left indicates genes with different differential expression patterns. The colored bars above the heatmap refer to the clinical stage of each sample. The gene function annotation on the right marks the interferon-stimulated genes (ISG), transcription factor (TF) and phosphorylation regulatory genes (Phospho) in DEGs. The hub genes with a more significant differential expression in the function networks constructed by all DEGs are marked with the respective gene names. **b** A heatmap showing the expression profiles of 67 DE miRNAs and 405 DE lncRNAs. The blue-red gradient square maps the scaled $\log_2$ TPM of each DE lncRNA, or the scaled $\log_2$ value of counts per million ($\log_2$ CPM) of each DE miRNA in a sample. The gene function annotation shows the number of target genes for each non-coding RNA. When the target gene is a DEG, we annotate the regulation module in the format of “non-coding RNA name - target gene name” on the right. **c** By comparing the P value and TPM/CPM at three different clinical stages, DEG, DE miRNA or DE lncRNA can be further clustered into 8 expression patterns. Each pattern reflects the characteristics of its RNAs being upregulated (up), downregulated (down) or stayed for no change (stay) at the convalescence (C) and rehabilitation (R) stages relative to the treatment (T) stage. ns, *, **, ***, ****: $p > 0.05$, ≤ 0.05 , ≤ 0.001 , ≤ 0.0001 , respectively

a

GSEA for whole transcriptome: up-regulated gene sets of biological process

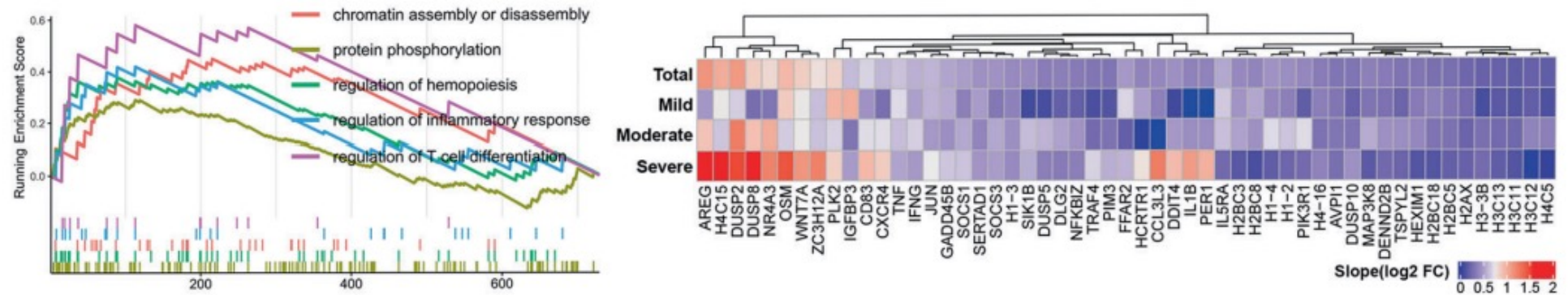


GSEA for whole transcriptome: down-regulated gene sets of biological process



b

up-regulated gene sets and their core genes



down-regulated gene sets and their core genes

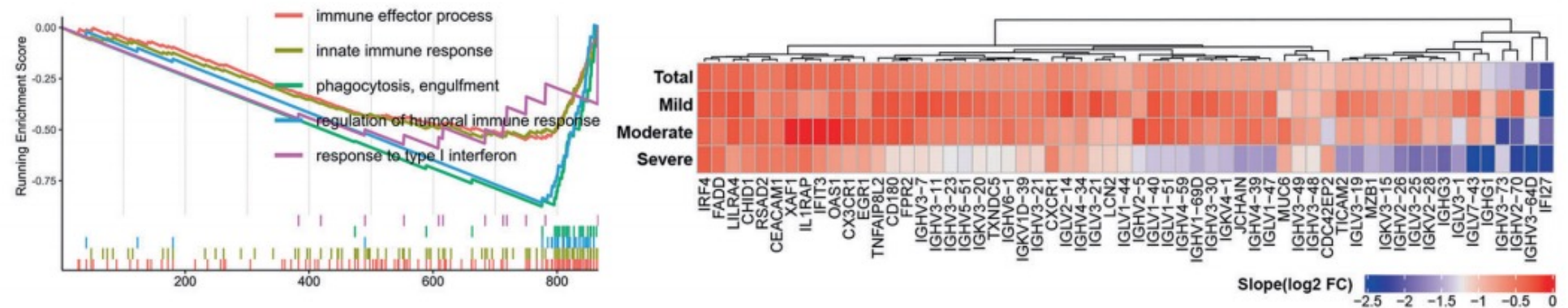


Fig. 3 Gene set enrichment analysis (GSEA) showing an immune system remodeling at the whole transcriptome level. a The bubble-pie graphs displaying upregulated and downregulated gene ontology (GO) gene sets enriched by the differentially expressed mRNAs, miRNAs, and lncRNAs. The color refers to the indicated type of transcripts enriched for a gene set. The bubble size maps the sum enrichment scores of all RNA types in a gene set. The X and Y values of a gene set are calculated by REVIGO's GO semantic space algorithm.⁶⁹ The ellipses refer to clusters formed by gene sets with a high semantic similarity. **b** GSEA plot showing the distribution of the upregulated or downregulated gene sets and the enrichment scores based on DEGs for all samples. The heatmap shows the core genes in these gene sets of different clinical stages for all samples, mild, moderate and severe groups, respectively. The blue-red gradient square maps the slope of the linear regression equation of Log2 fold change of DEG

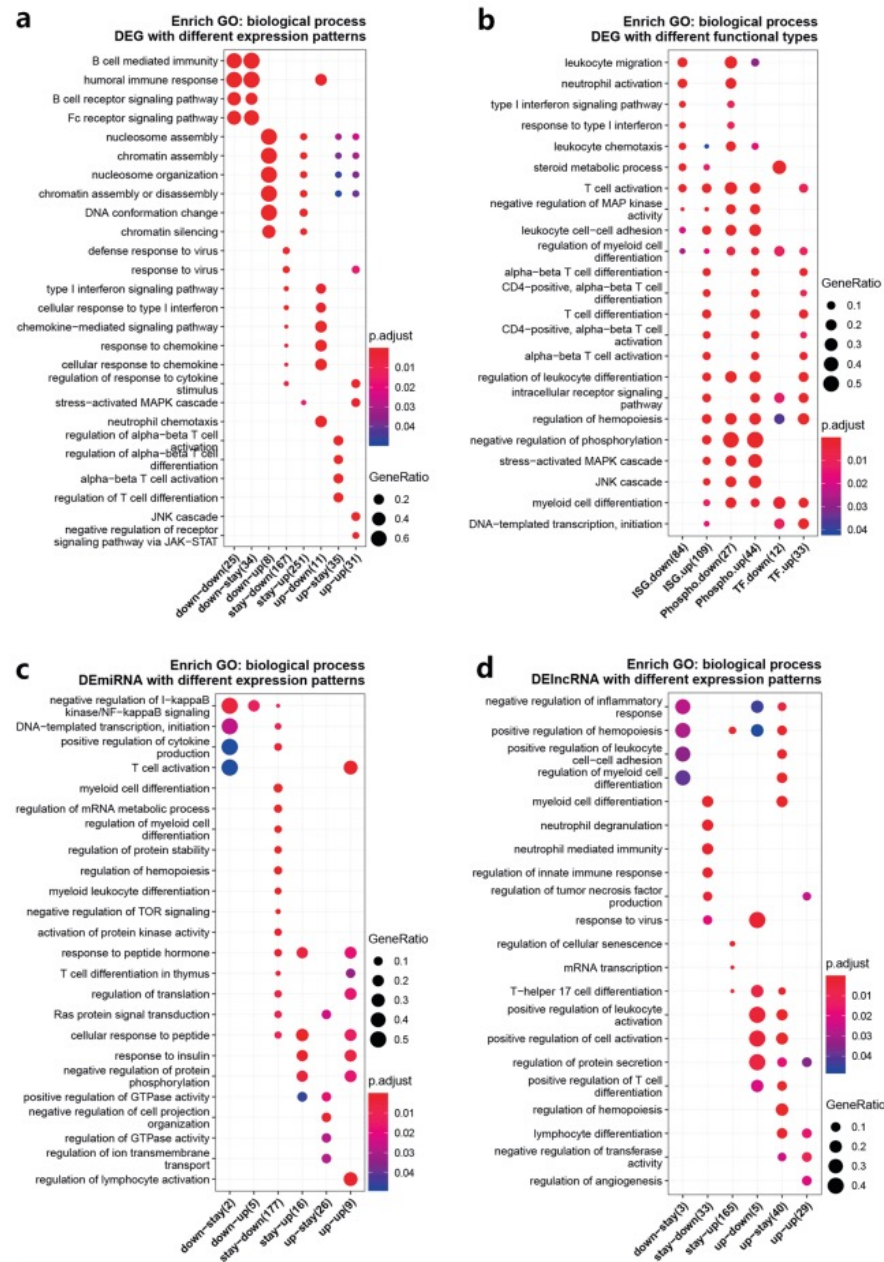
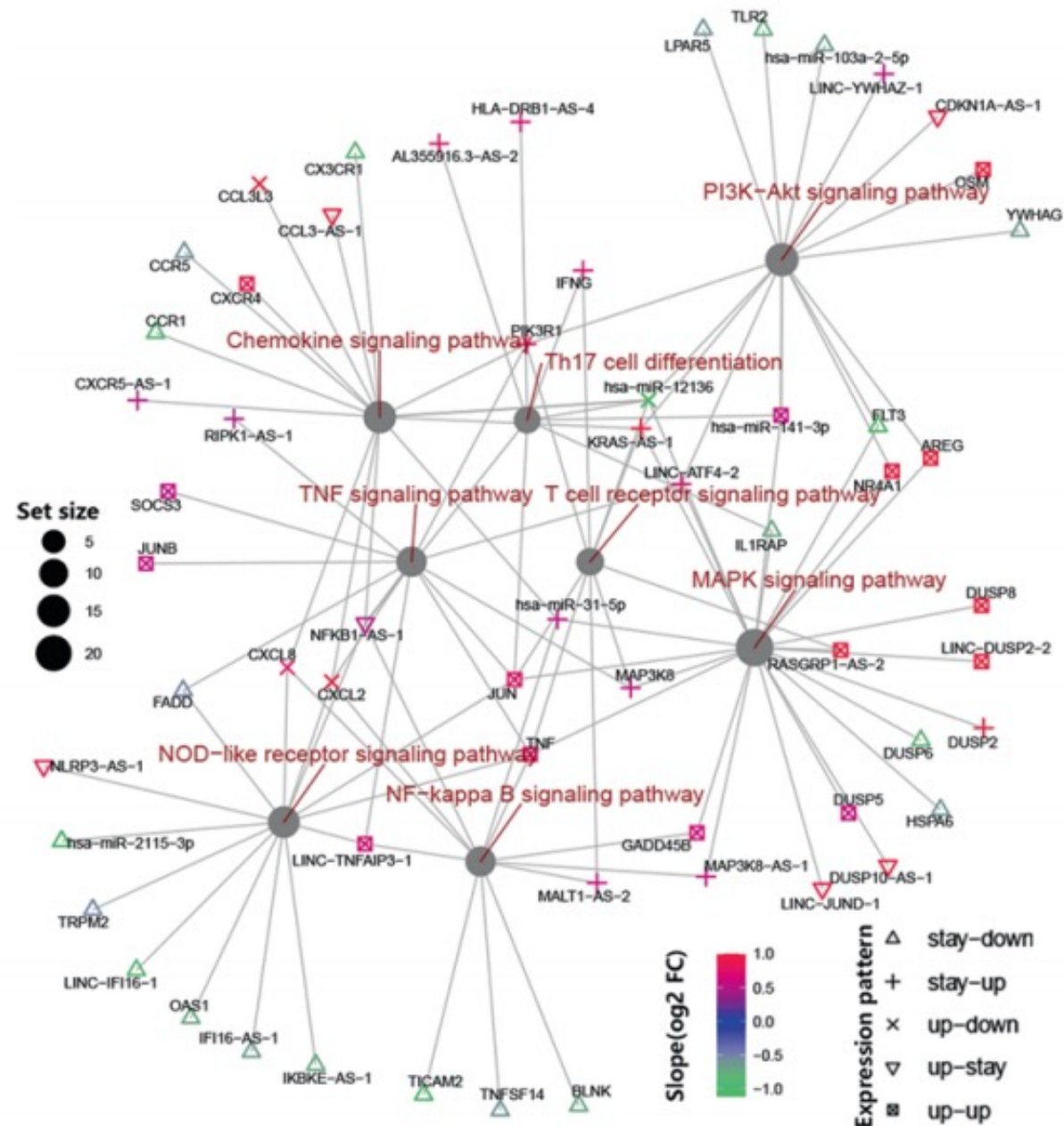


Fig. 4 Gene ontology (GO) enrichment analysis identified T cell immunity as the main regulatory target during the recovery of COVID-19. **a** GO enrichment results of DEGs in 8 differential expression clusters defined in Fig. 2b. The numbers of significantly enriched genes in each cluster were included in parentheses. **b** GO enrichment results of interferon-stimulated genes (ISG), transcription factor genes (TF), and phosphorylation regulatory genes (Phospho) in DEGs. **c**, **d** GO enrichment results of the genes targeted by DEIncRNAs (**c**) and DEIncRNAs (**d**) in 6 differential expression clusters defined in Fig. 2c. The bubble size indicates the gene enrichment ratio (Generatio) of a biological process GO term, with color maps the FDR value (p.adjust) of the enrichment analysis

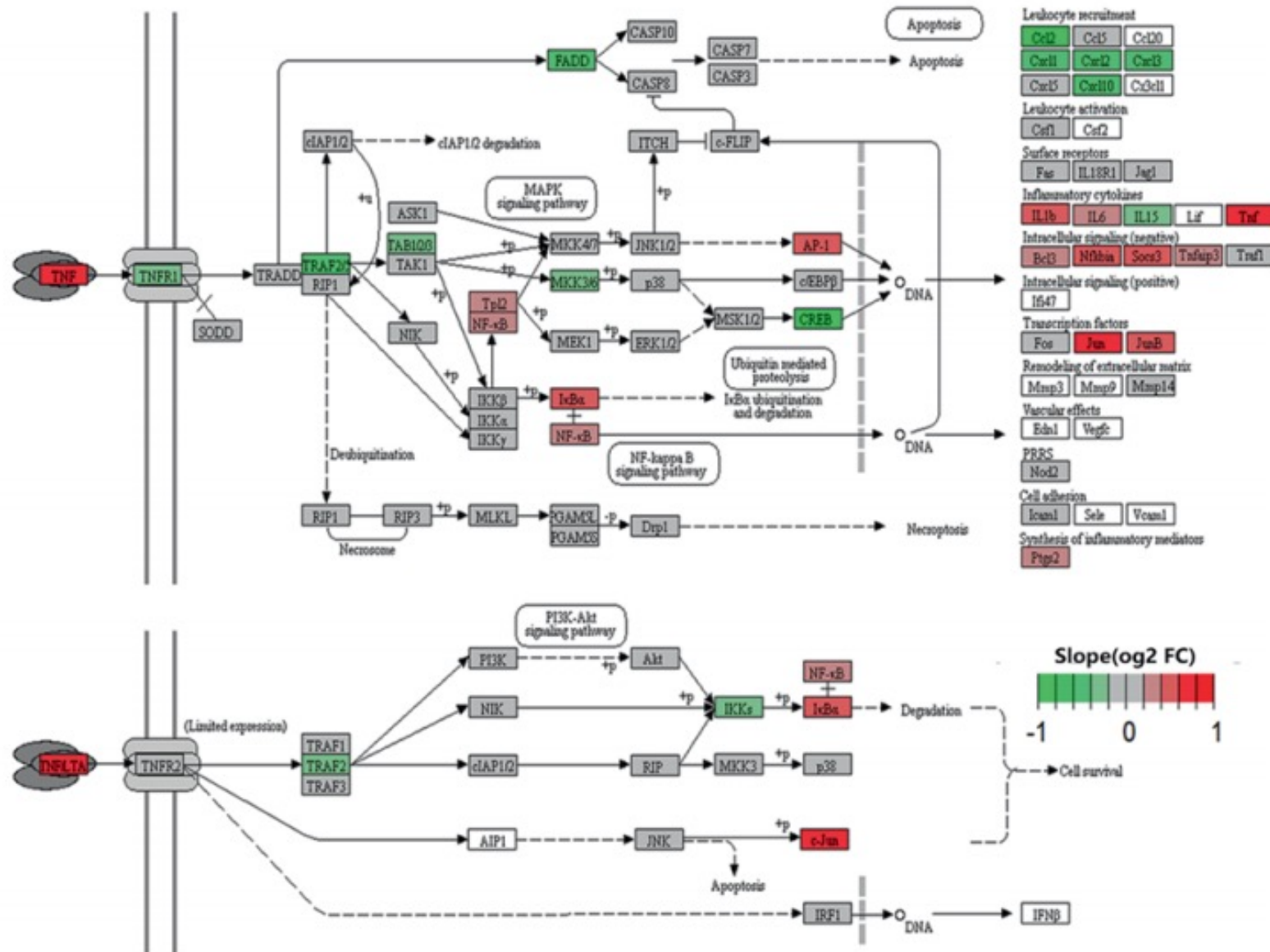
a

KEGG network of DEG, DEmiRNA and DElncRNA



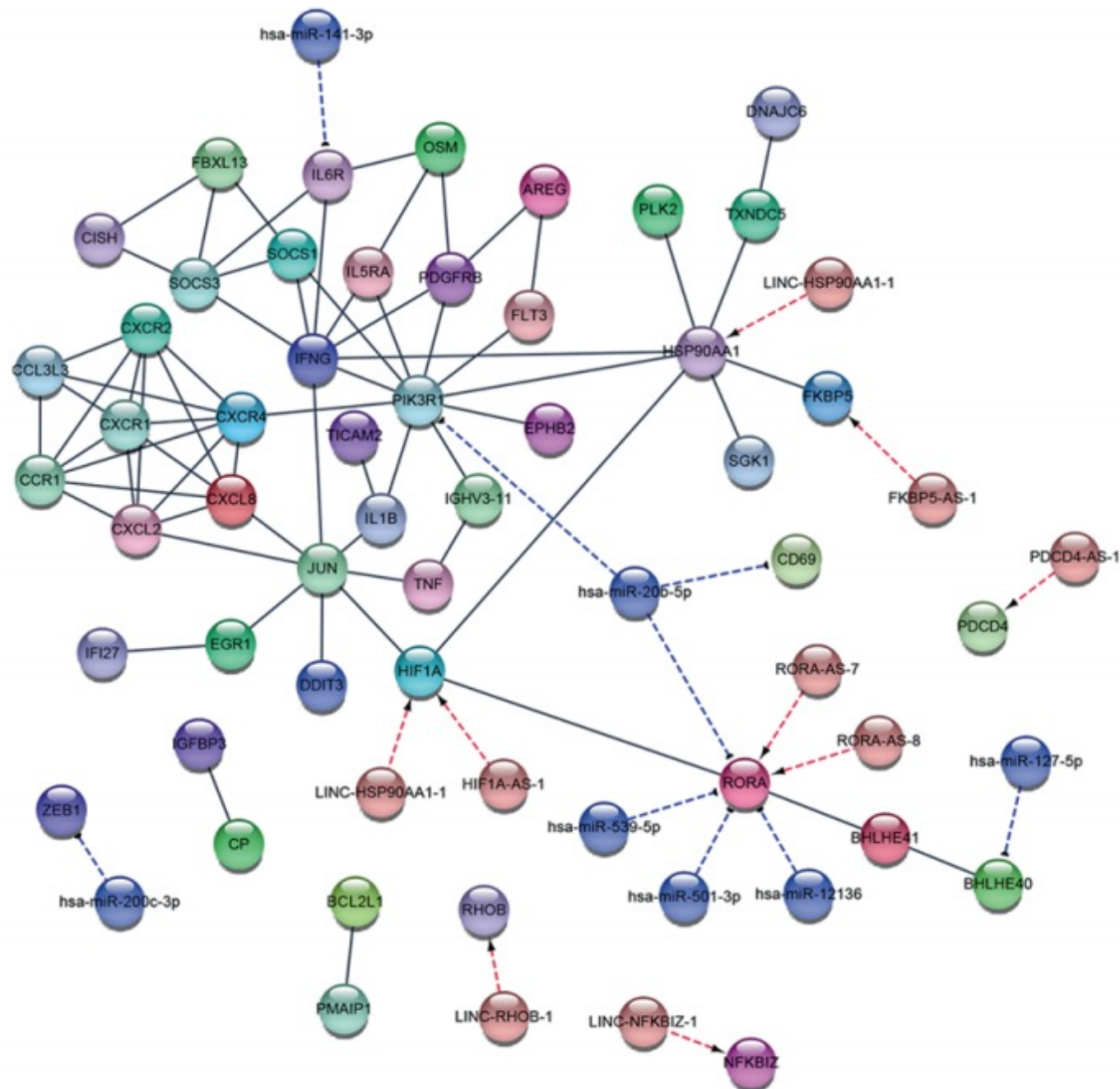
b

KEGG graph of TNF signaling pathway



C

PPI network for key DEG, DEmiRNA and DElncRNA



d

Hub nodes of PPI network

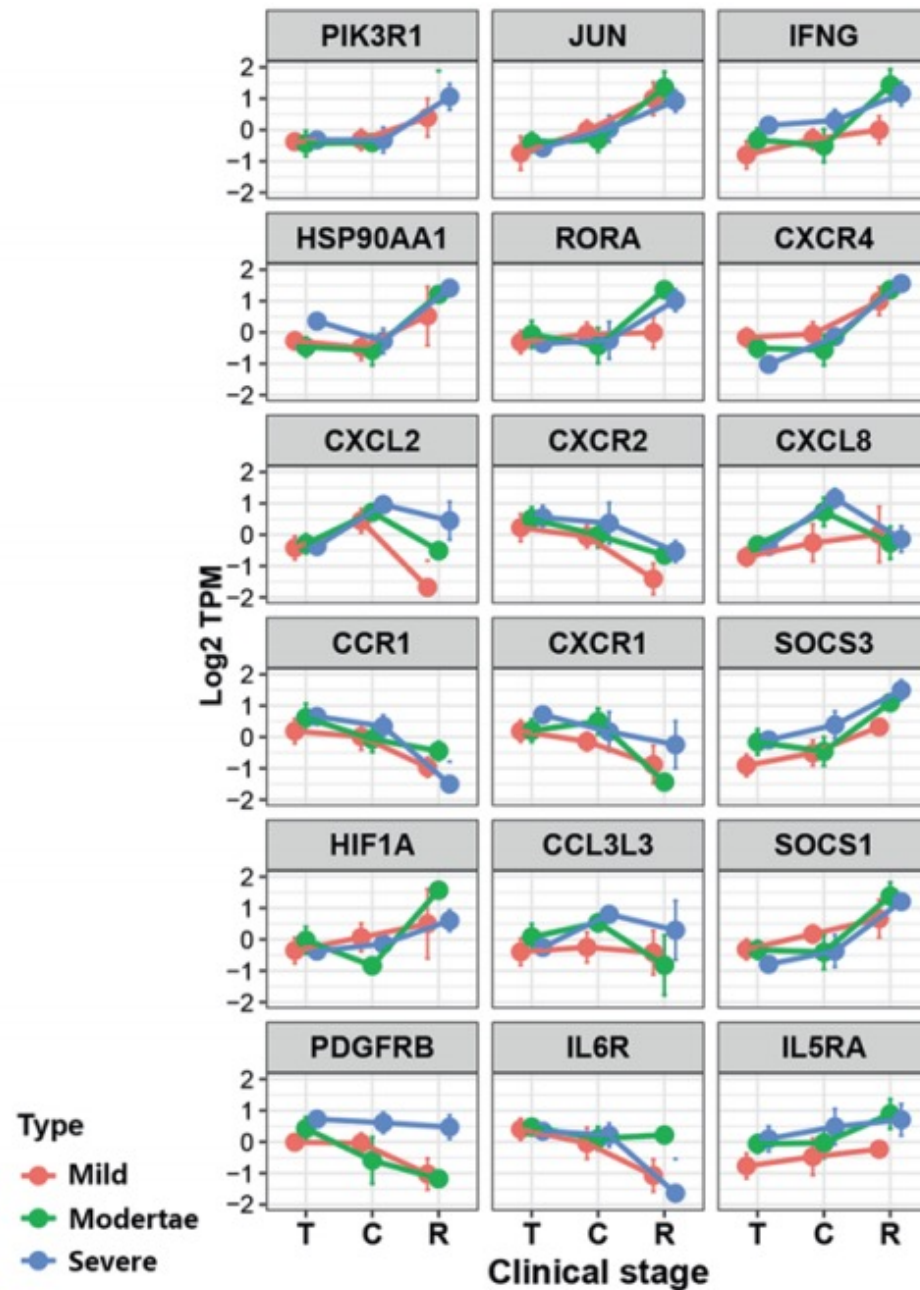
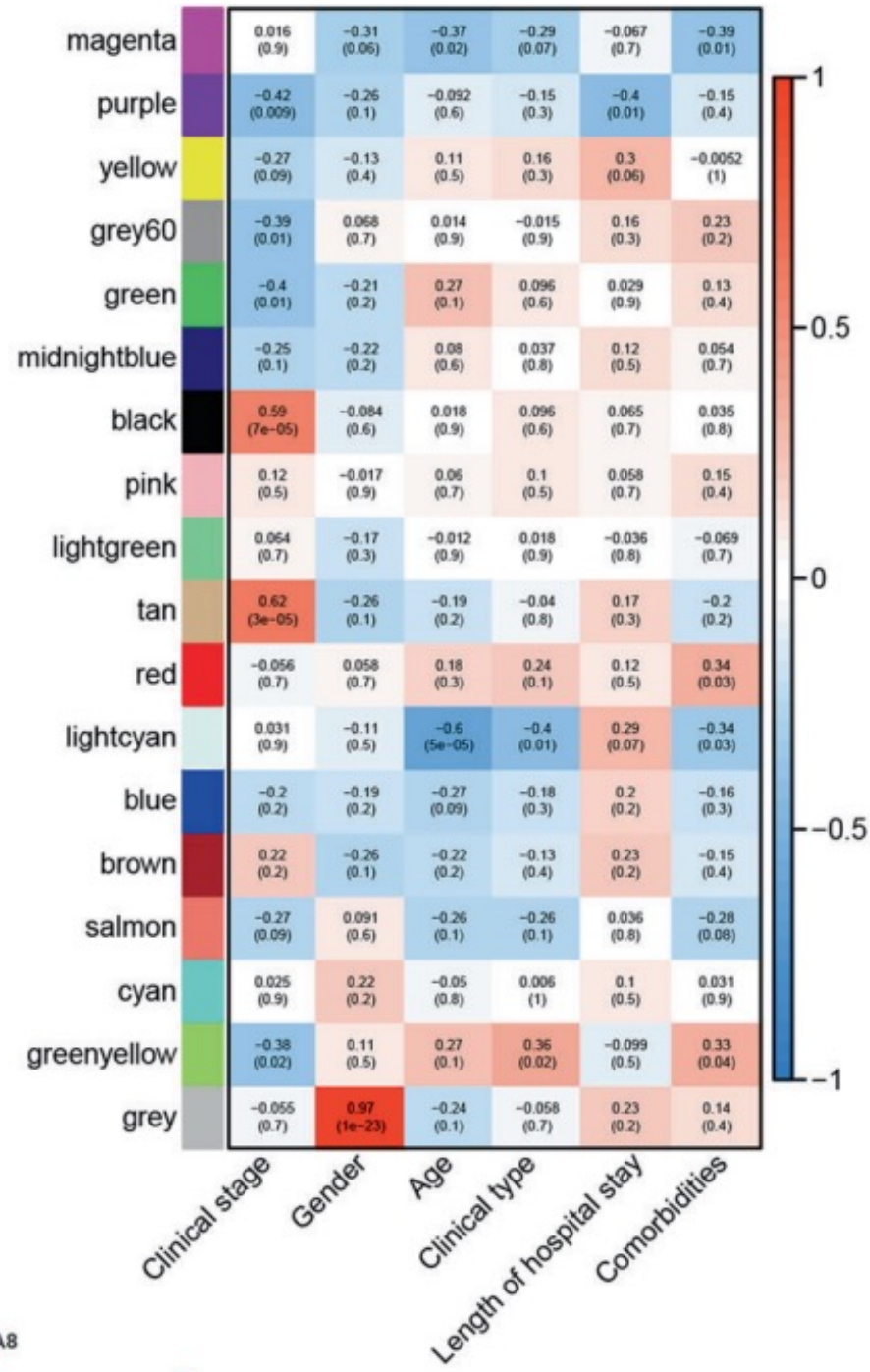
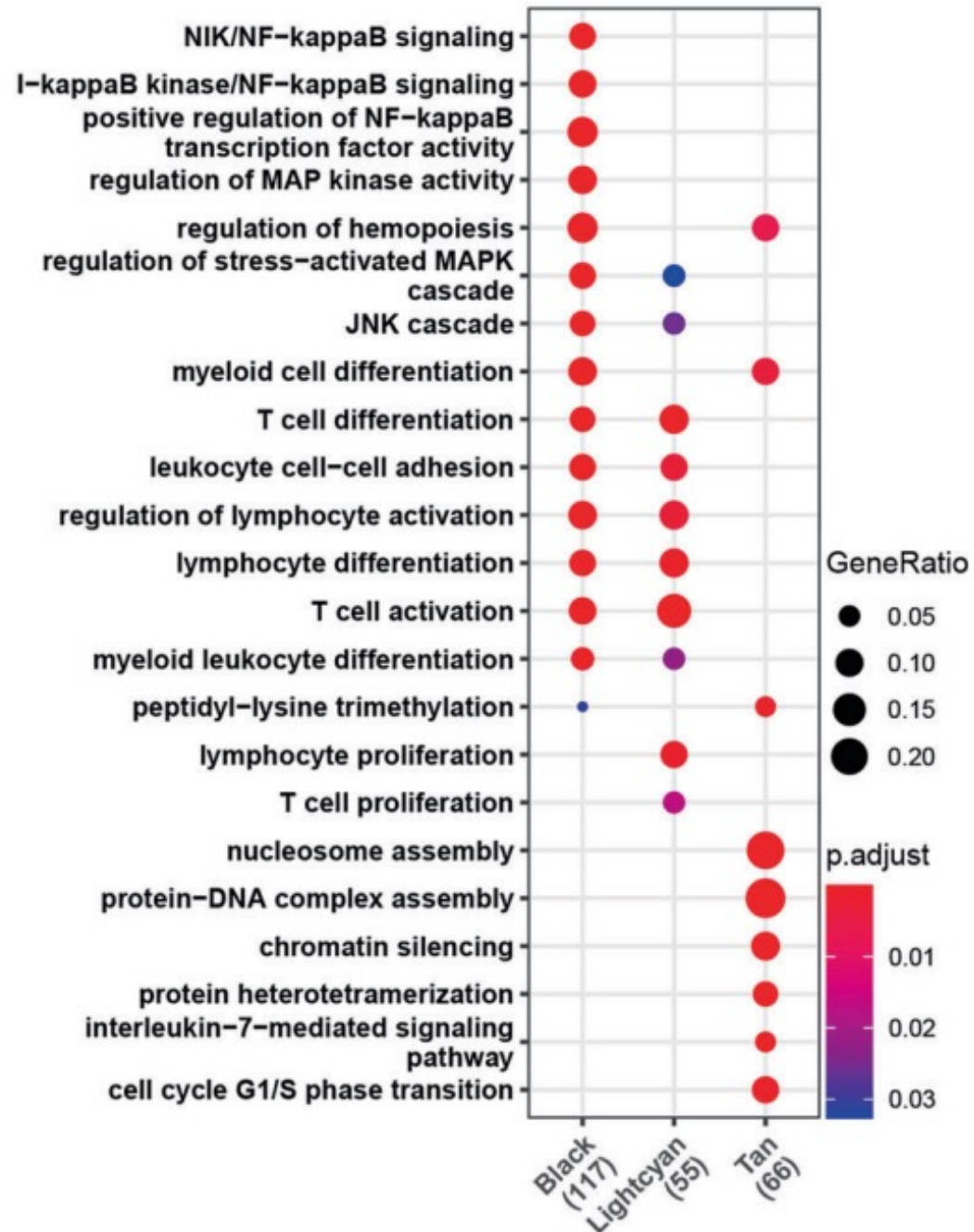


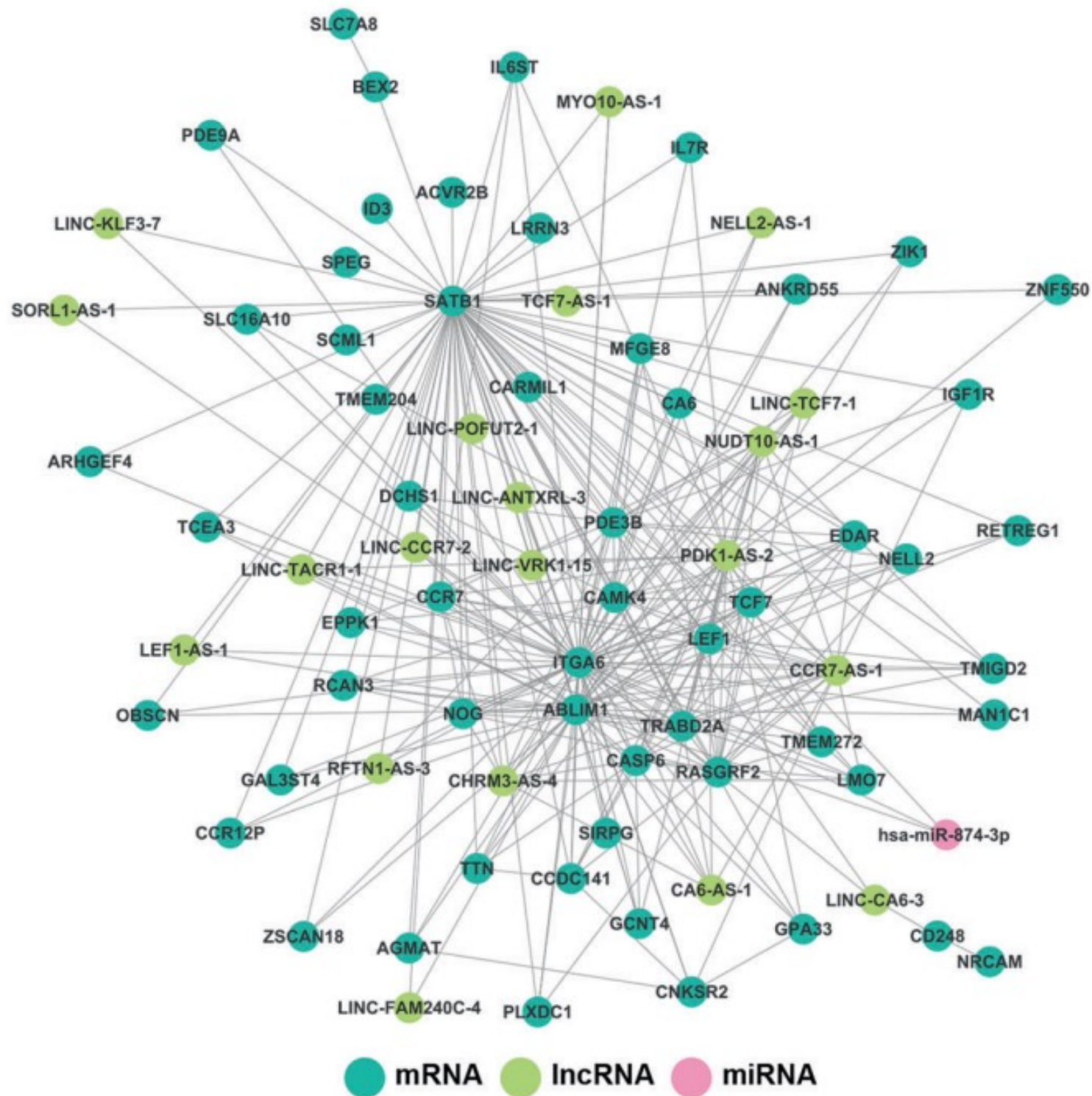
Fig. 5 Gene function network revealed a core role of the AP-1 linked signaling pathways during the recovery of COVID-19. **a** A network showing the relationship between genes and enriched KEGG pathway. The genes displayed are selected from the DEGs and the genes regulated by DE miRNAs or DE lncRNAs with a more significant differential expression and a higher connectivity. The color maps the linear regression slope of Log₂ fold change of a gene. The size of the circle is proportional to the number of genes enriched in a KEGG pathway. **b** A KEGG graph showing the interactions of genes involved in the TNF signaling pathway. The color indicates linear regression slope of Log₂ fold change of a gene. **c** A protein-protein interaction network (PPI) showing the interactions between genes and non-coding RNA. The genes displayed are selected from the top hub genes with the most significant differential expression. **d** A line graph showing the expression profiles of the main hub genes during COVID-19 recovery. The color indicates samples with different clinical types: T, treatment stage; C, convalescence stage; R, rehabilitation stage. The data are shown as mean $\pm$ SD.

b



C





The developmental transcriptome of *Drosophila melanogaster*

Brenton R. Graveley^{1*}, Angela N. Brooks^{2*}, Joseph W. Carlson^{3*}, Michael O. Duff^{1*}, Jane M. Landolin^{3*}, Li Yang^{1*}, Carlo G. Artieri⁴, Marijke J. van Baren⁵, Nathan Boley⁶, Benjamin W. Booth³, James B. Brown⁶, Lucy Cherbas⁷, Carrie A. Davis⁸, Alex Dobin⁸, Renhua Li⁴, Wei Lin⁸, John H. Malone⁴, Nicolas R. Mattiuzzo⁴, David Miller⁹, David Sturgill⁴, Brian B. Tuch^{10,11}, Chris Zaleski⁸, Dayu Zhang⁷, Marco Blanchette^{12,13}, Sandrine Dudoit¹⁴, Brian Eads⁹, Richard E. Green¹⁵, Ann Hammonds³, Lichun Jiang⁴, Phil Kapranov⁸, Laura Langton⁵, Norbert Perrimon¹⁶, Jeremy E. Sandler³, Kenneth H. Wan³, Aaron Willingham¹⁷, Yu Zhang⁴, Yi Zou⁷, Justen Andrews⁹, Peter J. Bickel⁶, Steven E. Brenner^{2,17}, Michael R. Brent⁵, Peter Cherbas^{7,9}, Thomas R. Gingeras^{8,18}, Roger A. Hoskins³, Thomas C. Kaufman⁹, Brian Oliver⁴ & Susan E. Celniker³

Drosophila melanogaster is one of the most well studied genetic model organisms; nonetheless, its genome still contains unannotated coding and non-coding genes, transcripts, exons and RNA editing sites. Full discovery and annotation are pre-requisites for understanding how the regulation of transcription, splicing and RNA editing directs the development of this complex organism. Here we used RNA-Seq, tiling microarrays and cDNA sequencing to explore the transcriptome in 30 distinct developmental stages. We identified 111,195 new elements, including thousands of genes, coding and non-coding transcripts, exons, splicing and editing events, and inferred protein isoforms that previously eluded discovery using established experimental, prediction and conservation-based approaches. These data substantially expand the number of known transcribed elements in the *Drosophila* genome and provide a high-resolution view of transcriptome dynamics throughout development.

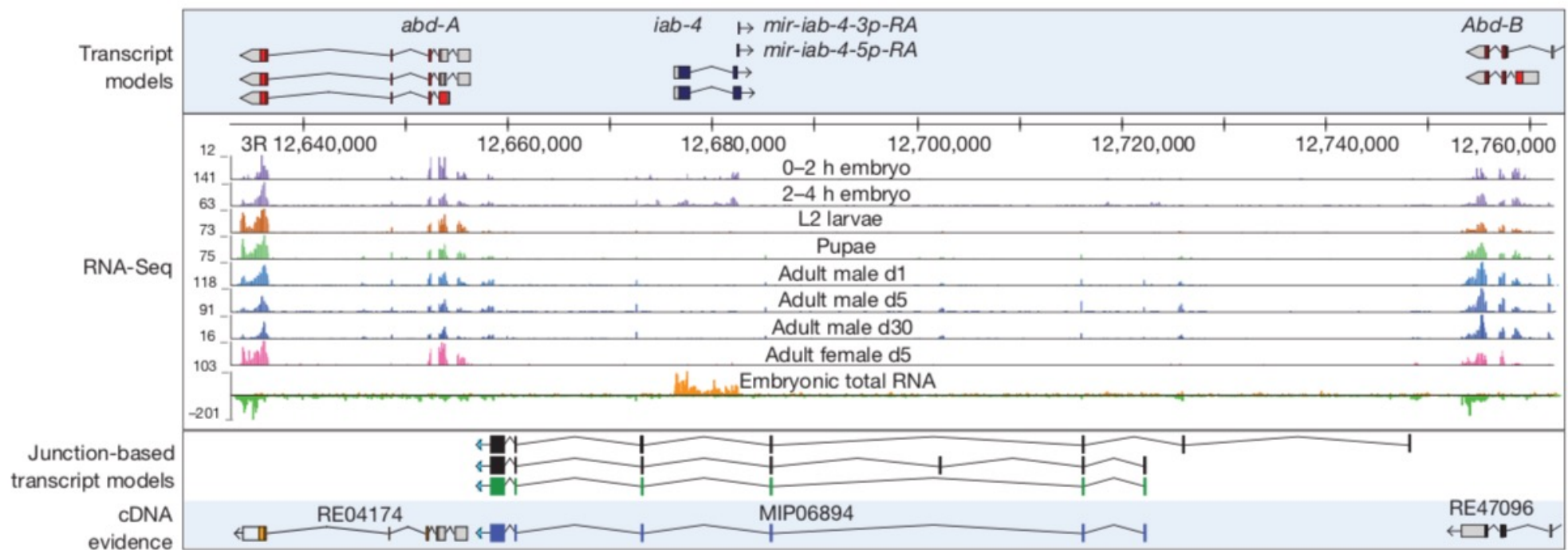


Figure 1 | Discovery of new RNAs in the Bithorax complex. Genomic organization and experimental evidence for new transcripts located between the HOX genes, *abd-A* and *Abd-B*, based on short poly(A)⁺ RNA and total RNA-Seq expression profiles. The numbers to the left of each track indicate the

maximal number of reads for that sample. Three manually curated junction-based transcript models are shown; the green transcript model was fully validated by a cDNA, MIP06894.

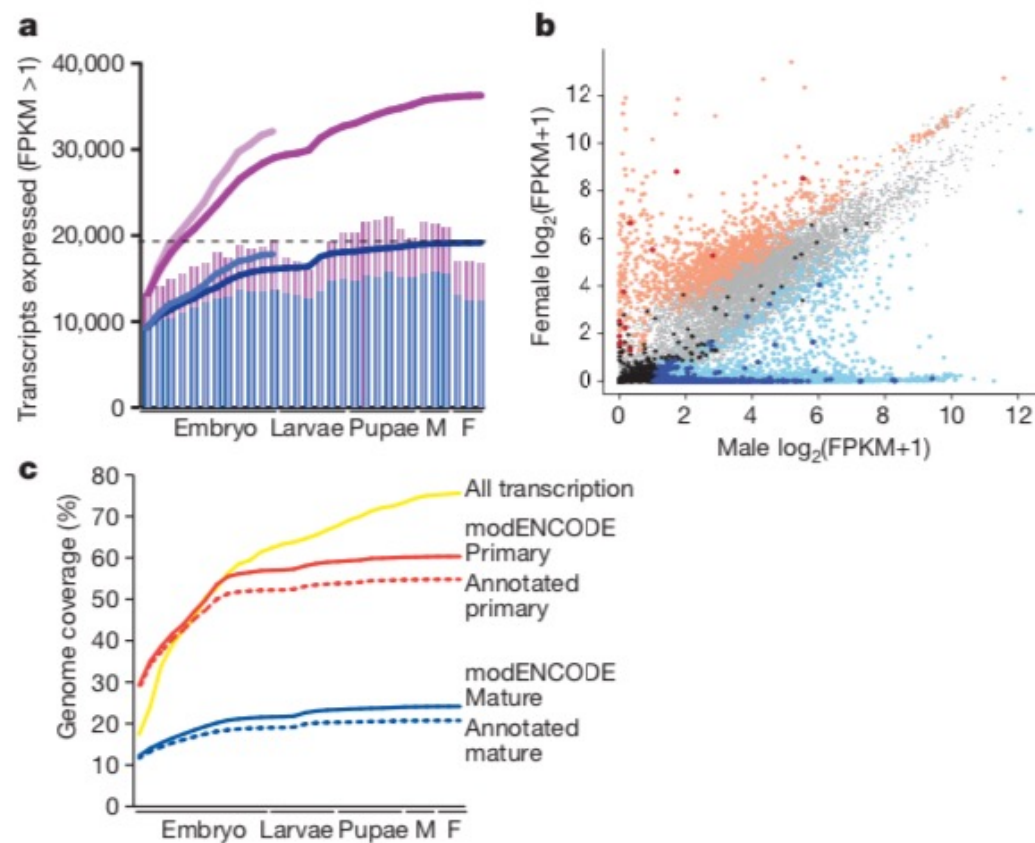


Figure 3 | Dynamics of gene expression. **a**, Transcripts expressed (FPKM > 1) in the short poly(A)⁺ RNA-Seq data: FlyBase 5.12, blue; modENCODE, purple. The bar graphs indicate the number of transcripts expressed in each sample (Supplementary Table 1); the lines indicate the cumulative number of expressed transcripts. The lighter blue and purple lines indicate the cumulative number of transcripts expressed in the embryonic total RNA-Seq samples. The horizontal dotted lines indicate the number of expressed previously annotated transcripts. F, female; M, male. **b**, Scatter plot of sex-biased gene expression. Light red, female-biased annotated ($n = 960$); dark red, female-biased NTRs ($n = 12$); light blue, male-biased annotated ($n = 2,401$); dark blue, male-biased NTRs ($n = 431$); light grey, unbiased annotated ($n = 8,217$); black, unbiased NTRs ($n = 136$). **c**, Genome coverage. For each developmental sample, the short poly(A)⁺ reads were used to estimate the percentage of the genome covered using a cutoff of two reads. The mature and primary transcripts were inferred for the previously FlyBase 5.12 (dotted lines) and modENCODE (solid lines) gene models.

Table 1 | Classification of alternative splicing events

Splicing event	Diagram	FlyBase r5.12	modENCODE	New events	Short poly(A) ⁺ RNA-Seq	Significantly changing
Cassette exons		793	2,717	2,014	2,369	1,539
Alternative 5' splice sites		843	5,192	4,599	4,583	3,142
Alternative 3' splice sites		879	6,253	5,505	5,579	3,242
Mutually exclusive exons		229	251	123	228	226
Coordinate cassette exons		301	1,227	979	992	467
Alternative first exons		1,767	4,936	3,442	4,473	3,996
Alternative last exons		227	604	432	553	471
Retained/unprocessed introns		1,434	2,679 (5,667)	1,275 (4,263)	2,439 (35,641)	868 (8,998)
Total		6,437	23,859 (26,847)	18,369 (21,478)	21,216 (54,418)	13,951 (22,081)

The number of retained/unprocessed introns in parentheses indicates the total number identified, whereas the number not in parentheses indicates the subset of identified events that have been validated by cDNA sequences or FlyBase 5.12 annotations.

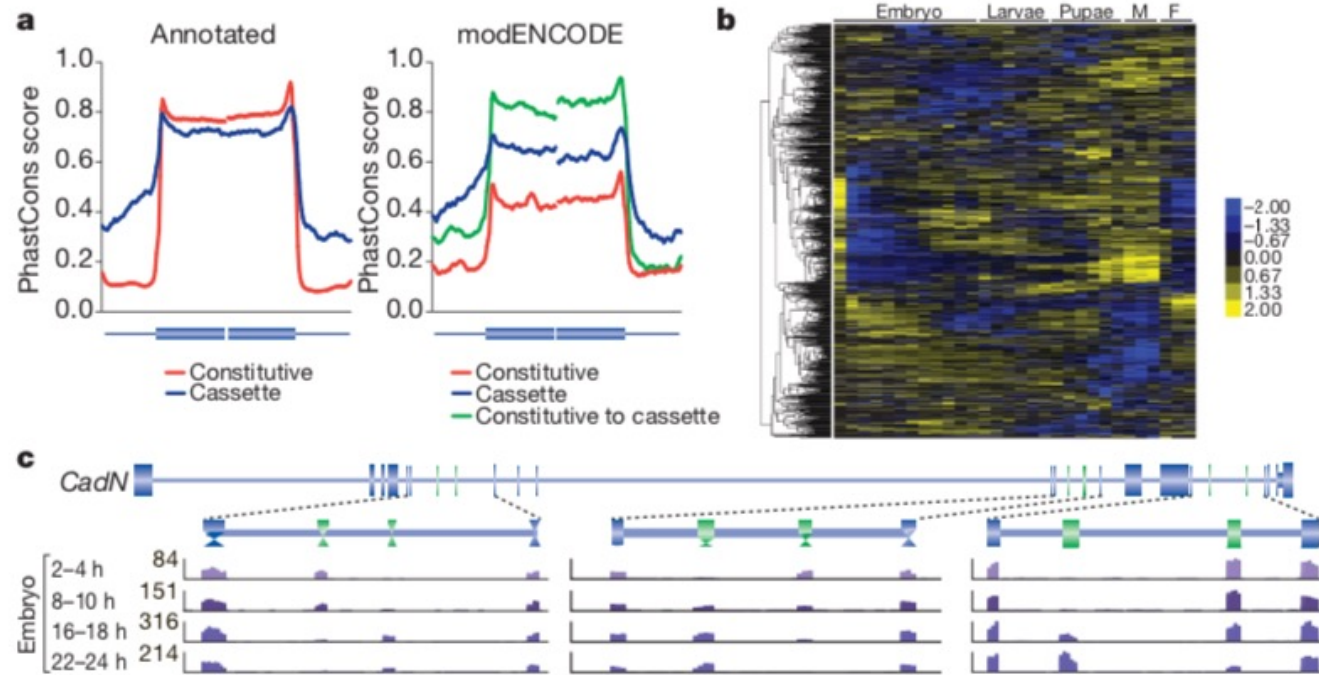


Figure 4 | Developmentally regulated splicing events. **a**, Conservation of internal constitutive and cassette exons >50 nucleotides that were annotated or new discoveries. (Annotated constitutive, $n = 26,127$; annotated cassette, $n = 438$; modENCODE cassette, $n = 173$; modENCODE constitutive, $n = 306$; FlyBase 5.12 constitutive to modENCODE cassette, $n = 304$.) **b**, Clusters of

regulated cassette exon events during development. The scale bar indicates Z-scores of Ψ . **c**, Regulated alternative splicing in *CadN* during embryogenesis. The maximal number of reads in the poly(A)⁺ RNA-Seq data are indicated for each track.

Diversity and dynamics of the *Drosophila* transcriptome

James B. Brown^{1,2*}, Nathan Boley^{1*}, Robert Eisman^{3*}, Gemma E. May^{4*}, Marcus H. Stoiber^{1*}, Michael O. Duff⁴, Ben W. Booth², Jiayu Wen⁵, Soo Park², Ana Maria Suzuki^{6,7}, Kenneth H. Wan², Charles Yu², Dayu Zhang⁸, Joseph W. Carlson², Lucy Cherbas³, Brian D. Eads³, David Miller³, Keithanne Mockaitis³, Johnny Roberts⁸, Carrie A. Davis⁹, Erwin Frise², Ann S. Hammonds², Sara Olson⁴, Sol Shenker⁵, David Sturgill¹⁰, Anastasia A. Samsonova^{11,12}, Richard Weiszmann², Garret Robinson¹, Juan Hernandez¹, Justen Andrews³, Peter J. Bickel¹, Piero Carninci^{6,7}, Peter Cherbas^{3,8}, Thomas R. Gingeras⁹, Roger A. Hoskins², Thomas C. Kaufman³, Eric C. Lai⁵, Brian Oliver¹⁰, Norbert Perrimon^{11,12}, Brenton R. Graveley⁴ & Susan E. Celniker²

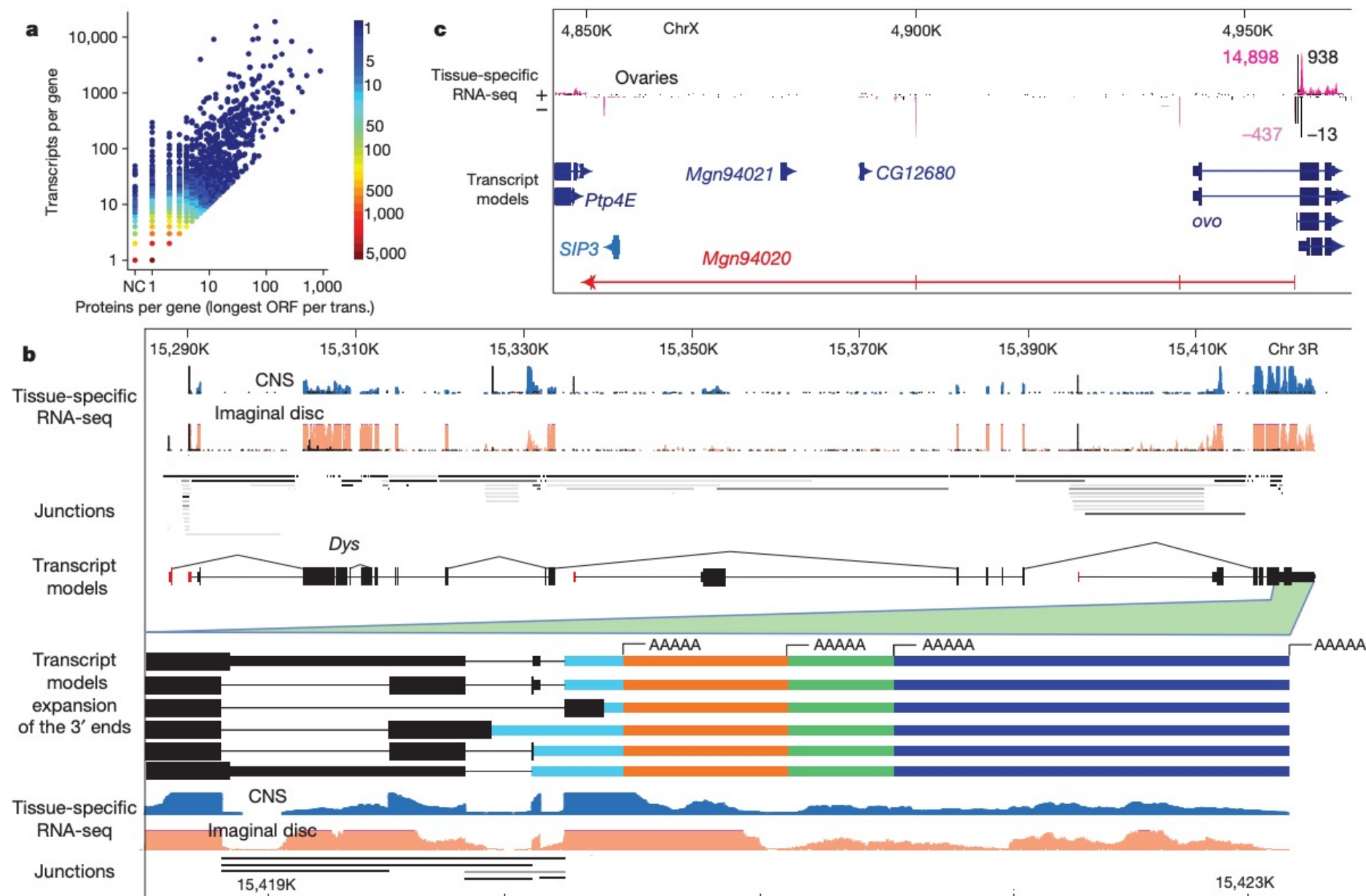
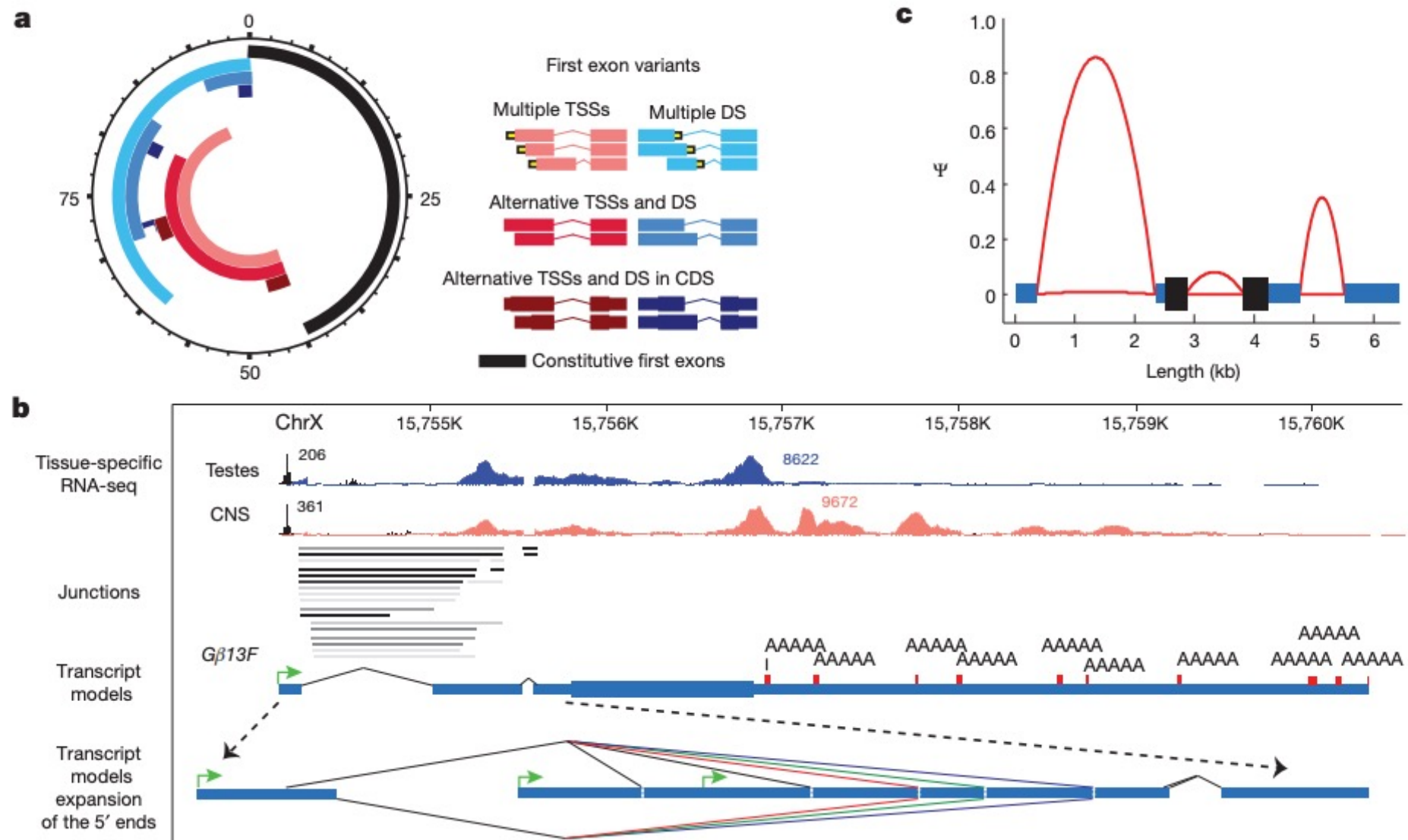


Figure 1 | Overview of the annotation of the *Drosophila melanogaster* transcriptome. **a**, Scatterplot showing the per gene correlation between number of proteins and number of transcripts. The genes *Dscam* and *para* are omitted as extreme outliers both encoding >10,000 unique proteins. **b**, *Dystrophin* (*Dys*) produces 72 transcripts and encodes 32 proteins.

Highlighted is alternative splicing and polyadenylation at the 3' end. CAGE (black), RNA-seq (tan, blue), splice junctions (shaded grey as a function of usage). **c**, An internal promoter of *ovo* is bidirectional in ovaries and produces a lncRNA (430 bp, red) bridging two gene deserts. CAGE (black), RNA-seq (pink), counts are read-depth (minus-strand given as negative).⁴⁵

Splicing complexity across the gene body



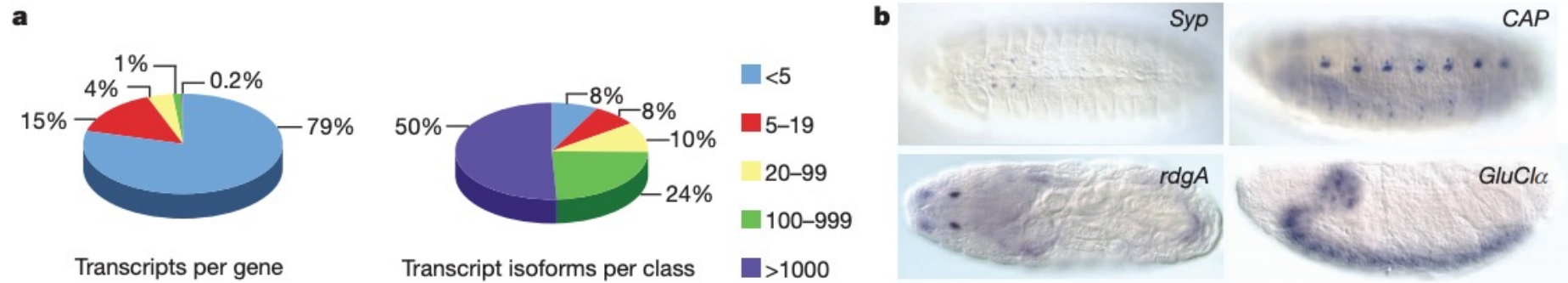


Figure 3 | Complex splicing patterns are mainly limited to neural tissues.
a, A small minority of genes (47, 0.2%) encode most transcripts. **b**, *In situ* RNA staining of constitutive exons of four genes with highly complex splicing patterns in the embryo. *Syncrin* (*Syp*), *CAP*, *retinal degeneration A* (*rdgA*) and

GluCl α show specific late embryonic neural expression in the ventral midline neurons; dorsal/lateral and ventral sensory complexes; Bolwig's organ or larval eye; and central nervous system, respectively.

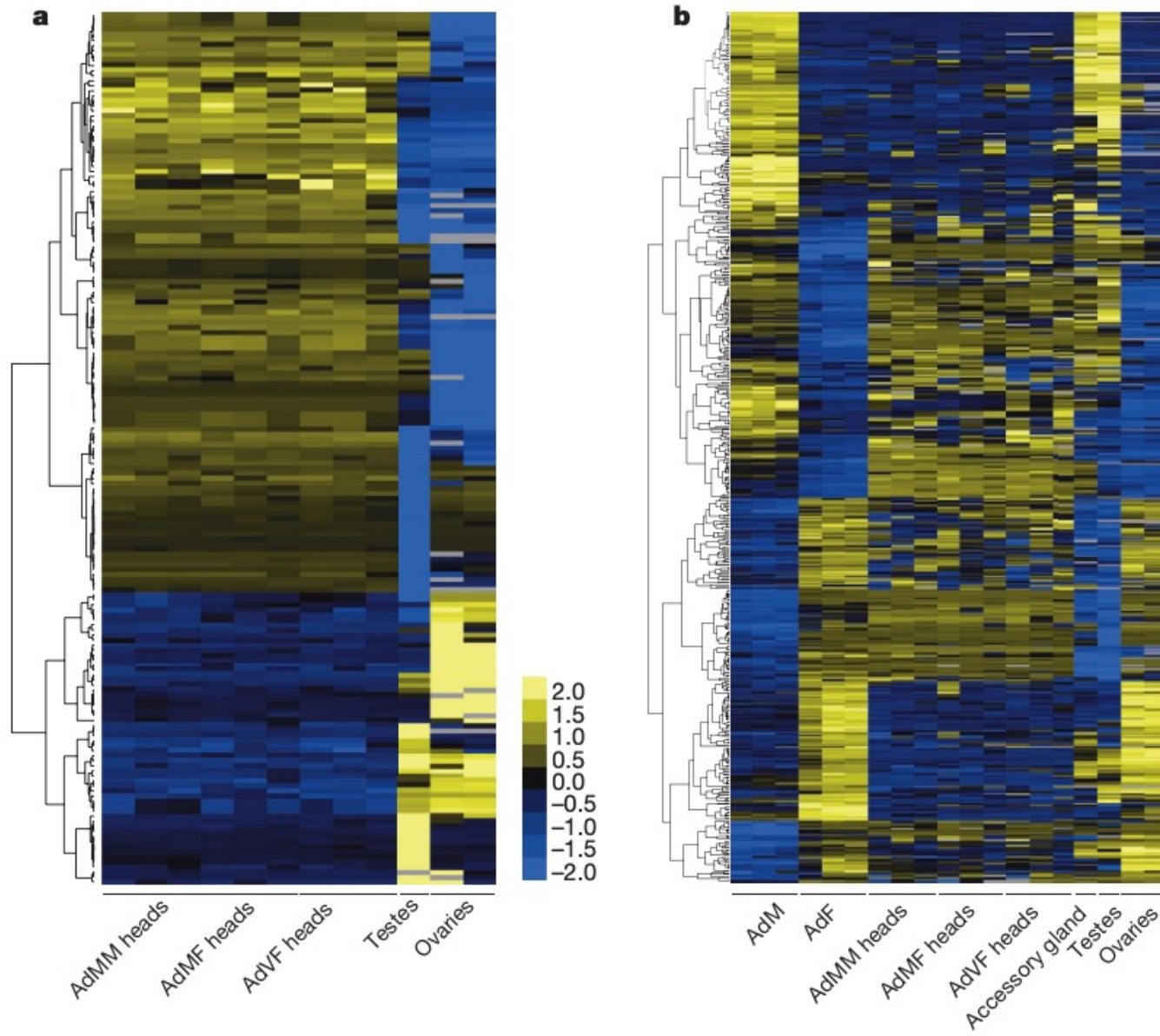


Figure 4 | Sex-specific splicing is mainly tissue-specific splicing. **a**, Clusters of tissue-specific splicing events. The scale bar indicates z-scores of Ψ . Adult mated male (AdMM), adult mated female (AdMF) and adult virgin female (AdvF) heads are from 1-, 4- and 20-day-old animals, respectively. Testes are from 4-day-old adult males, and ovaries are from mated and virgin 4-day-old adult females. **b**, Sex-specific splicing events in whole animals are primarily testes- or ovary-specific splicing events. Adult male (AdM) and adult female (AdF) animals are 1, 5 and 30 days old. Accessory glands were dissected from 4-day-old adult males. The RNA-seq columns from heads, testes and ovaries are as described in **a**.

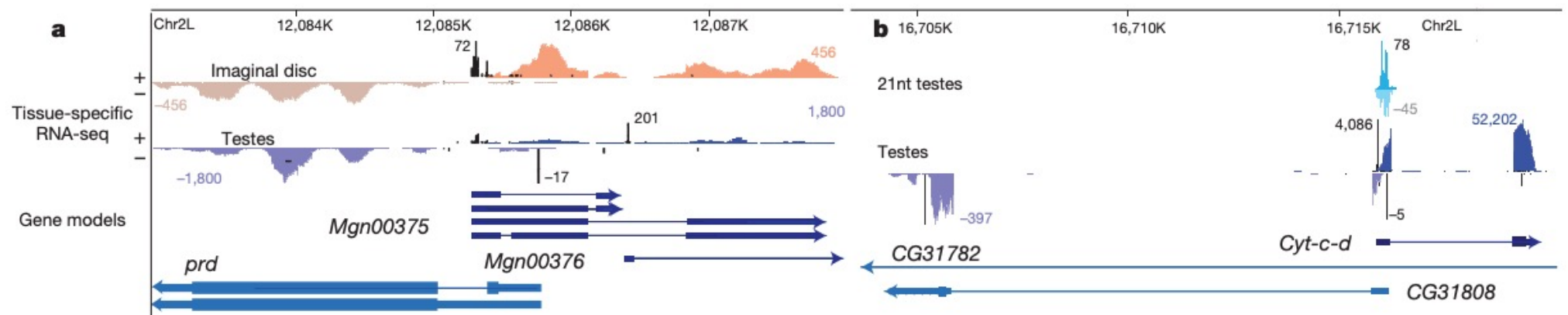


Figure 5 | Examples of antisense transcription. **a**, 5'/5' overlapping bidirectional antisense transcription at the *prd* locus. Short RNA sequencing does not reveal substantial siRNA (that is, 21-nt-dominant small RNA) signal

in this region (data not shown). **b**, A 5'/5' antisense region that produces substantial small RNA signal on both strands. nt, nucleotide.

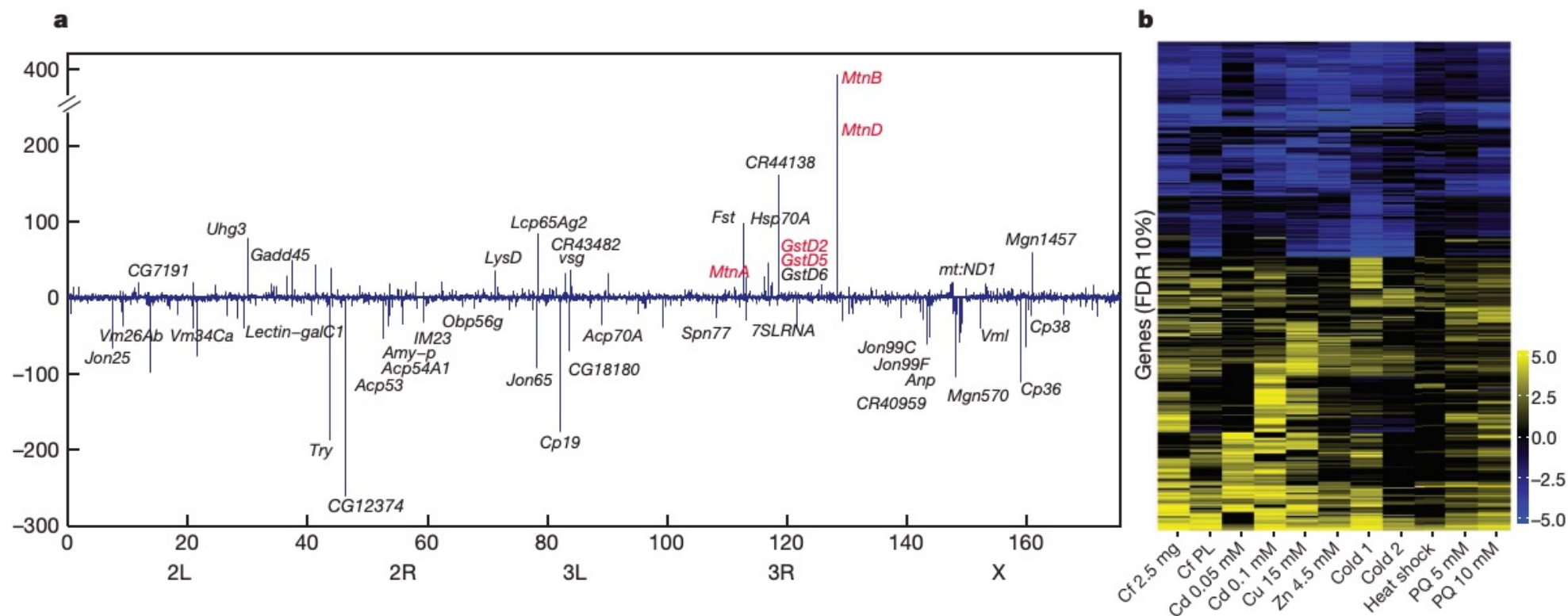


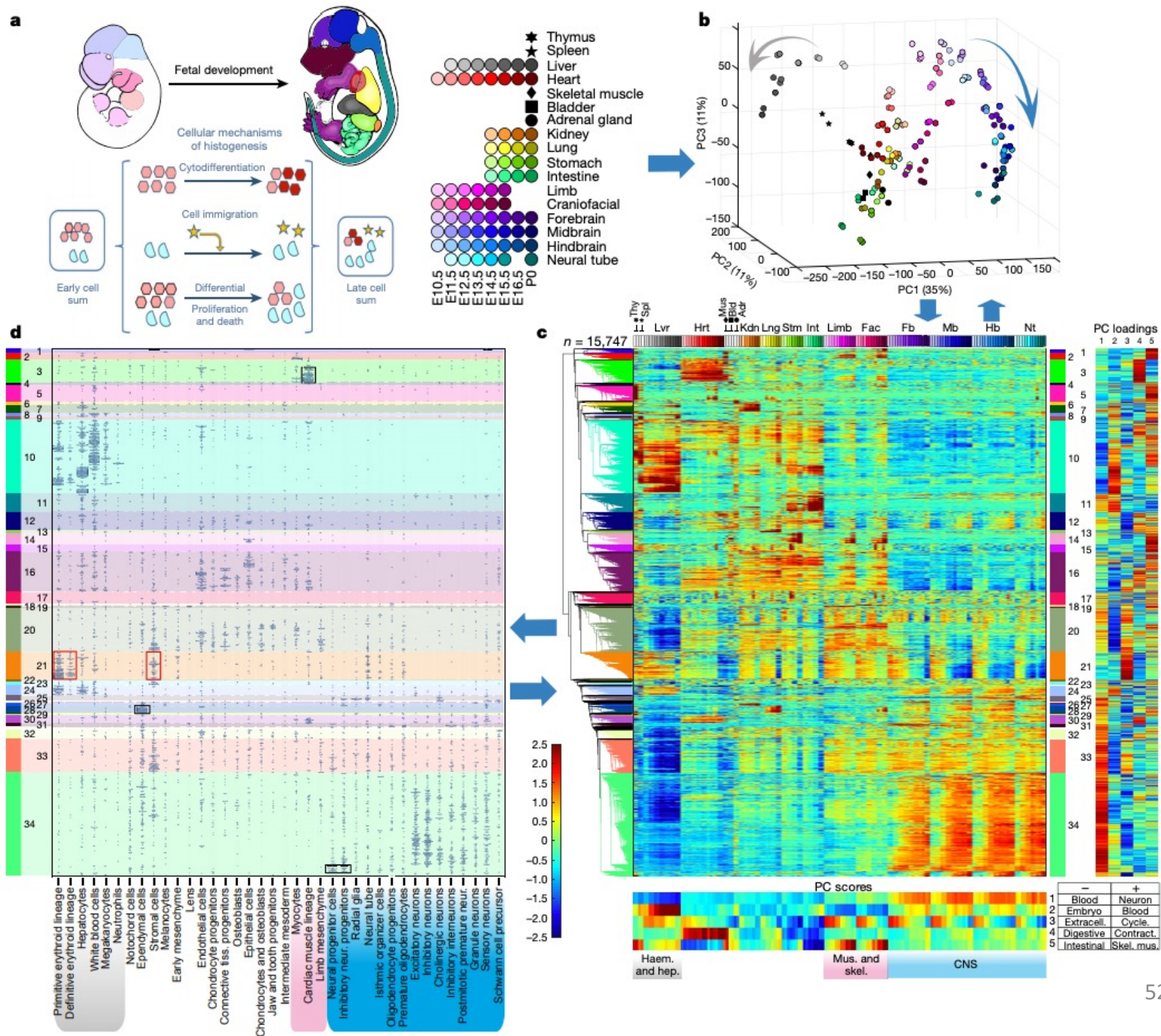
Figure 6 | Effects of environmental perturbations on the *Drosophila* transcriptome. Adults were treated with caffeine (Cf), Cd, Cu, Zn, cold, heat or paraquat (PQ). **a**, A genome-wide map of genes that are up- or downregulated as a function of Cd treatment. Labelled genes are those that showed a 20-fold (<10% FDR) change in response (linear scale). Genes highlighted in red are

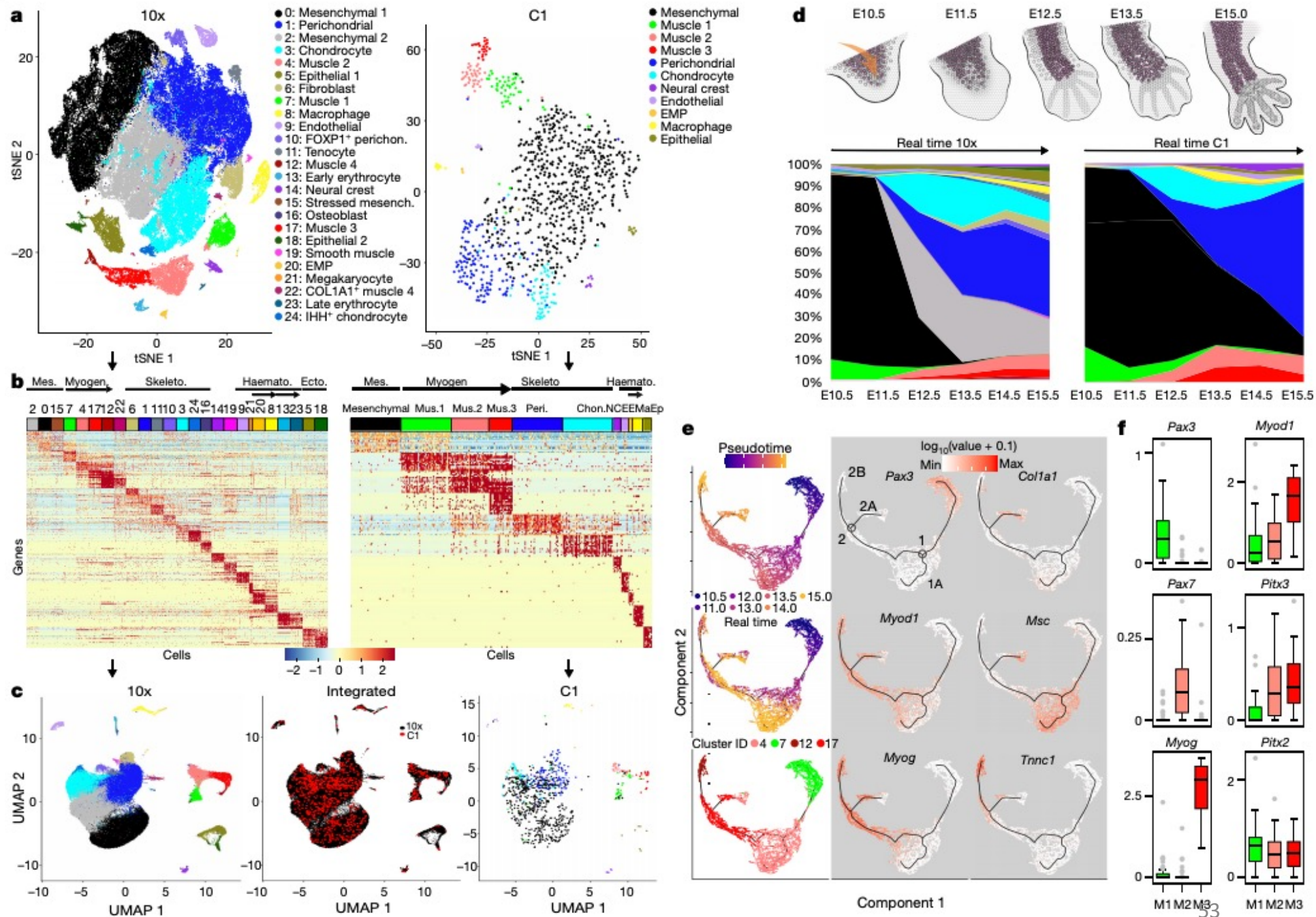
those identified in larvae⁵⁰. Some genes are omitted for readability, the complete figure and list of omitted genes are given in Supplementary Fig. 8a. **b**, Heat map showing the fold change of genes with a FDR < 10% (differential expression) in at least one sample (log₂ scale). PL, pre-lethal.

The changing mouse embryo transcriptome at whole tissue and single-cell resolution

Peng He, Brian A. Williams , Diane Trout, Georgi K. Marinov, Henry Amrhein, Libera Berghella, Say-Tar Goh, Ingrid Plajzer-Frick, Veena Afzal, Len A. Pennacchio, Diane E. Dickel, Axel Visel, Bing Ren, Ross C. Hardison, Yu Zhang & Barbara J. Wold 

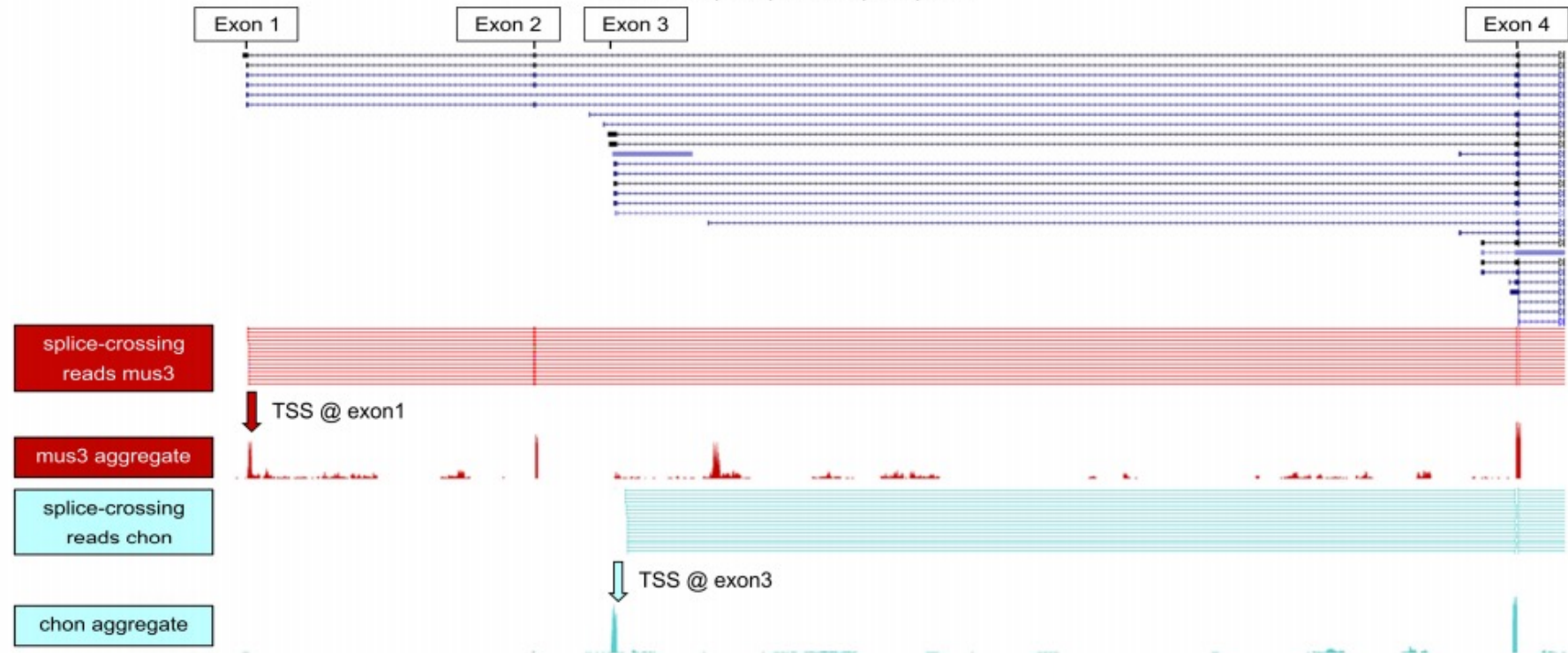
Nature **583**, 760–767(2020) | [Cite this article](#)





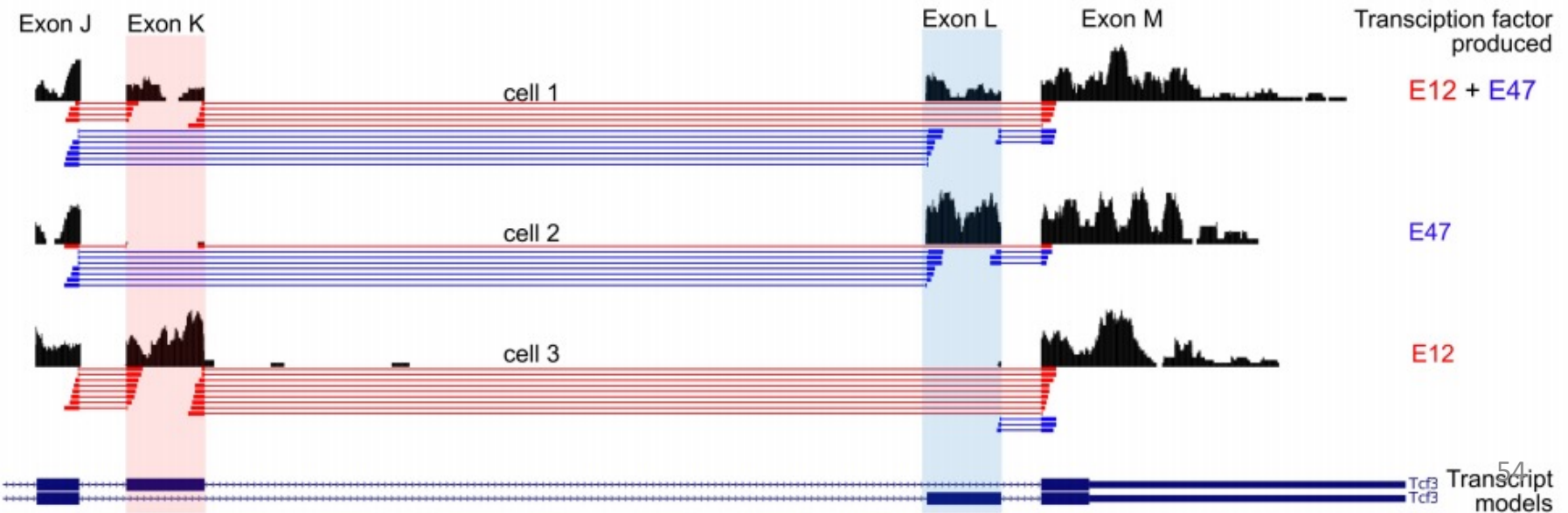
a

Mef2c: 6325 nt mRNA
chr13:83,502,991-83,527,603

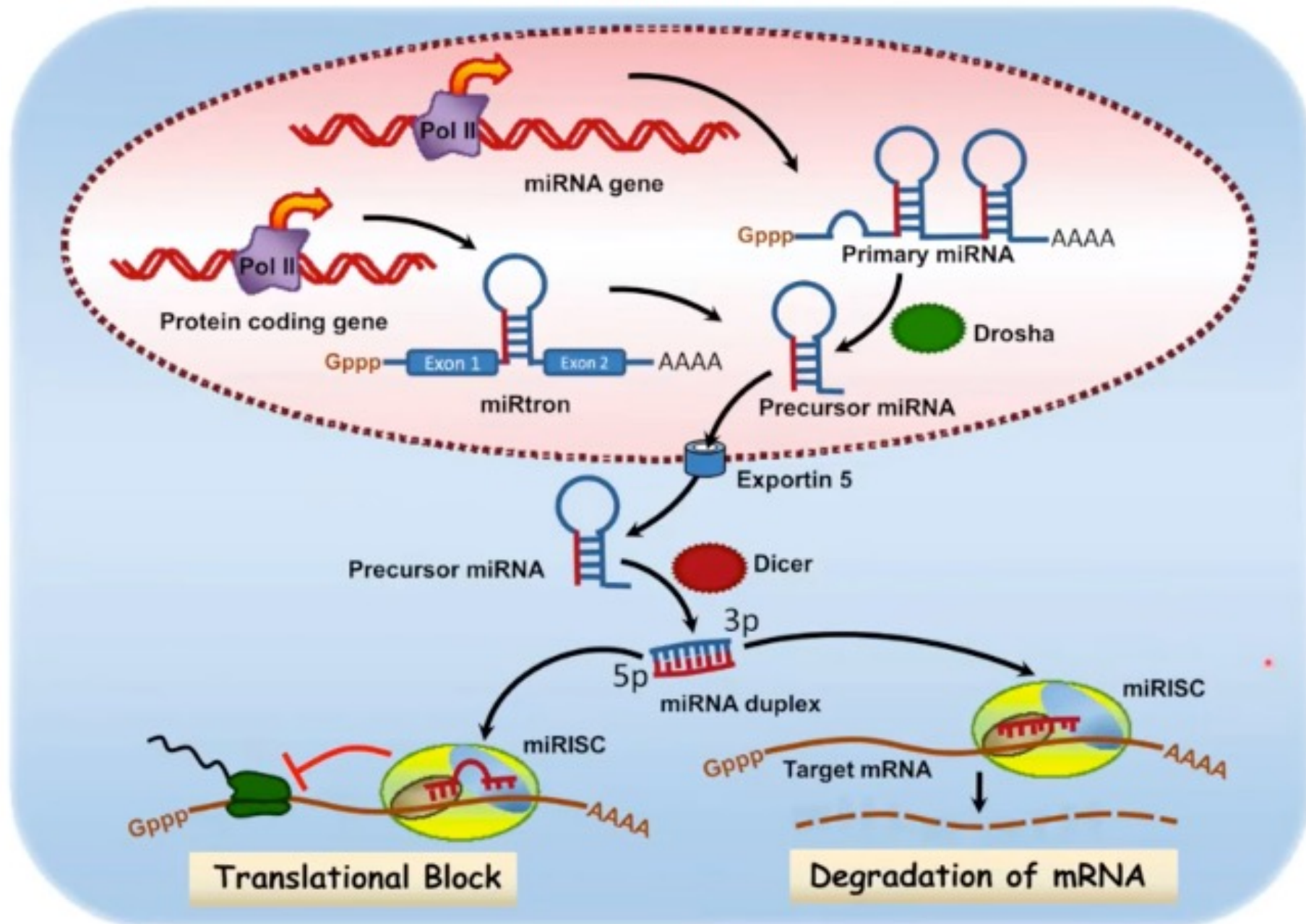


b

Tcf3: 4,523bp
chr10:80,413,672-80,409,150



MicroRNAs as post-transcriptional regulators of mRNA



Today: from very short to very long

RNA Length



microRNAs

21-28 nt long

UGAGGUAGUAGGUUGUAUAGUU
let7a-1

ENCODE3/4: sequence microRNAs

First Half

messenger RNAs

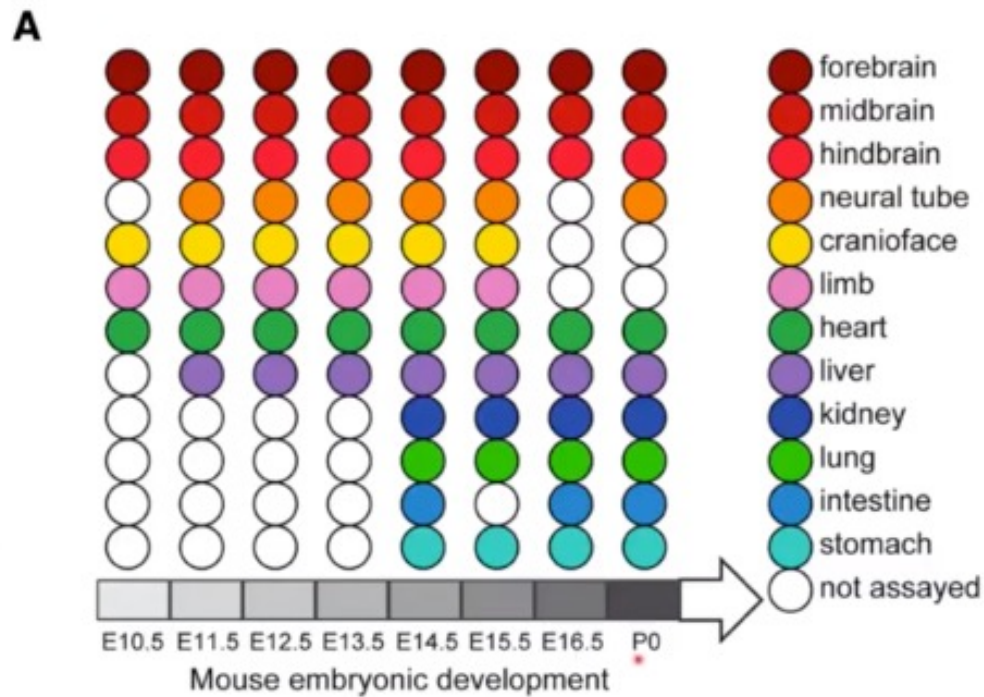
300-110,000 nt long

Most annotated mRNAs less than 5kb

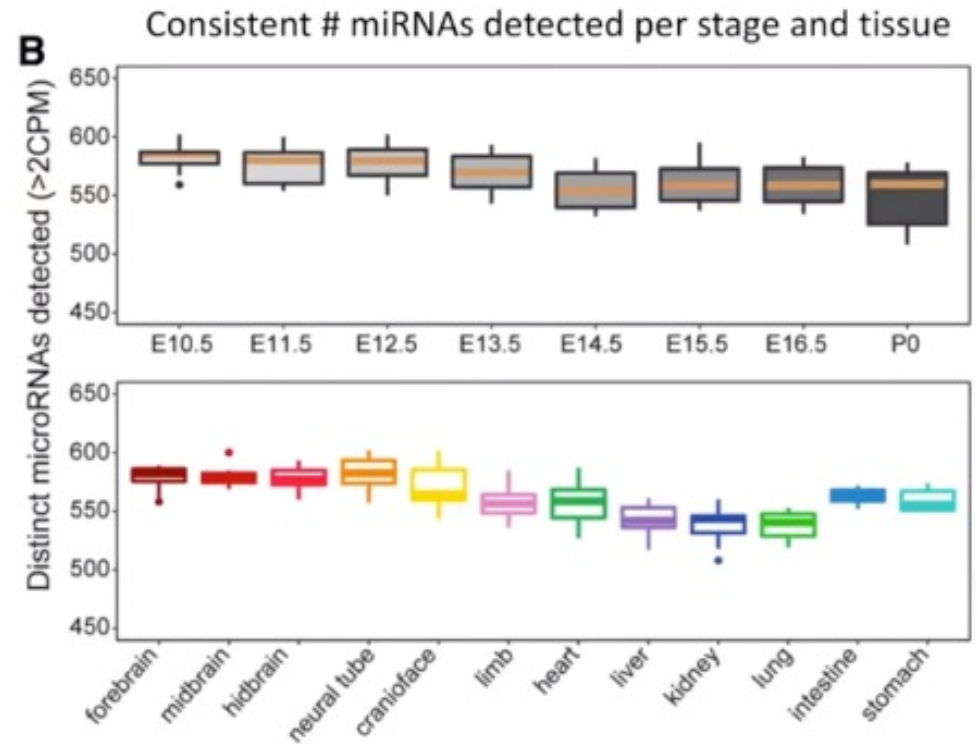
ENCODE4: full-length transcript isoforms

Second Half

Overview of mouse ENCODE miRNA data sets

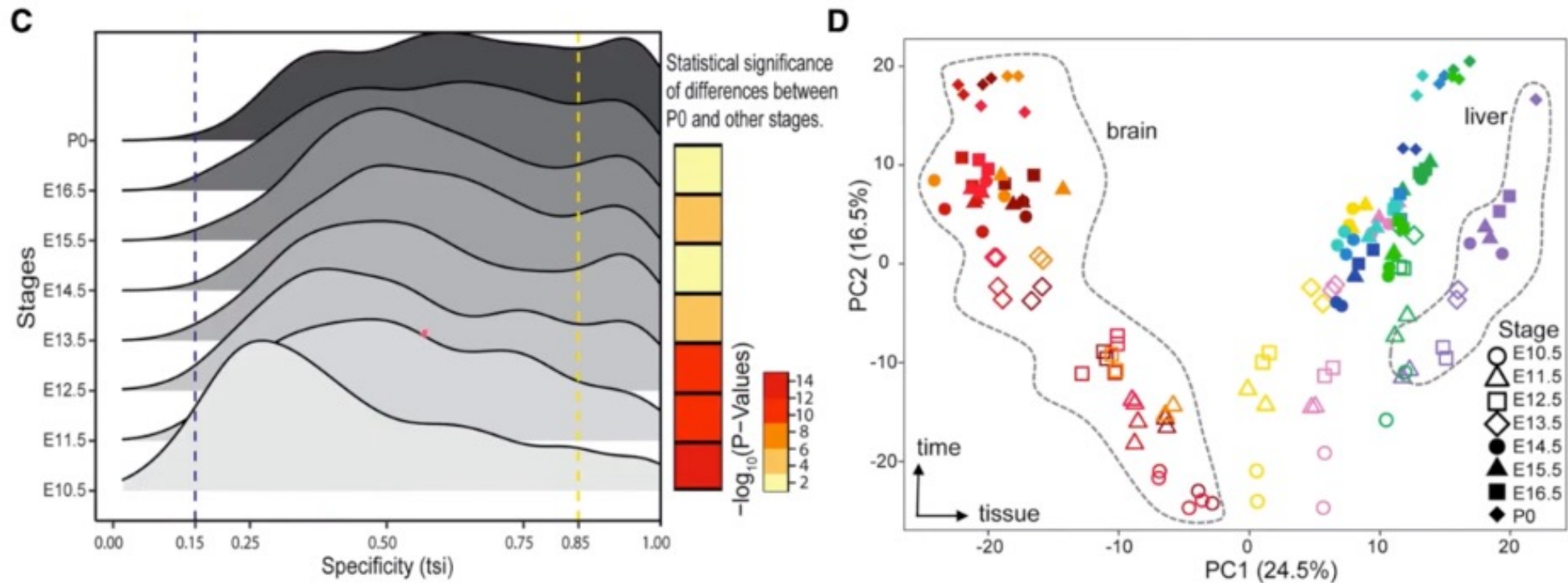


Matches other ENCODE3 mouse samples



Overall, detected 785 distinct miRNA > 2 CPM

MicroRNA expression profiles become more tissue specific during development

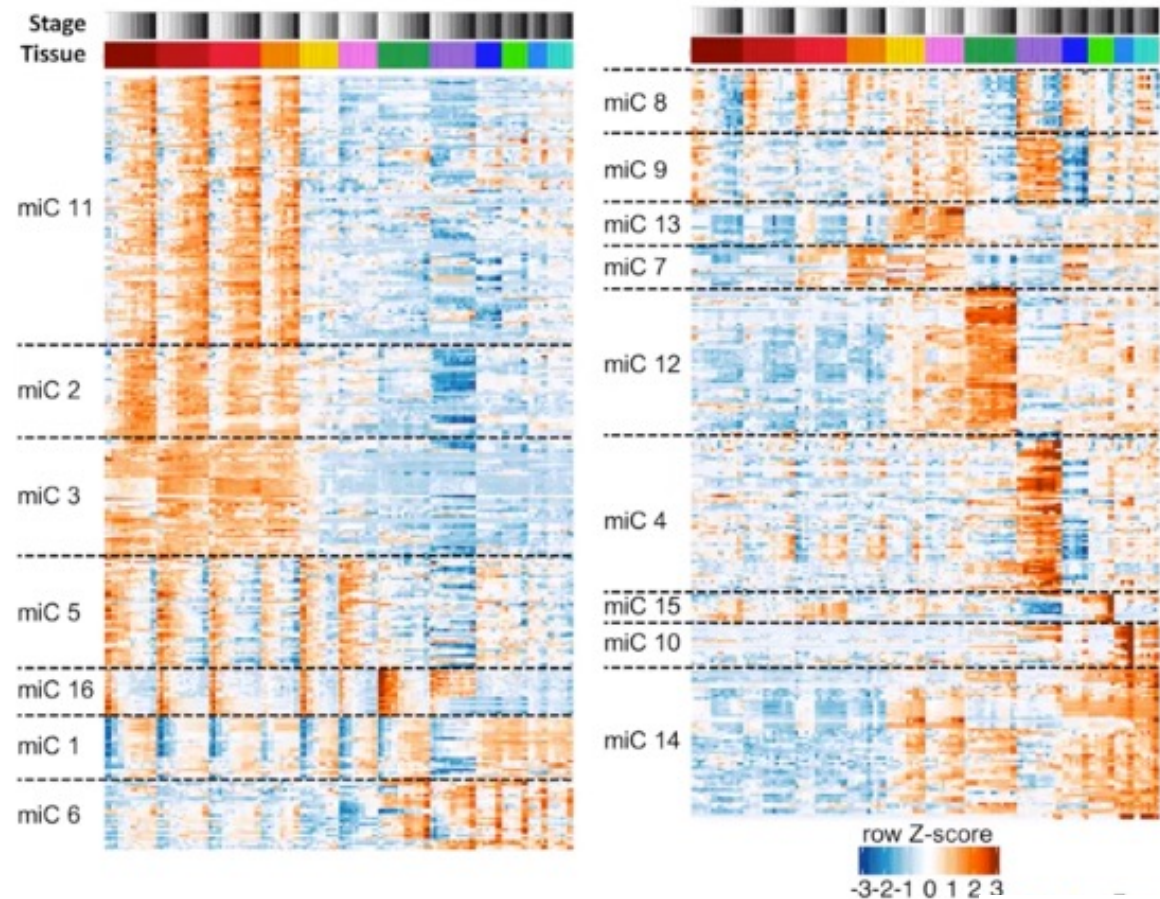
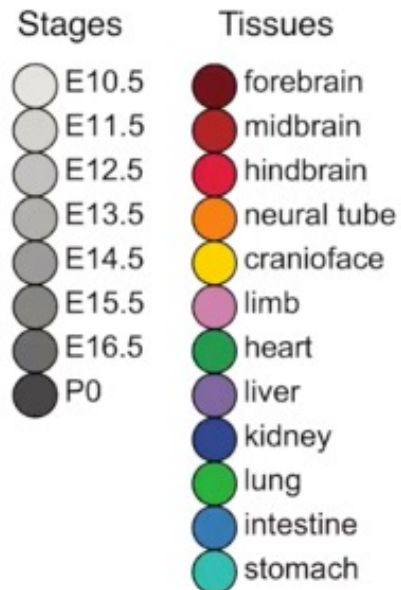


TSI = Tissue Specificity Index

(Rahmanian and Murad et al, 2019)

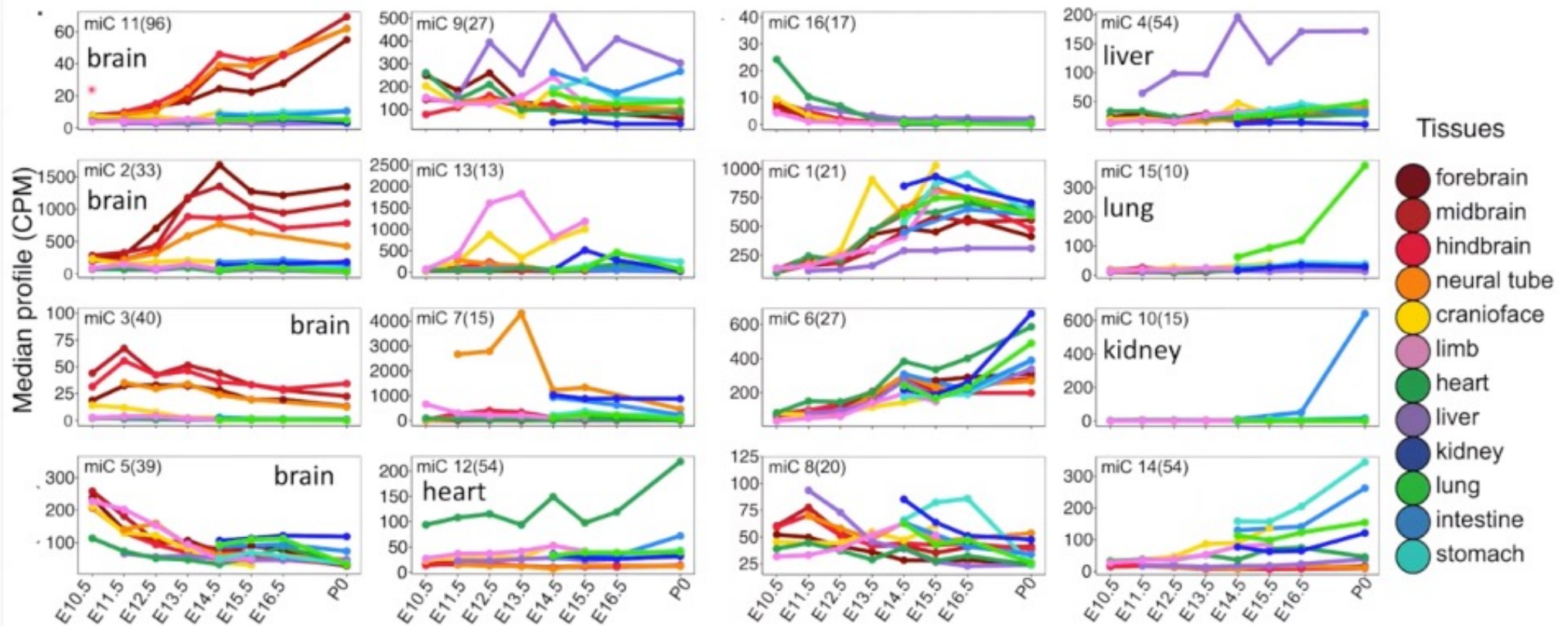
Clustering of MicroRNAs expression captures tissue specific expression patterns

- Clustering was done by MaSigPro
- 16 clusters were identified



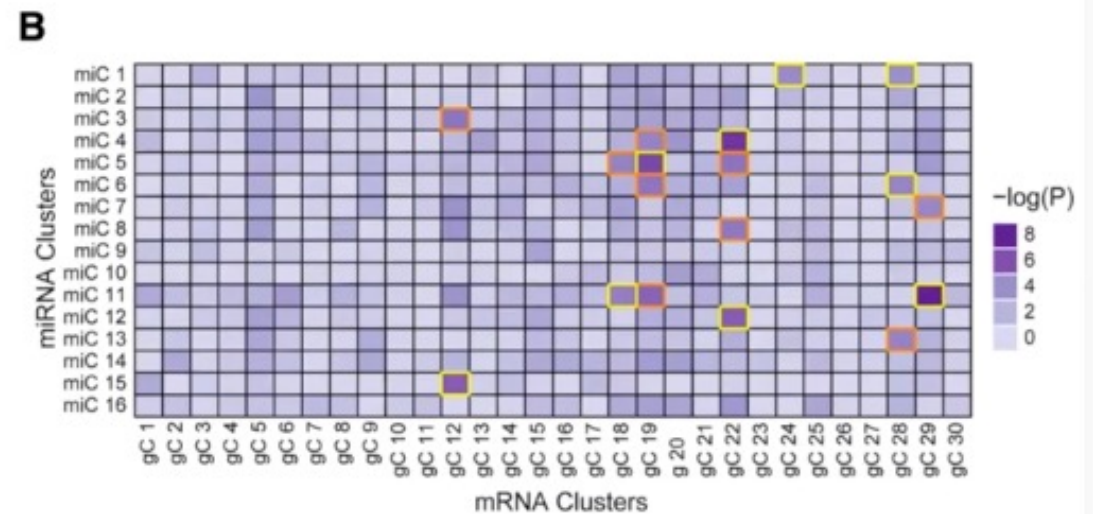
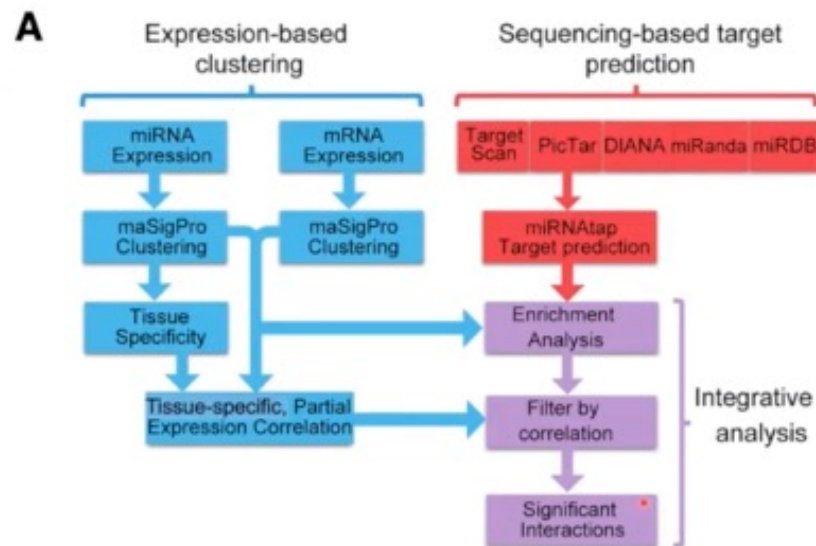
(Rahmanian and Murad et al, 2019)

Each miRNA cluster exhibits a distinct tissue-specific expression



(Rahmanian and Murad et al, 2019)

Identifying microRNA expression clusters that are repressing their mRNA targets

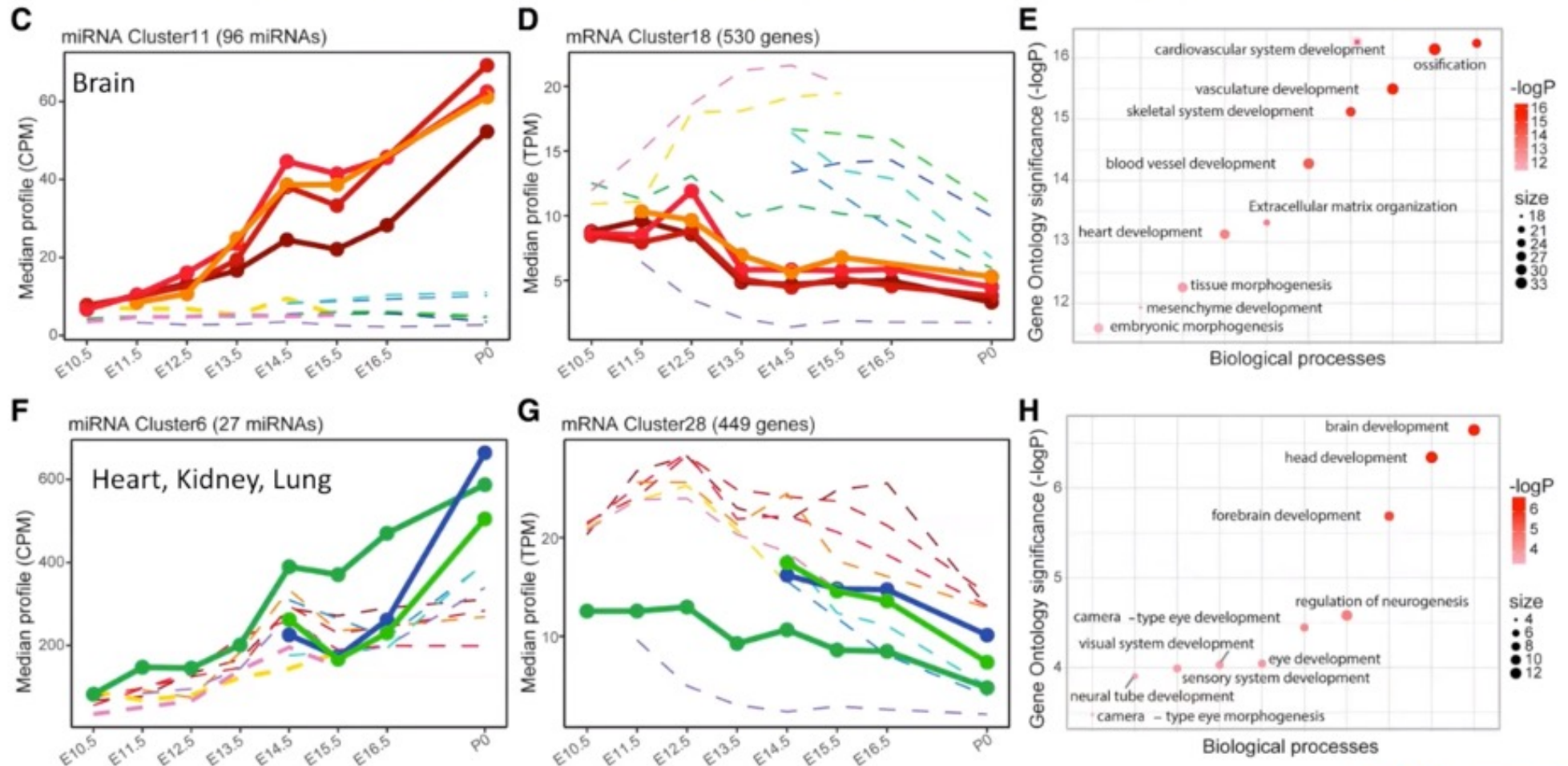


18 are significant by χ^2

- negative correlation with mRNA targets
- positive correlation with mRNA targets

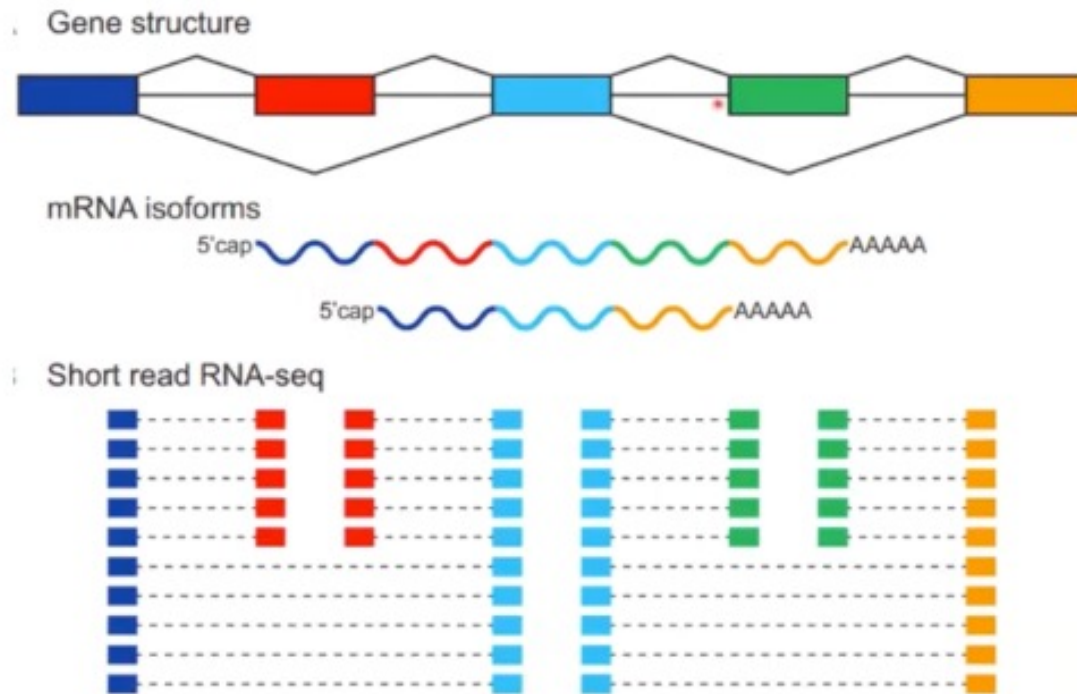
9 have negative correlation to their target mRNA

Examples of significant anti-correlated miRNA-mRNA clusters



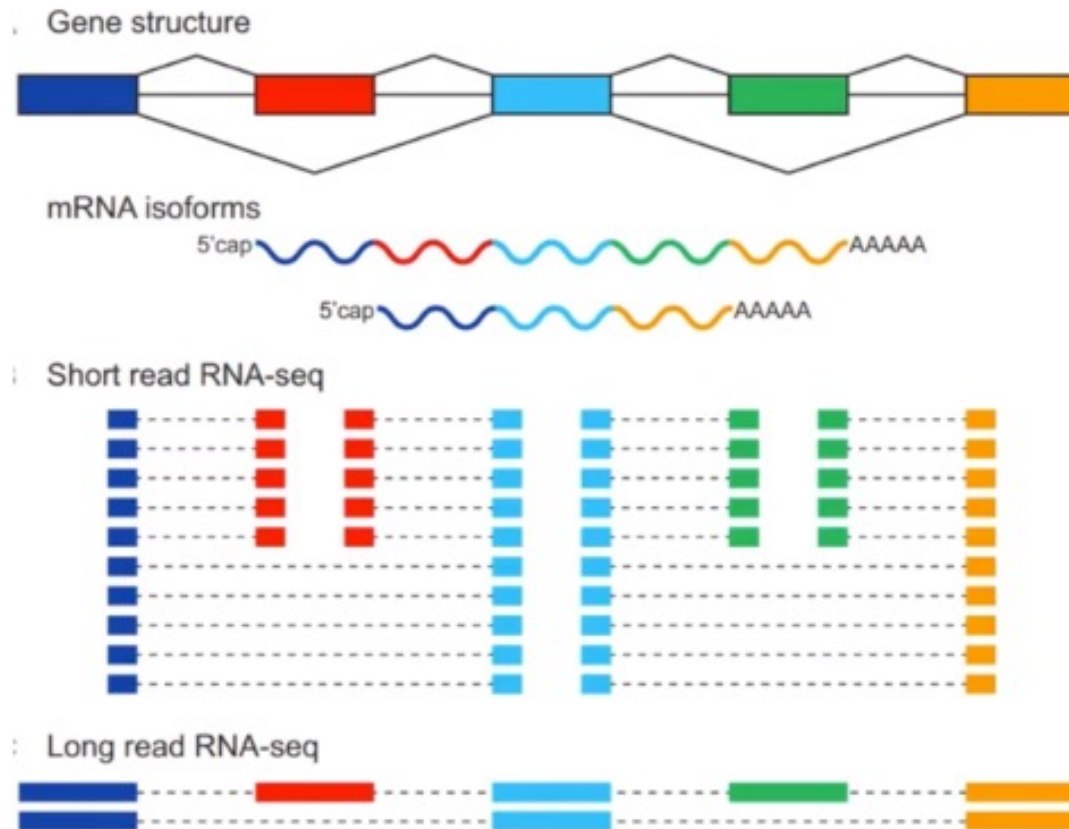
(Rahmanian and Murad et al, 2019)

Short-read sequencing falls short of identifying mRNA isoforms



(Park et al., 2017)

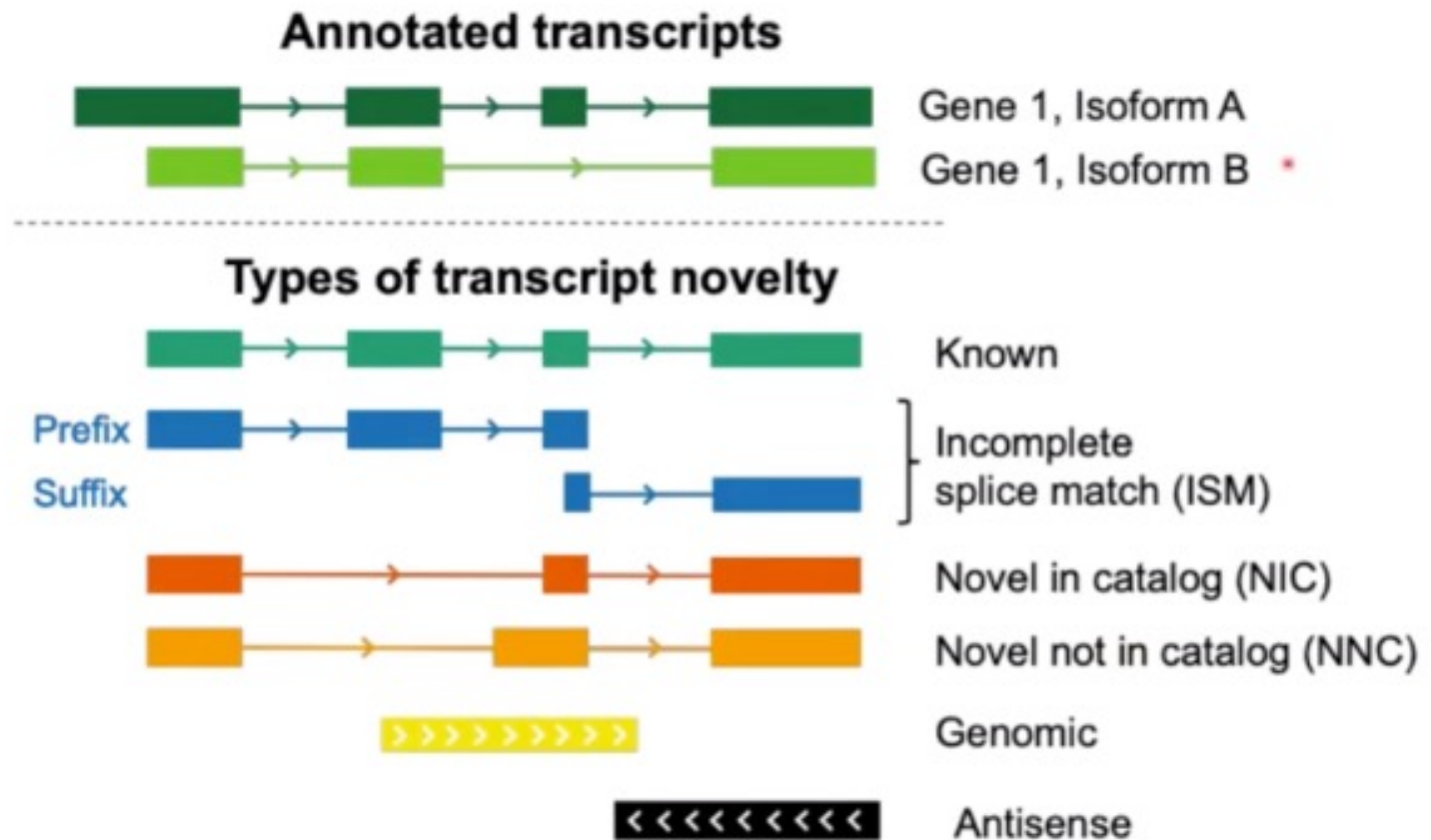
Short-read sequencing falls short of identifying mRNA isoforms



(Park et al., 2017)

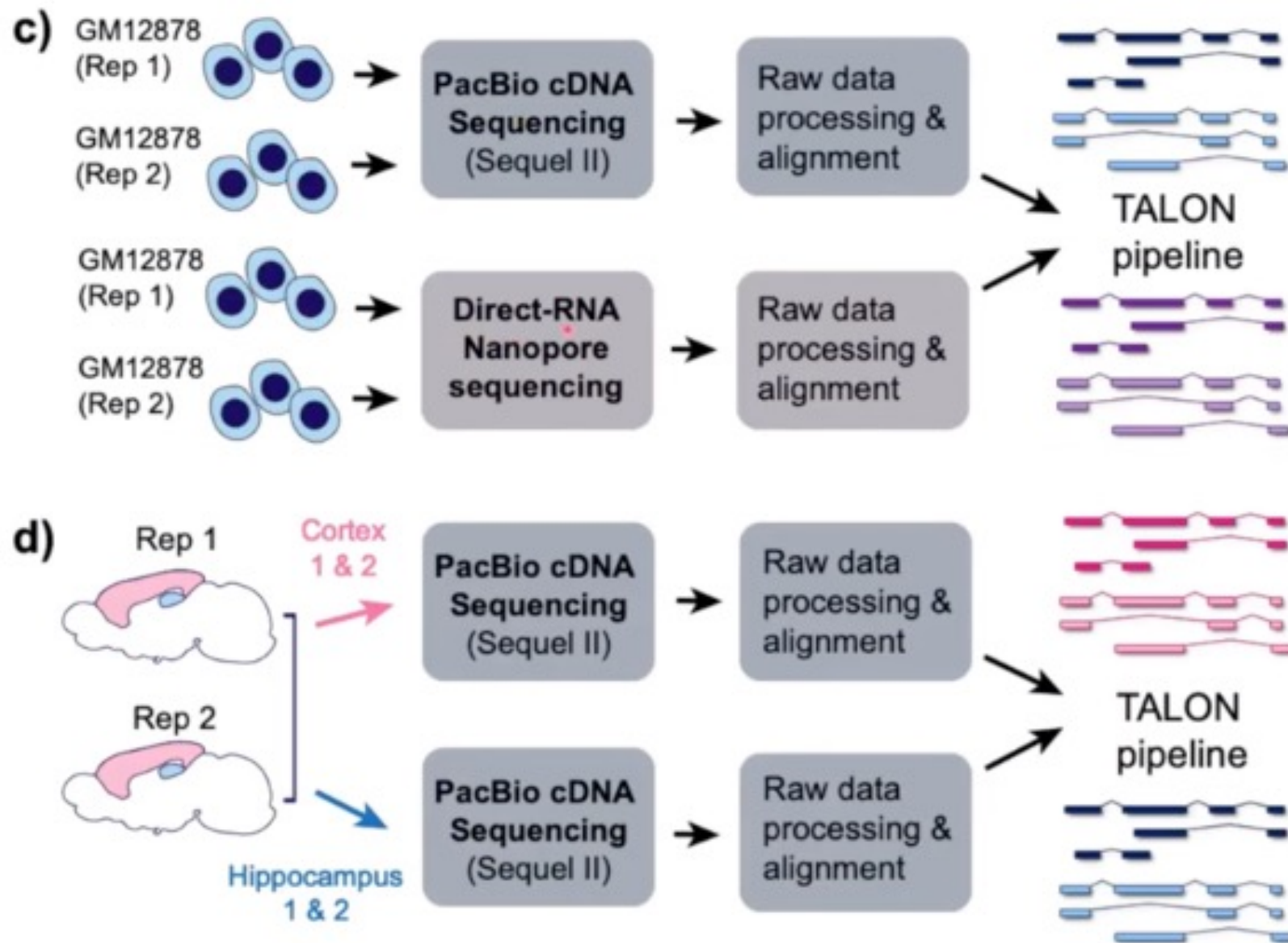
Isoform novelty categories

b)



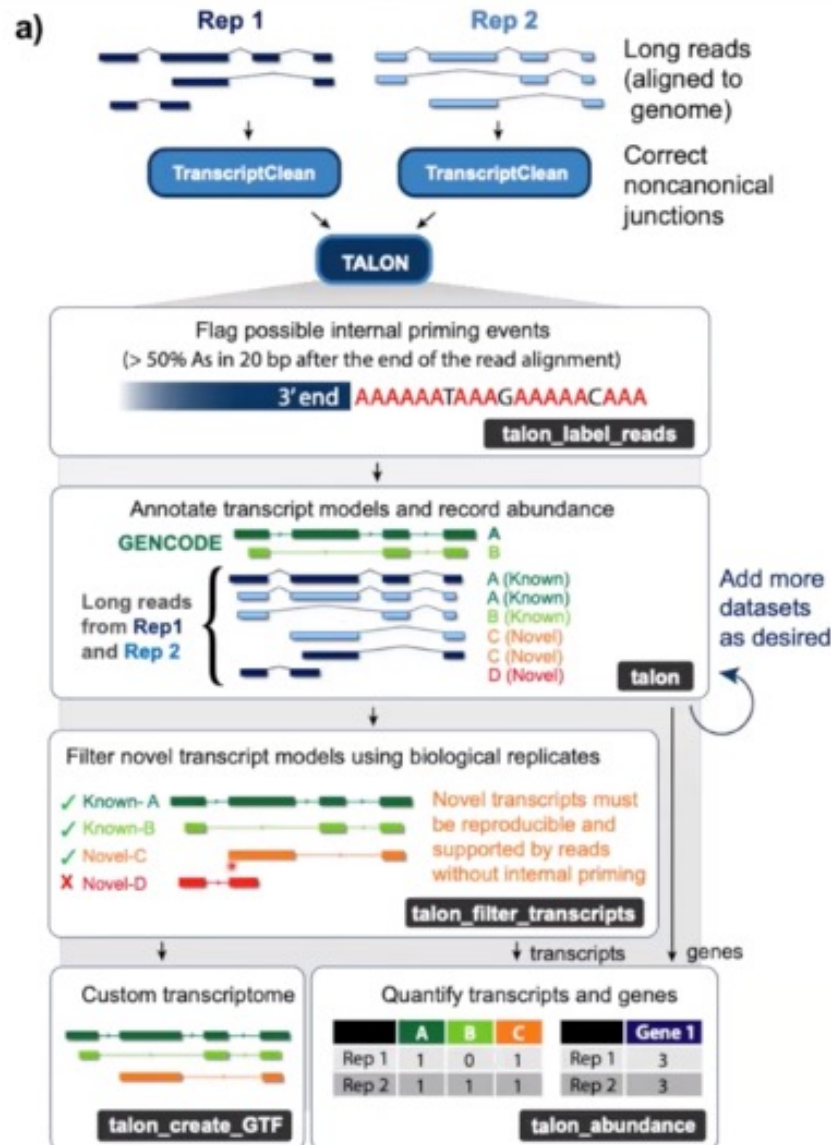
Using SQANTI novelty categories

Comparing sequencing technologies and tissues





TALON: a pipeline for long-read transcriptomes

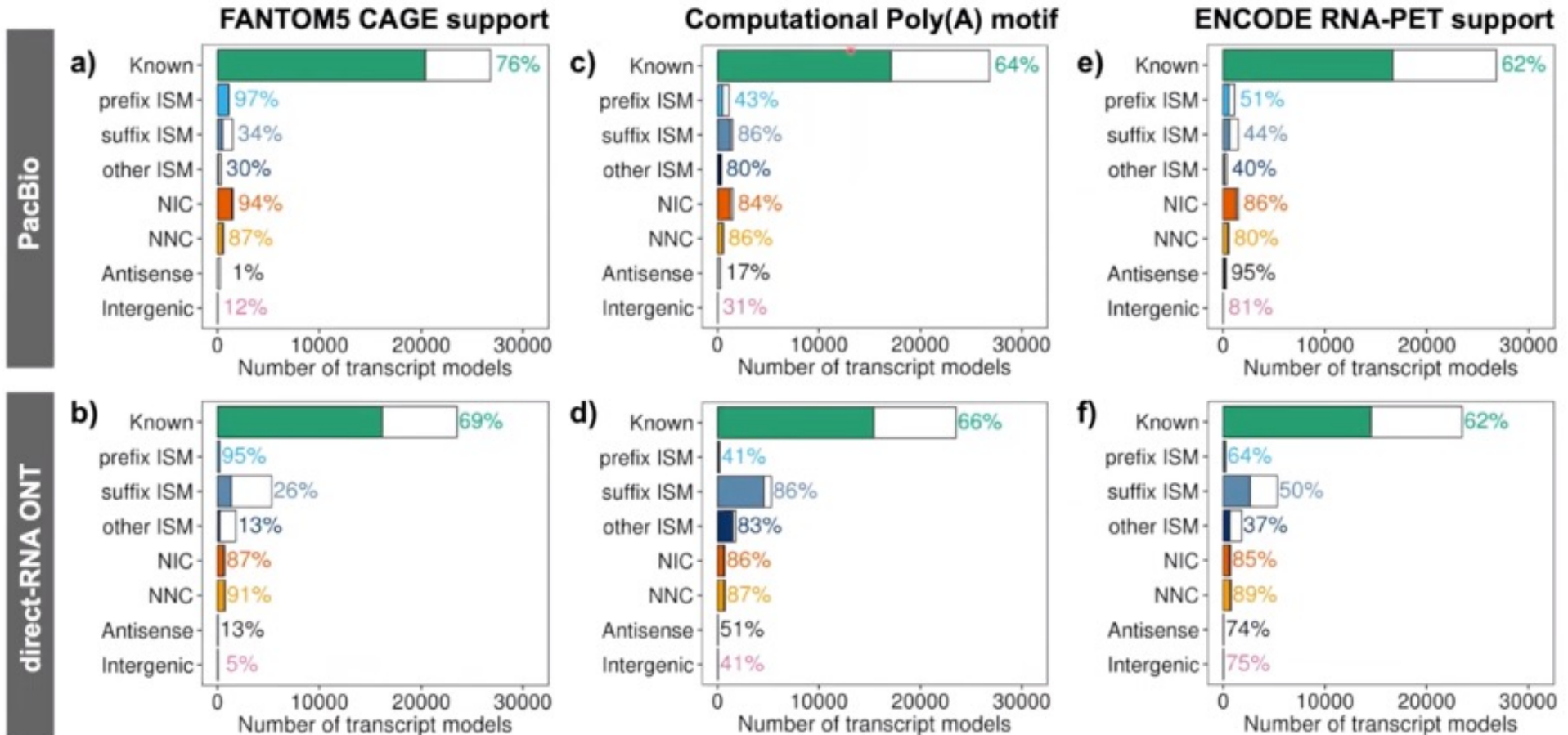


<https://github.com/mortazavilab/TranscriptClean>

<https://github.com/mortazavilab/TALON>

(Wyman and Balderrama-Gutierrez et al, BioRxiv, 2020)

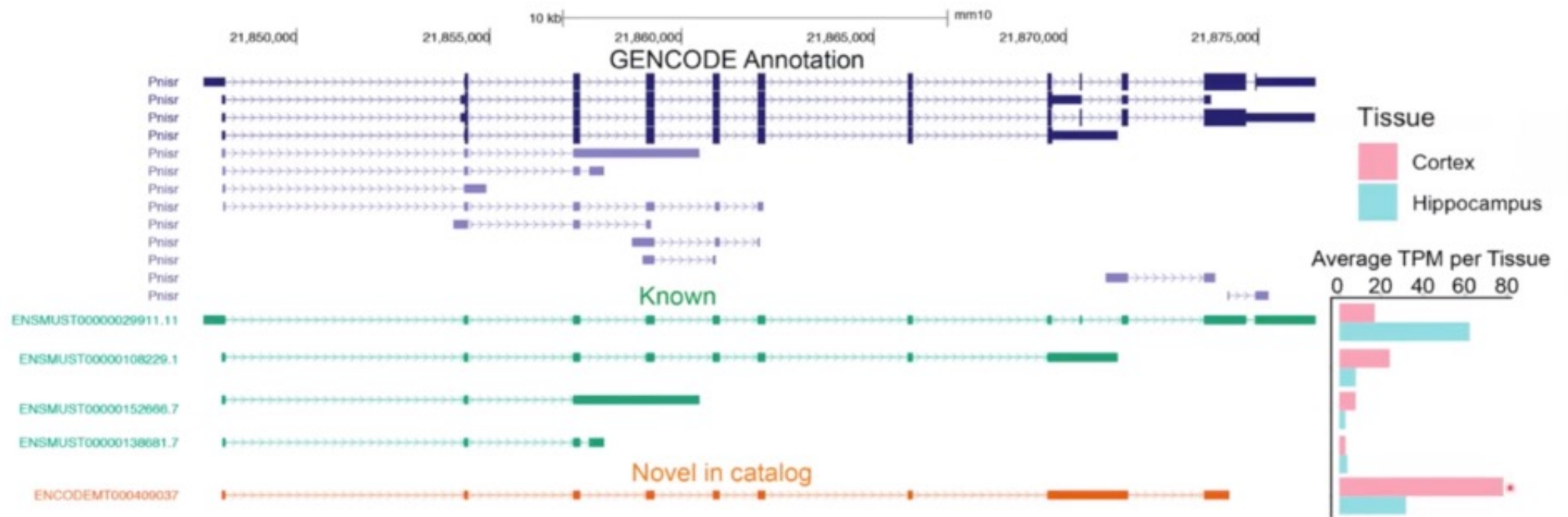
Pacbio has higher rates of 5' and 3' completeness



(Wyman and Balderrama-Gutierrez et al, BioRxiv, 2020)



Differences between tissues can involve novel isoforms



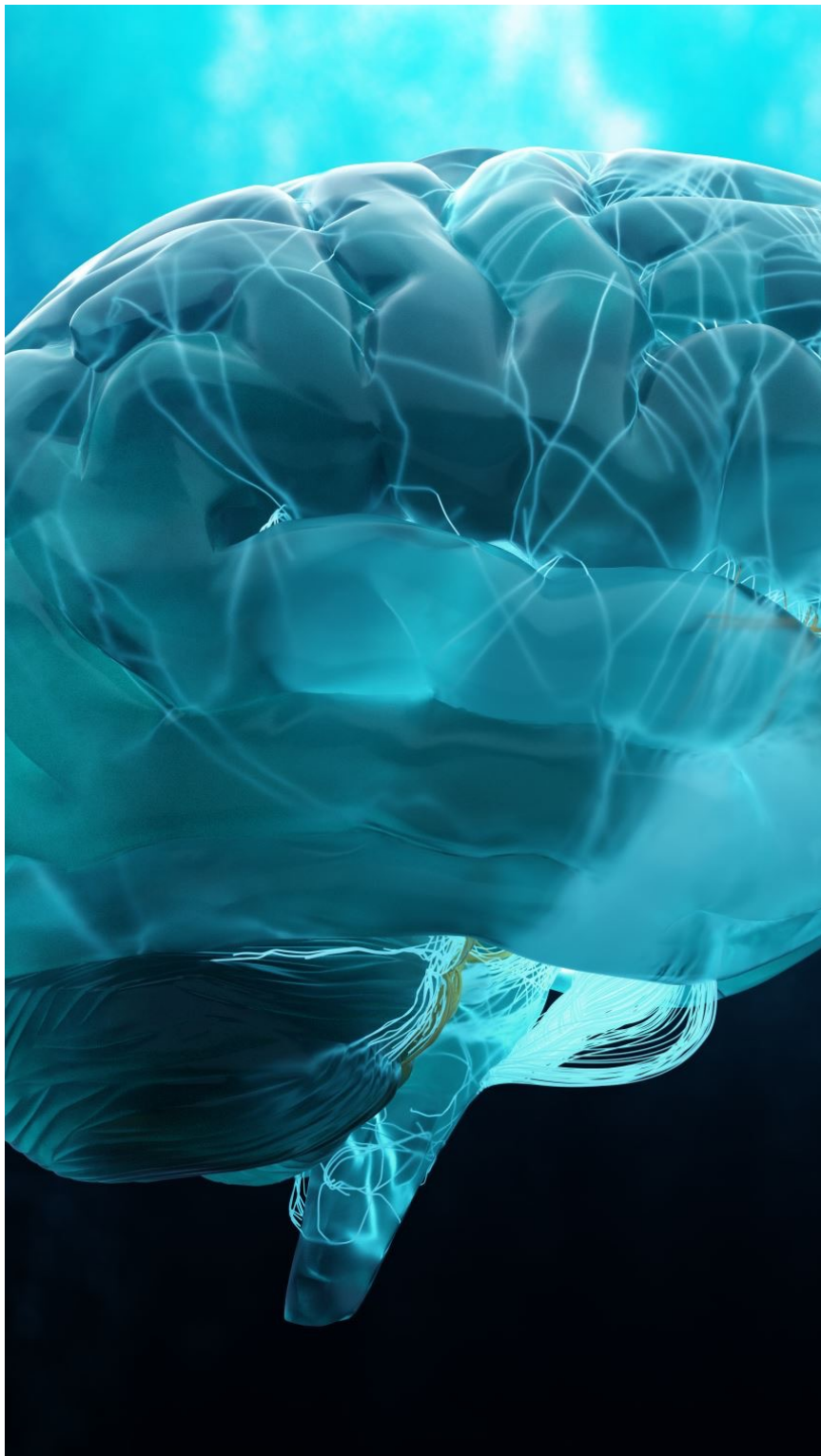
(Wyman and Balderrama-Gutierrez et al, BioRxiv, 2020)

ALS

Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis

"肌萎缩侧索硬化症".

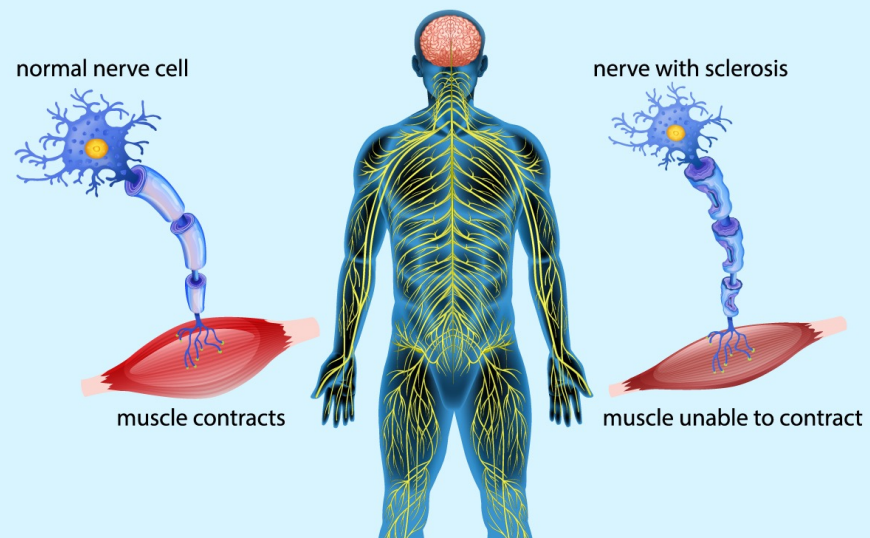
Example



ALS

- ALS, is a **nervous system disease** that affects **nerve cells** in the **brain and spinal cord**. ALS causes **loss of muscle control**. The disease gets worse over time.
- The exact cause of the disease is still **not known**. A small number of cases are inherited.
- ALS often begins with **muscle twitching** and **weakness in an arm or leg, trouble swallowing** or slurred speech. Eventually ALS affects control of the muscles needed to move, speak, eat and breathe. There is no cure for this fatal disease.

Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis (ALS)





Divergent single cell transcriptome and epigenome alterations in ALS and FTD patients with C9orf72 mutation

Received: 16 December 2022

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Published online: 15 September 2023

Junhao Li ^{1,6}, Manoj K. Jaiswal ^{2,6}, Jo-Fan Chien ³, Alexey Kozlenkov², Jinyoung Jung², Ping Zhou², Mahammad Gardashli⁴, Luc J. Pregent⁴, Erica Engelberg-Cook ⁴, Dennis W. Dickson ⁴, Veronique V. Belzil ⁴, Eran A. Mukamel ¹✉ & Stella Dracheva ^{2,5}✉

Background

- Aggregates of the RNA-binding transactive response DNA binding 43 protein (TDP-43) accumulate in neurons of almost all ALS cases
- The most common genetic cause is a dynamic hexanucleotide (GGGGCC; G4C2) repeat expansion in the first intron of the C9orf72 gene

REVIEW article

Front. Cell. Neurosci., 05 May 2021

Sec. Cellular Neuropathology

Volume 15 - 2021 | <https://doi.org/10.3389/fncel.2021.661447>

This article is part of the Research Topic

Molecular Mechanisms Underlying C9orf72 Neurodegeneration

[View all 8 Articles >](#)

C9ORF72: What It Is, What It Does, and Why It Matters



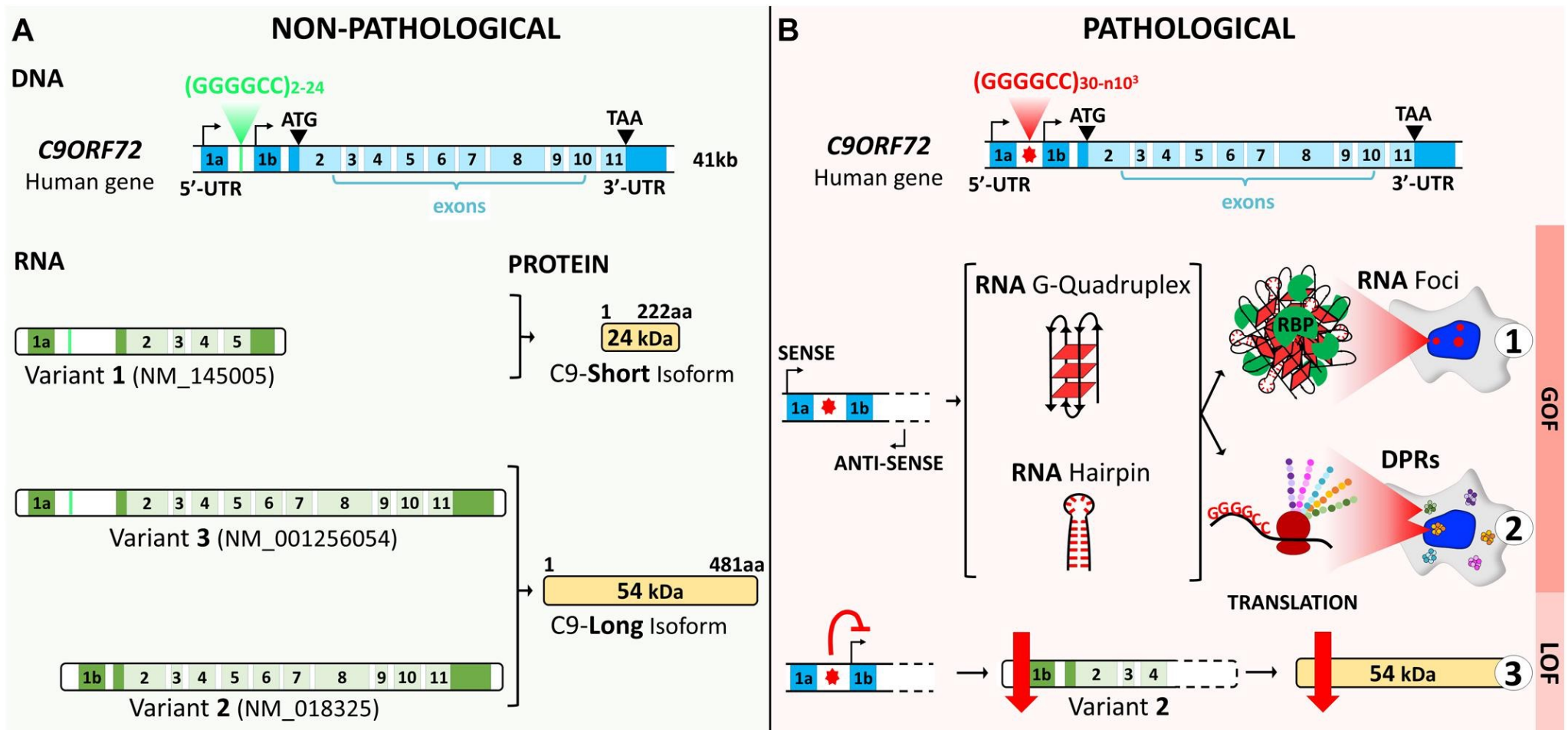
Julie Smeyers^{1,2}



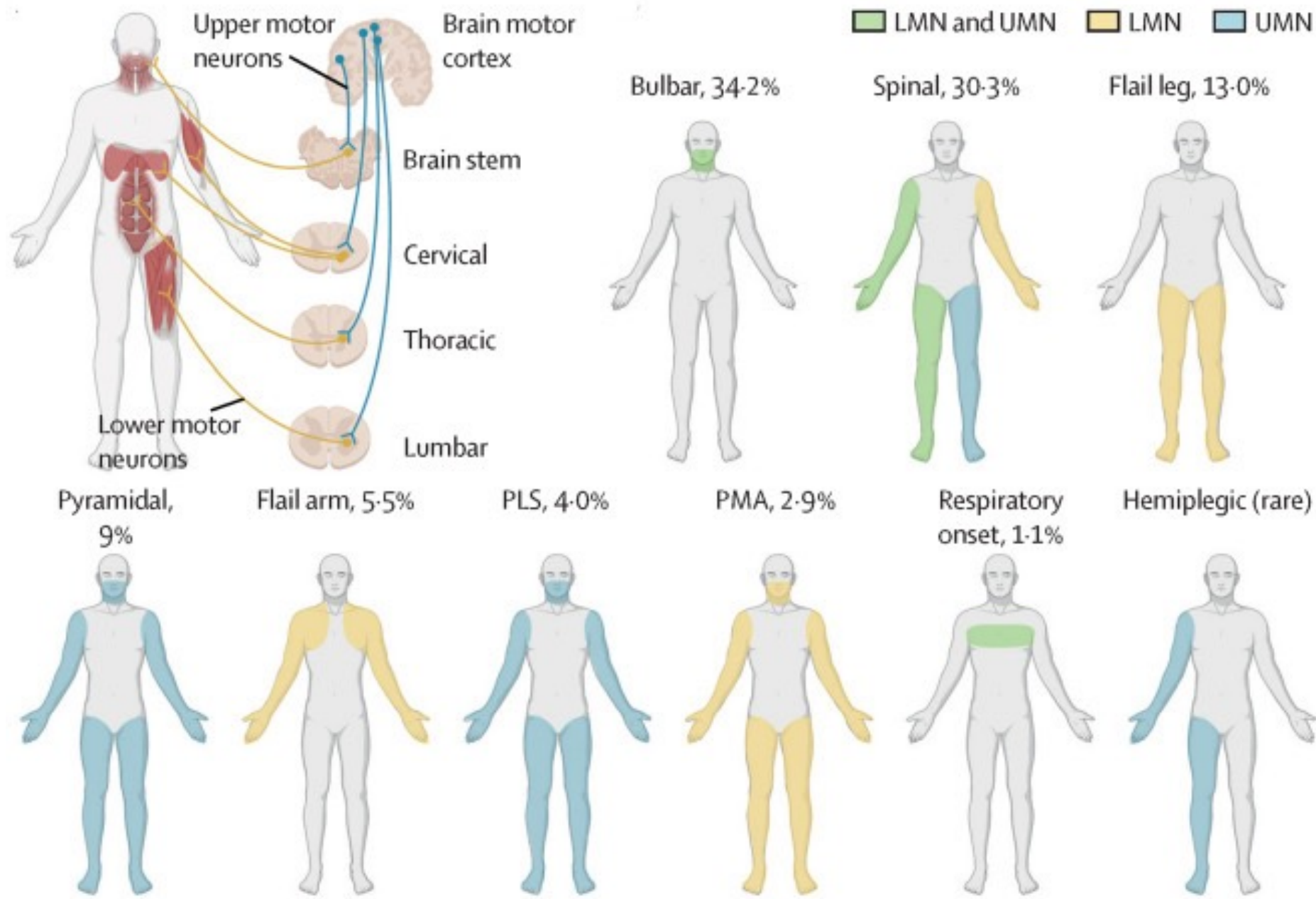
Elena-Gaia Banchi¹



Morwena Latouche^{1,2*}



- Bidirectional transcription of the hexanucleotide repeat expansion (HRE) generates G4C2 sense and G2C4 antisense expanded RNAs.
- These HRE transcripts give rise to G-quadruplex and hairpin structures that can form RNA foci and sequester RNA-binding proteins (RBP)
- Expanded RNAs are also translated through repeat-associated non-ATG (RAN) translation, resulting in the synthesis of dipeptide protein repeats (DPRs)
- Finally, the presence of the HRE inhibits transcription, leading to a decrease in the C9ORF72 protein



Design

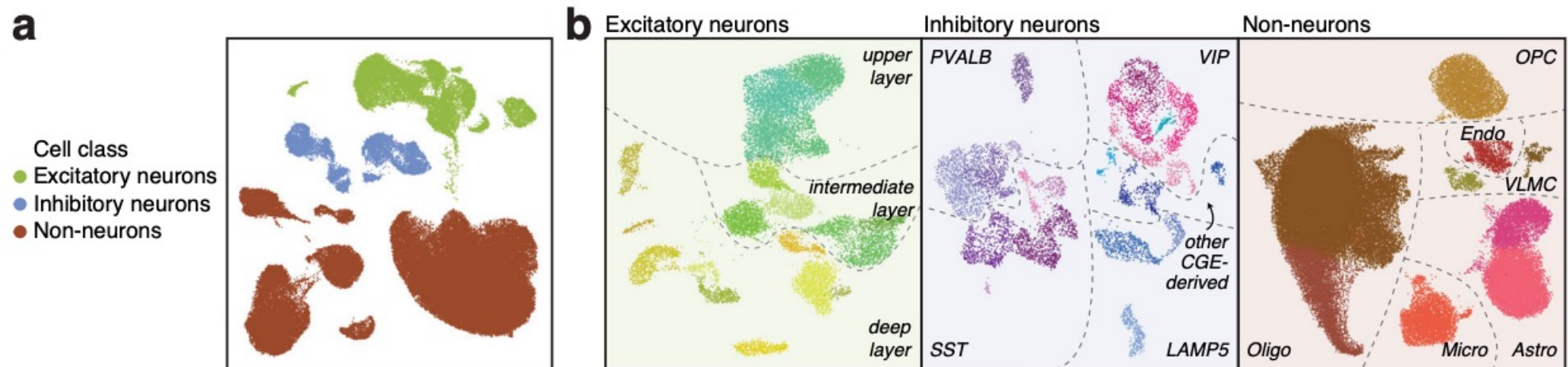


single-nucleus transcriptomic (snRNA-seq) and epigenomic (snATAC-seq) analysis of human brain samples to investigate the cell-type-specific molecular alterations in C9-ALS or C9-FTD donors

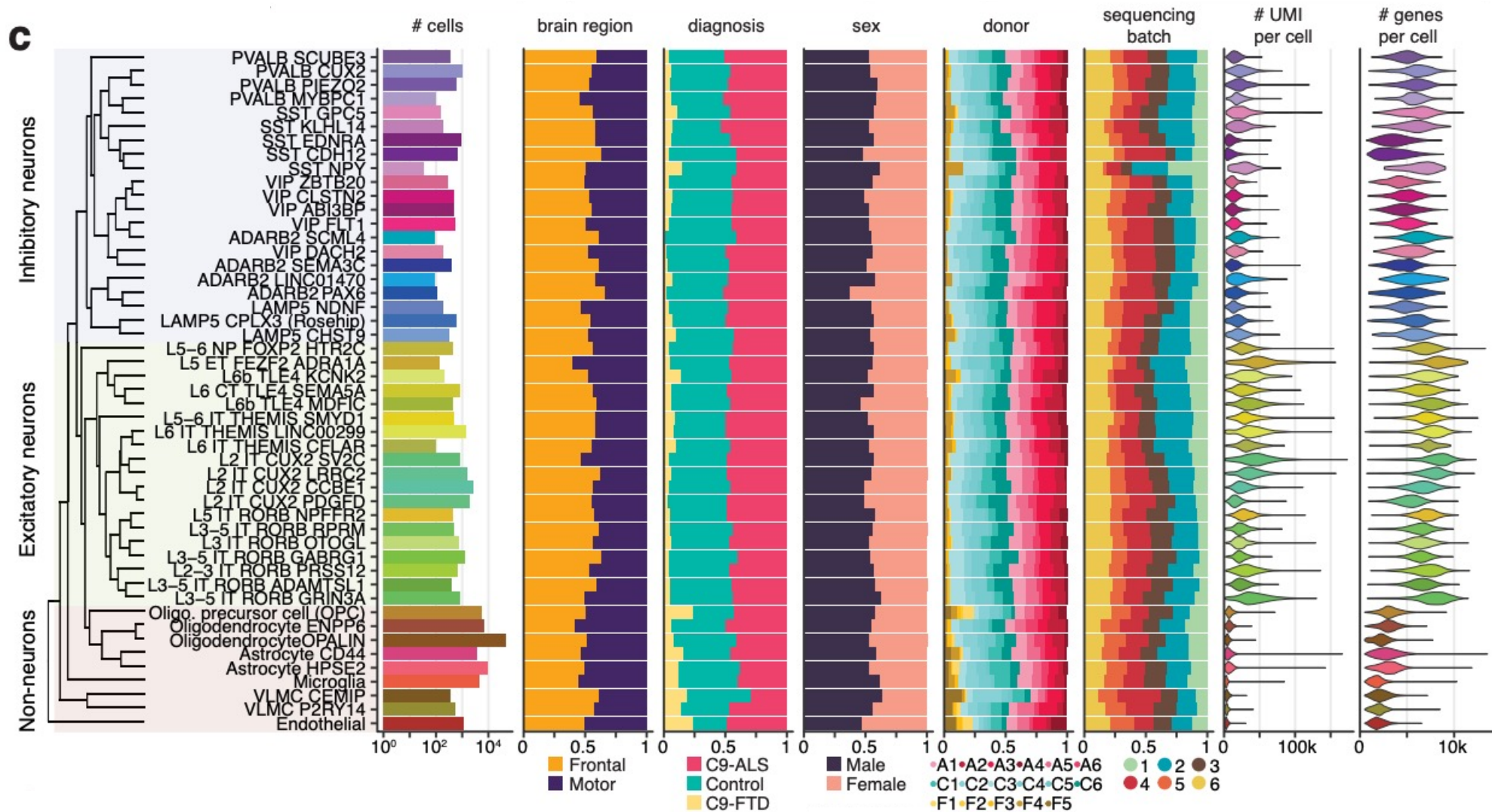


two key cortical regions, the motor and frontal cortices, in an attempt to uncover regional differences.

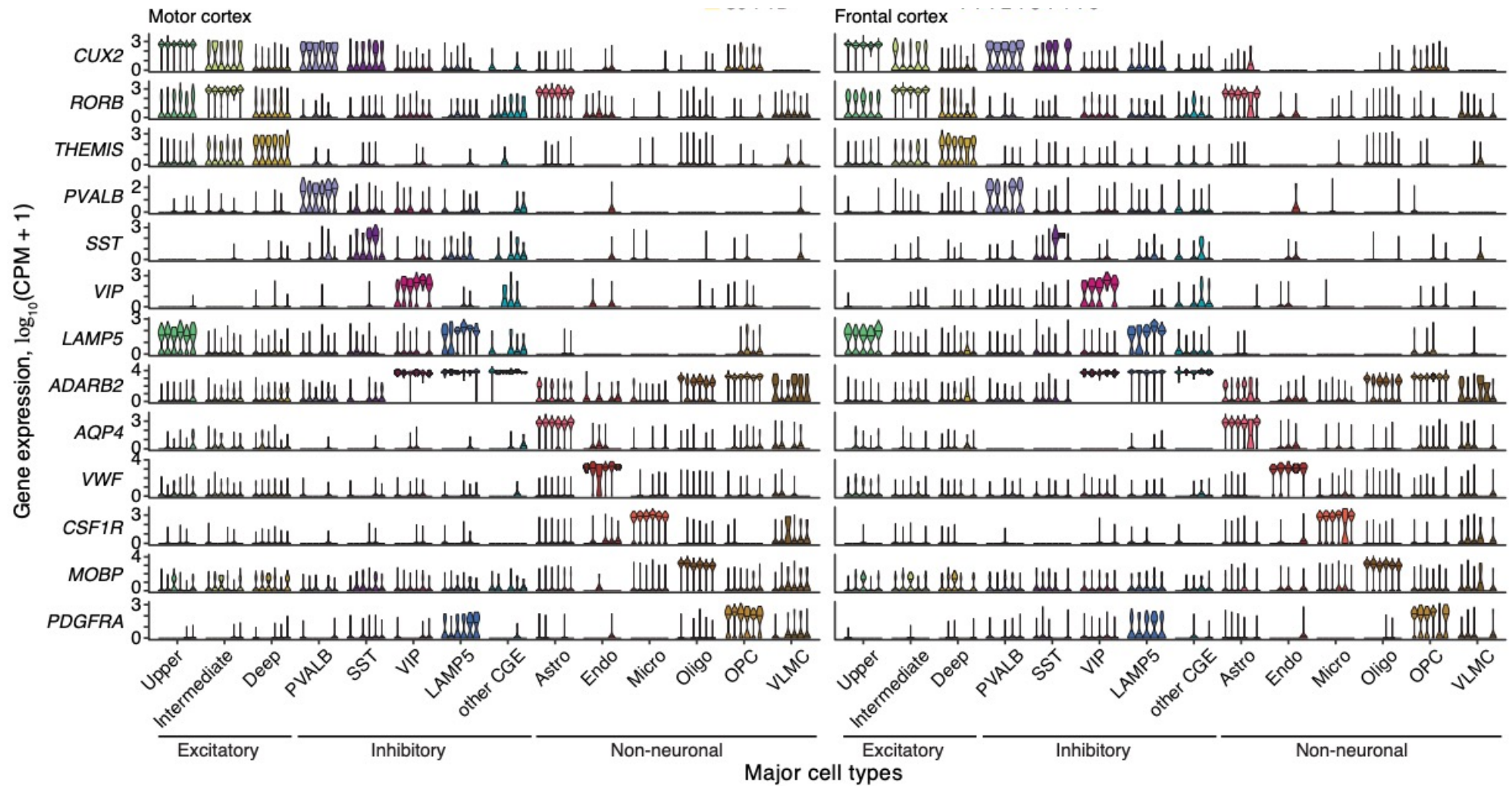
Single nucleus transcriptomes in C9-ALS and C9-FTD specimens identify fine-grained cortical cell types



- $n = 105,120$ cells from 17 donors
- Nuclei were first classified into three cell classes
- then subpopulations in each class were identified

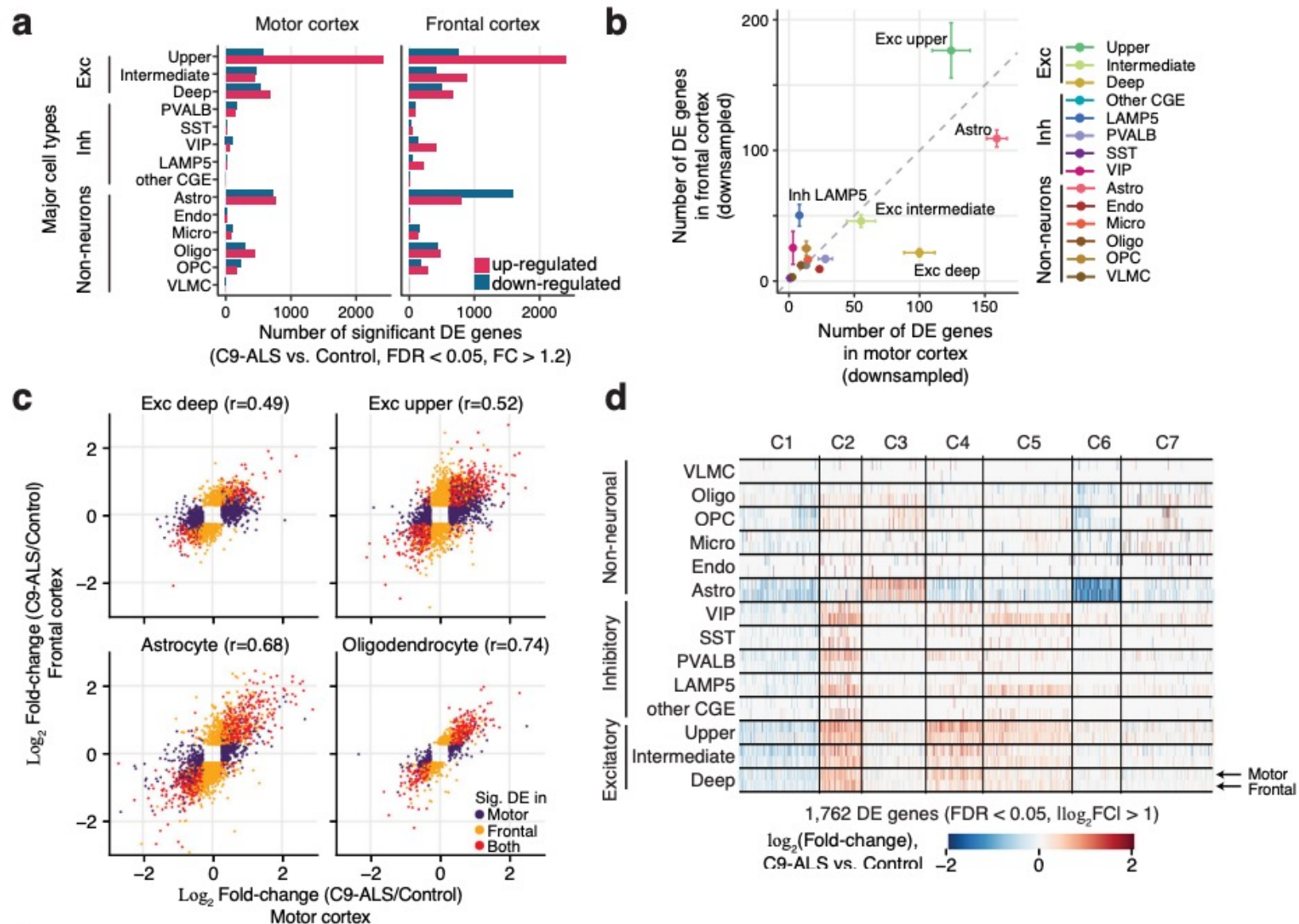


- Neuronal and non-neuronal cell types were distributed across brain regions, donor diagnosis groups, sex, and sequencing batches. UMI unique molecular identifier.

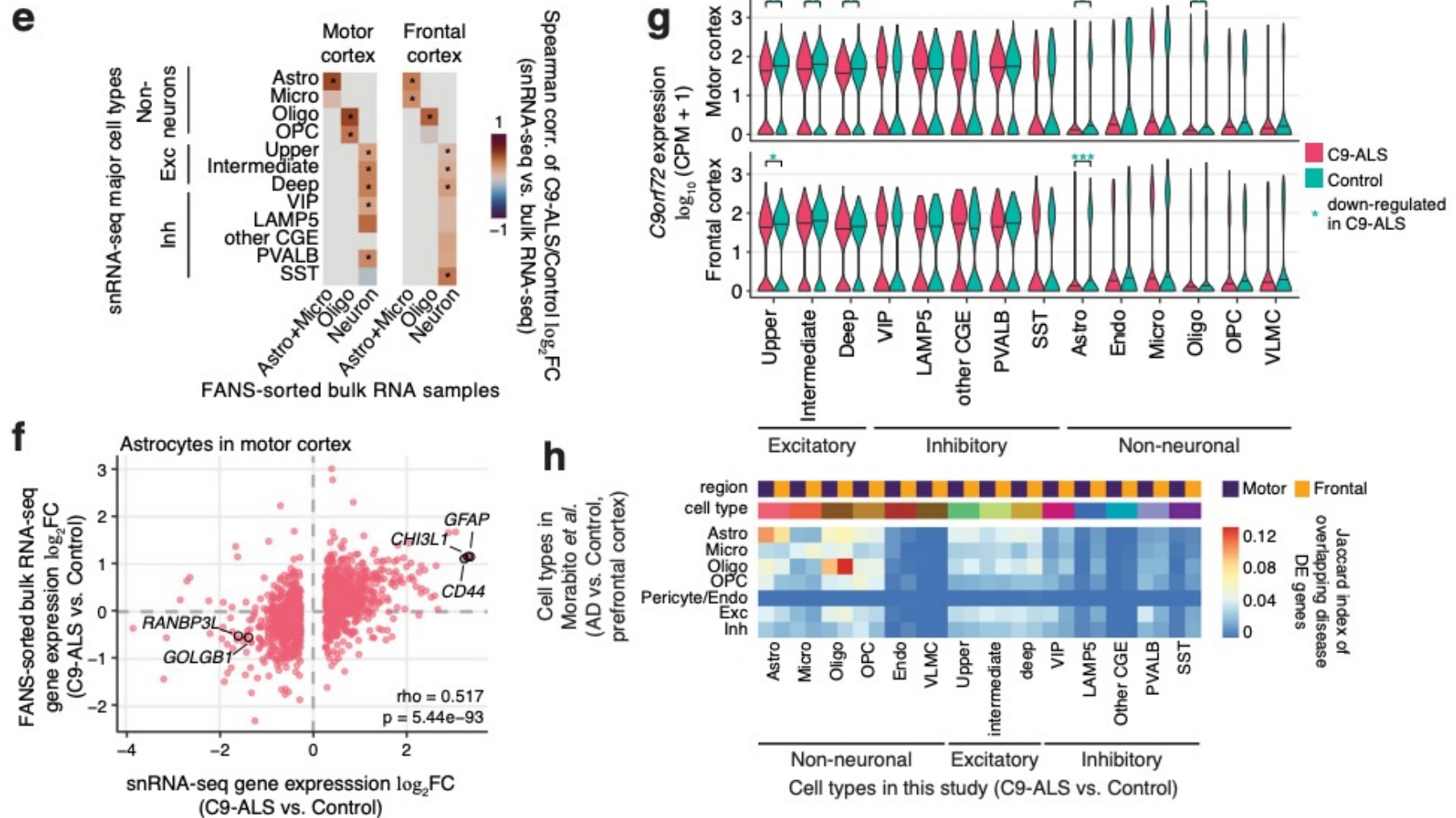


- Violin plots show marker gene expression in major cell types in each of the 6 control donors.

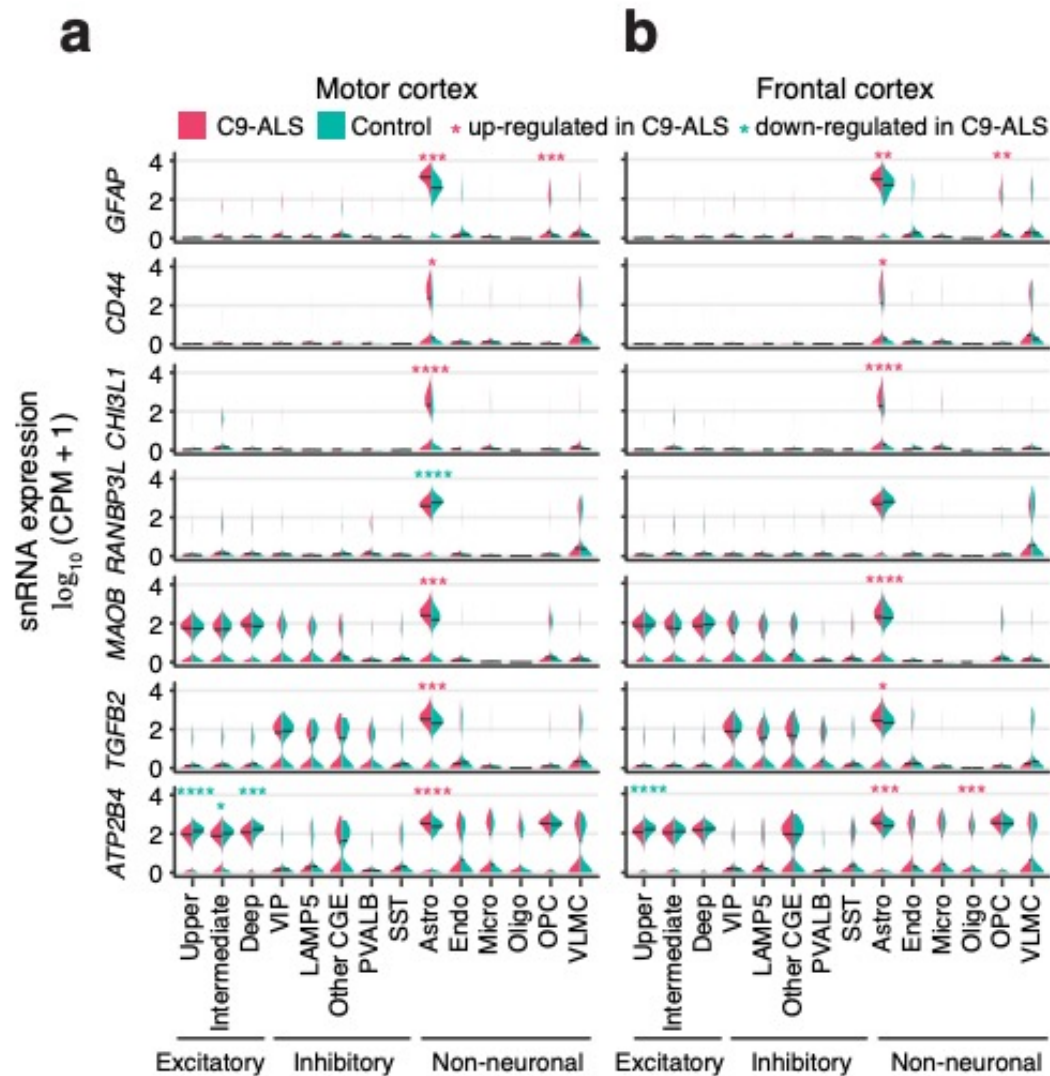
Dysregulation of gene expression in C9-ALS is concentrated in astrocytes and excitatory neurons



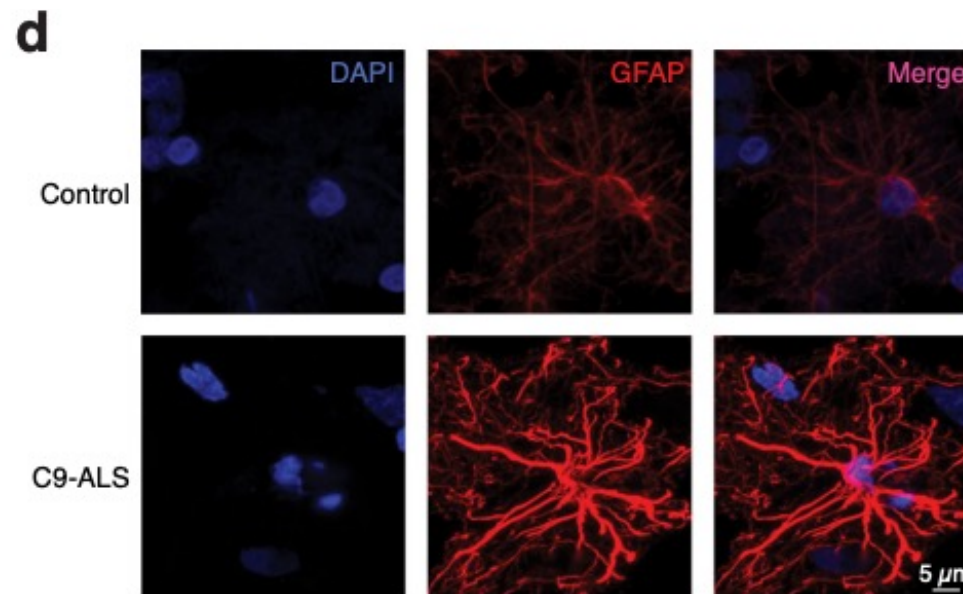
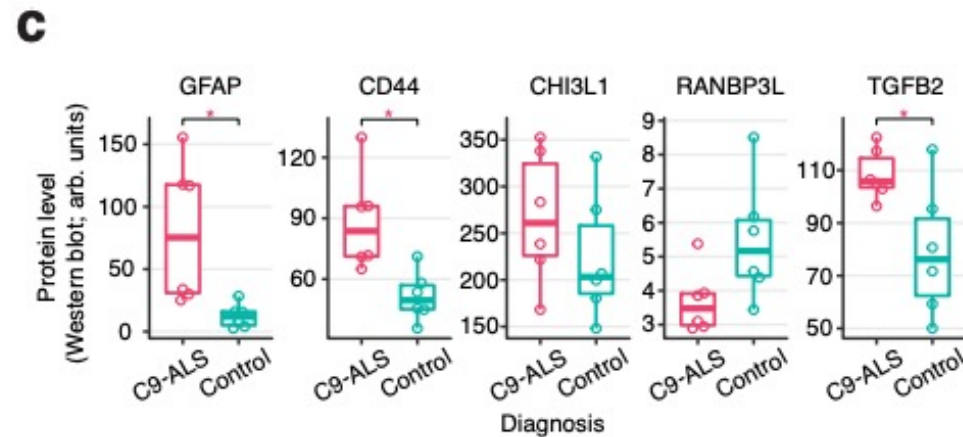
Dysregulation of gene expression in C9-ALS is concentrated in astrocytes and excitatory neurons



Dysregulation of gene expression in C9-ALS astrocytes suggests activation and structural remodeling

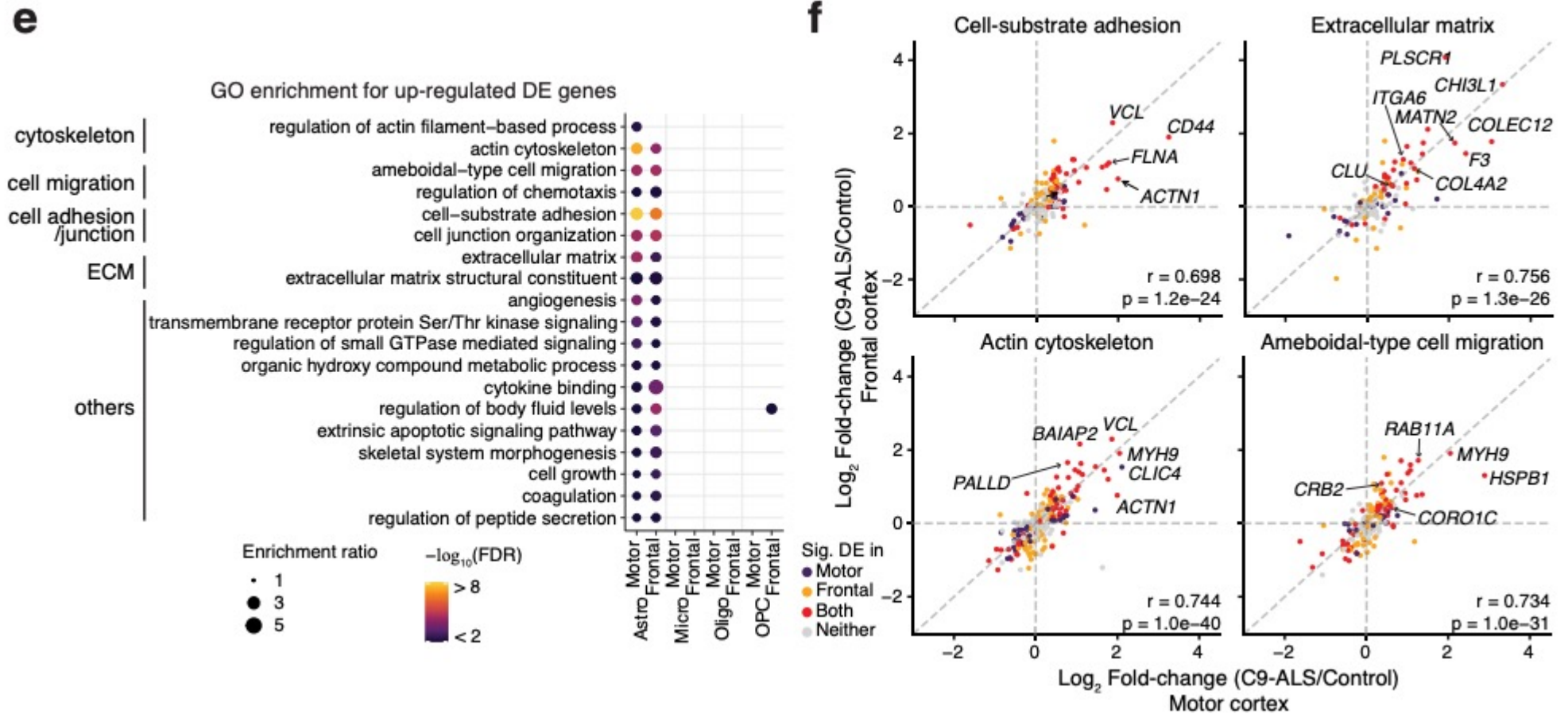


Dysregulation of gene expression in C9-ALS astrocytes suggests activation and structural remodeling



- immunofluorescence images of the GFAP-positive astrocytes in motor cortex (red)

Dysregulation of gene expression in C9-ALS astrocytes suggests activation and structural remodeling



Heterochromatin anomalies and double-stranded RNA accumulation underlie *C9orf72* poly(PR) toxicity

Yong-Jie Zhang^{1,2}, Lin Guo³, Patrick K. Gonzales⁴, Tania F. Gendron^{1,2}, Yanwei Wu¹, Karen Jansen-West¹, Aliesha D. O'Raw¹, Sarah R. Pickles¹, Mercedes Prudencio^{1,2}, Yari Carlomagno¹, Mariam A. Gachechiladze⁵, Connor Ludwig^{6a}, Ruilin Tian⁶, Jeannie Chew^{1,2}, Michael DeTure^{1,2}, Wen-Lang Lin¹, Jimei Tong¹, Lillian M. Daugherty¹, Mei Yue¹, Yuping Song¹, Jonathan W. Andersen¹, Monica Castaneda-Casey¹, Aishe Kurti¹, Abhishek Datta^{7†}, Giovanna Antognetti⁷, Alexander McCampbell⁸, Rosa Rademakers^{1,2}, Björn Oskarsson⁹, Dennis W. Dickson^{1,2}, Martin Kampmann⁶, Michael E. Ward⁵, John D. Fryer^{1,2}, Christopher D. Link⁴, James Shorter³, Leonard Petrucelli^{1,2†}

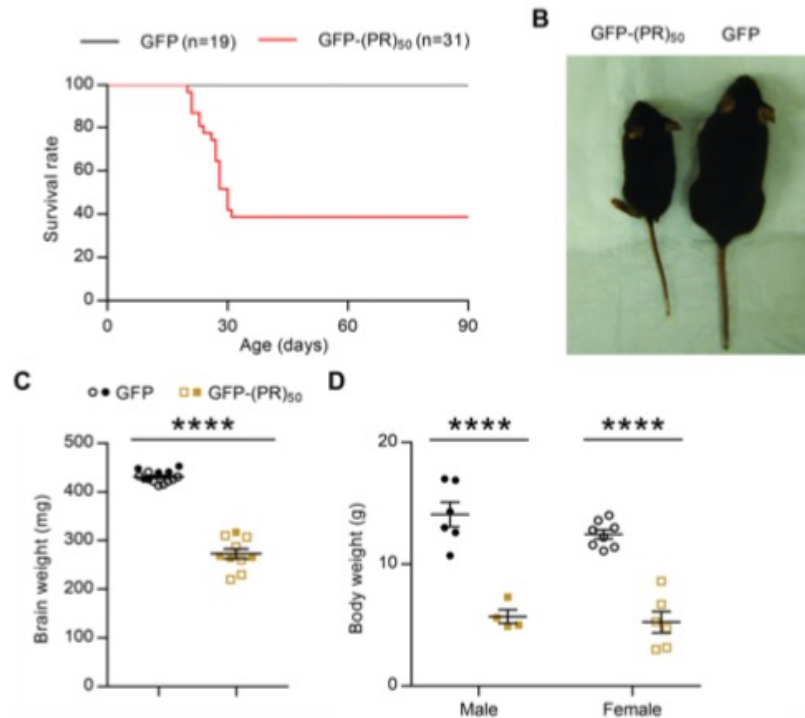


Fig. S1. Expression of GFP-(PR)₅₀ in mouse brain was extremely toxic. (A) ~60% of GFP-(PR)₅₀ mice died by 4 weeks of age. (B) GFP-(PR)₅₀ mice that died prematurely were markedly smaller than age-matched GFP mice. (C) Mean brain weight of GFP-(PR)₅₀ mice that died prematurely ($n = 10$) and age-matched GFP mice ($n = 14$). (D) Mean body weight of GFP-(PR)₅₀ mice that died prematurely (male, $n = 4$; female, $n = 6$) and age-matched GFP mice (male, $n = 6$; female, $n = 8$). Data are presented as mean $\pm$ SEM. Male mice are represented by solid symbols, while female mice are represented by empty symbols. In (C) and (D): **** $P < 0.0001$, two-tailed unpaired t test.

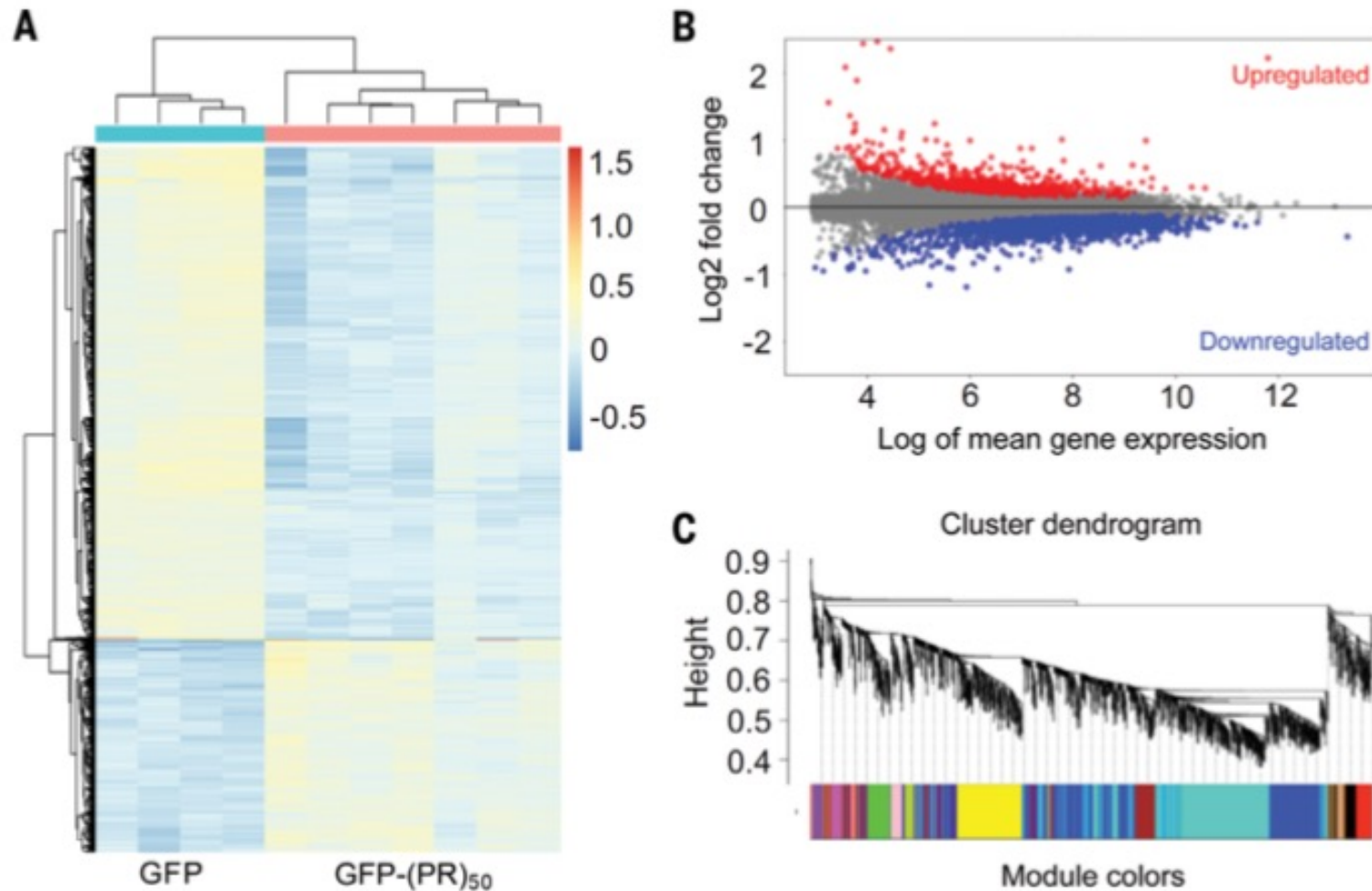


Fig. 4. Transcriptome alterations were identified in the brains of mice expressing GFP-(PR)₅₀. (A) Hierarchical clustering of the 1000 most variable genes between 3-month-old GFP mice ($n = 4$) and GFP-(PR)₅₀ mice ($n = 7$). (B) MA plots of up- and down-regulated genes (FDR < 0.01) in the cortices and hippocampi of 3-month-old mice expressing GFP-(PR)₅₀ ($n = 7$) compared with those of GFP controls ($n = 4$). The MA plot is based on the Bland-Altman plot, where M represents the log₂ fold change (y axis) and A represents the log of mean gene expression (x axis). (C) Gene modules identified in brains of 3-month-old mice expressing GFP-(PR)₅₀ ($n = 7$ mice) through weighted gene coexpression correlation network analyses using differentially expressed genes.

General Approaches in ALS Treatment Research

